BEST OF THE BEST

GENERAL PAPER- NEW ADVANCED LEVEL CURRICULUM

QUICK APPROACH

S.5&S.6

2025

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GENERAL PAPER NOTES

ADVANCED LEVEL SECONDARY EDUCATION

In alignment with the National Curriculum Development Centre, Uganda

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SENIOR FIVE TERM 1

TOPIC 1: COMMUNICATION

Duration: 33 Periods

Competency: The learner communicates effectively using appropriate media for different target audiences to be understood.

LEARNING OUTCOME 1(a): Convey relevant information effectively by applying it to a given scenario (s, gs)

1.1 UNDERSTANDING COMMUNICATION

Definition of Communication

Communication is the process of exchanging information, ideas, thoughts, feelings, and messages between two or more people through various channels and media. It comes from the Latin word "communicare," meaning "to share" or "to make common."

Key Elements of Communication:

1. **Sender** - The person who initiates the message
2. **Message** - The information being conveyed
3. **Channel/Medium** - The method used to send the message
4. **Receiver** - The person for whom the message is intended
5. **Feedback** - The response from the receiver
6. **Context** - The situation or environment where communication occurs
7. **Noise** - Anything that interferes with the message

Example Scenario: A teacher (sender) explains a concept (message) to students (receivers) in a classroom (context) using verbal explanation and a chalkboard (channel). Students ask questions (feedback). A noisy construction site outside (noise) may interfere with hearing.

1.2 THE PURPOSE OF EFFECTIVE COMMUNICATION

A. Information Sharing

- To provide facts, data, and knowledge
- To keep others informed about developments
- To disseminate important announcements

Example: The Ministry of Health communicates COVID-19 guidelines to the public through press releases, radio announcements, and social media.

B. Persuasion and Influence

- To convince others to adopt a particular viewpoint
- To encourage specific actions or behaviors
- To change attitudes and opinions

Example: A political candidate delivers campaign speeches to persuade voters to support them in elections. They use emotional appeals, logical arguments, and promises of better governance.

C. Instruction and Guidance

- To teach others how to perform tasks
- To provide directions and procedures
- To clarify expectations

Example: A senior five student writes a step-by-step guide for junior students on how to choose Extended Essay topics, explaining the process, common pitfalls, and useful resources.

D. Expression of Feelings and Emotions

- To share personal experiences and emotions
- To build relationships through empathy
- To create connections with others

Example: A student writes a heartfelt poem about the challenges of balancing academics and family responsibilities, sharing it during a school assembly to connect with peers facing similar struggles.

E. Social Interaction

- To establish and maintain relationships
- To create bonds within communities
- To facilitate social harmony

Example: During a community meeting, elders use proverbs and stories to share wisdom, resolve conflicts, and strengthen community bonds.

F. Decision Making

- To gather opinions and perspectives
- To discuss alternatives and consequences
- To reach consensus or make informed choices

Example: A school prefect body holds a debate on whether to organize a sports day or a music festival, considering student preferences, available resources, and educational value.

1.3 FORMS OF COMMUNICATION

A. VERBAL COMMUNICATION

Verbal communication involves the use of words, either spoken or written, to convey messages.

i) Oral Communication (Spoken)

Characteristics:

- Uses spoken words
- Immediate feedback possible
- Tone, pitch, and volume add meaning
- Can be formal or informal

Types of Oral Communication:

Type	Description	Example
Face-to-face conversation	Direct interaction between people	Two friends discussing weekend plans
Public speaking	Addressing a group	A head prefect addressing the school assembly
Meetings	Formal gatherings for discussion	Staff meeting to plan the term's activities
Telephone calls	Remote spoken interaction	A student calling home to request school fees
Presentations	Structured delivery of information	A learner presenting research findings to classmates
Debates	Formal arguments on a topic	Inter-house debate on "Social media does more harm than good"

ii) Written Communication

Characteristics:

- Uses written symbols
- Provides permanent record
- Allows careful crafting of message

- Can be reviewed and revised

Types of Written Communication:

Type	Description	Example
Letters	Personal or formal written messages	A job application letter
Reports	Structured accounts of information	A class prefect's term report
Essays	Academic compositions	The Extended Essay for General Paper
Emails	Electronic written messages	A student emailing a teacher for clarification
Memos	Internal organizational communication	A memo from headteacher about changed schedule
Text messages	Short written communications	SMS reminder about a group meeting
Social media posts	Public written updates	A tweet about a school event

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B. NON-VERBAL COMMUNICATION

Non-verbal communication involves conveying messages without words, through body language, gestures, facial expressions, and other physical cues.

Key Forms of Non-Verbal Communication:

i) Facial Expressions

- The face conveys emotions: happiness, sadness, anger, surprise, fear, disgust
- Universal across cultures to some extent

Example: During a debate, a speaker's raised eyebrows may indicate surprise at an opponent's argument, while a smile can show confidence or agreement.

ii) Gestures

- Deliberate movements to express meaning
- Can be culture-specific

Gesture	Meaning in Uganda	Possible Different Meaning Elsewhere
Nodding head	Agreement/Yes	In some cultures, it may mean "no"
Shaking head	Disagreement/No	In some cultures, it may mean "yes"
Waving hand	Greeting or goodbye	Universal, but style varies
Pointing with lips	Indicating direction or person	Common in Ugandan communication
Thumbs up	Approval/good job	Generally positive, but offensive in some cultures

iii) Eye Contact (Oculesics)

- Indicates attention and interest
- Shows confidence or nervousness
- Varies across cultures

Example: In Ugandan culture, maintaining eye contact during conversation shows respect and attentiveness. However, prolonged eye contact with elders might be considered disrespectful in some communities.

iv) Posture and Body Orientation

- How we sit, stand, and position ourselves
- Indicates attitudes and emotions

Posture	Possible Meaning
Leaning forward	Interest, engagement
Arms crossed	Defensiveness, closed attitude
Slouching	Disinterest, tiredness
Standing straight	Confidence, alertness
Turning away	Disengagement, avoidance

v) Touch (Haptics)

- Physical contact communicates various messages
- Highly culture-dependent

Example: A handshake is a common greeting in formal Ugandan settings. A pat on the back may indicate encouragement or congratulations. However, touch must be appropriate and respect personal boundaries.

vi) Personal Space (Proxemics)

- The distance we maintain from others
- Varies by relationship and culture

Zone	Distance	Appropriate for
Intimate	0-45 cm	Close family, partners
Personal	45-120 cm	Friends, acquaintances
Social	120-360 cm	Formal interactions, strangers
Public	360+ cm	Public speaking, audiences

vii) Paralanguage (Voice Qualities)

- How something is said, not what is said
- Includes pitch, tone, volume, speed, pauses

Example: Saying "That's interesting" in a flat, monotone voice may convey boredom, while saying it with enthusiasm conveys genuine interest. A pause before answering a question might indicate uncertainty or careful thought.

viii) Appearance and Artifacts

- Clothing, accessories, grooming
- Communicates identity, status, professionalism

Example: A student wearing the complete school uniform communicates discipline and belonging. A lawyer in formal attire communicates professionalism and respect for the court.

1.4 REGISTER, JARGON, STYLE, AND CONTEXT

A. Register

Register refers to the variety of language used in a particular social setting or for a specific purpose. It involves choices in vocabulary, grammar, and tone.

Types of Register:

Register	Characteristics	Example
Frozen	Fixed, unchanging language	The National Anthem, religious scriptures, pledges
Formal	Professional, official language	Academic essays, official letters, speeches
Consultative	Professional but interactive	Doctor-patient conversation, teacher-student discussion
Casual	Informal, between friends	Chatting with classmates during break
Intimate	Private, between close relations	Conversations between family members

Example of Different Registers for the Same Message:

Frozen: "I hereby solemnly pledge to uphold the values of this institution." (School pledge)

Formal: "I would like to express my commitment to maintaining the school's standards." (Letter to headteacher)

Consultative: "So, as we discussed, you'll need to maintain good behavior throughout the term." (Teacher to student)

Casual: "Hey man, just keep it cool and follow the rules, alright?" (Friend to friend)

Intimate: "Sweetheart, remember to behave well at school." (Parent to child)

B. Jargon

Jargon refers to specialized language used by a particular profession, group, or field of study. It facilitates efficient communication among insiders but may exclude outsiders.

Examples of Jargon by Field:

Field	Jargon Terms	Meaning
Education	Pedagogy, curriculum, formative assessment, scaffolding	Teaching methods, course of study, ongoing evaluation, support structure
Medicine	Diagnosis, prognosis, hypertension, anesthesia	Identification of illness, predicted outcome, high blood pressure, pain

		relief
Law	Plaintiff, defendant, habeas corpus, injunction	Person bringing a case, person defending, right to appear in court, court order
Business	ROI, assets, liabilities, leverage, equity	Return on investment, owned items, debts, borrowed funds, ownership value
Technology	Bandwidth, cloud, malware, encryption, firewall	Data capacity, online storage, harmful software, data protection, security system
Agriculture	Photosynthesis, irrigation, composting, mulching	Plant food production, water supply, organic fertilizer, soil covering

C. Style

Style refers to the distinctive way a person uses language, including choices in words, sentence structure, imagery, and tone.

Elements of Style:

Element	Description	Example
Diction	Word choice	Using "residence" vs. "home," "children" vs. "kids"
Sentence structure	Simple, compound, complex sentences	Varying sentence length for effect
Tone	Attitude conveyed	Serious, humorous, sarcastic, formal, informal
Imagery	Descriptive language creating mental pictures	"The sun sank like a golden coin into the lake"
Figurative language	Metaphors, similes, personification	"Her voice was music to his ears"
Rhythm and flow	Patterns in language	Poetic devices, alliteration, repetition

Example of Different Styles:

Academic Style: "The research findings indicate a significant correlation between study habits and academic performance among secondary school students in urban areas."

Poetic Style: "In quiet corners, books unfurl their wings, while eager minds chase knowledge on silent wings."

Persuasive Style: "Imagine a future where every child in Uganda has access to quality education. This is not just a dream—it is an achievable reality if we act now."

Narrative Style: "When I first entered Senior Five, I had no idea how much the General Paper would change my way of thinking. It all started with a simple question..."

D. Context

Context refers to the circumstances, setting, or situation in which communication occurs. Context significantly influences how messages are constructed and interpreted.

Types of Context:

Context Type	Description	Communication Considerations
Physical context	Actual location and environment	Noise level, seating arrangement, formality of setting
Social context	Relationships between participants	Power dynamics, familiarity, cultural norms
Historical context	Past events influencing present	Previous interactions, shared history
Psychological context	Mental and emotional states	Mood, stress level, attitudes
Cultural context	Shared beliefs and practices	Values, customs, taboos

Examples of Context Affecting Communication:

Scenario 1: Addressing the Headteacher

- *Context:* Formal, hierarchical relationship
- *Appropriate Communication:* "Good morning, sir. May I have a moment of your time to discuss the prefects' meeting?"
- *Features:* Formal register, polite requests, respectful address

Scenario 2: Talking to a Friend During Break

- *Context:* Informal, equal relationship
- *Appropriate Communication:* "Hey, you got a minute? Let's talk about the meeting later."
- *Features:* Casual register, shortened phrases, informal address

Scenario 3: Presenting Research Findings

- *Context:* Academic, formal, audience of peers and teachers
- *Appropriate Communication:* "This study investigated the impact of agricultural practices on soil fertility in Kabale district. The findings reveal..."
- *Features:* Formal register, specialized vocabulary, structured presentation

Scenario 4: Comforting a Classmate

- *Context:* Personal, emotional, private
- *Appropriate Communication:* "I'm really sorry to hear about your loss. If you need someone to talk to, I'm here."
- *Features:* Empathetic tone, simple language, supportive message

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1.5 PRACTICAL APPLICATION: CREATING COMMUNICATION FOR SPECIFIC SCENARIOS

Activity Guide: When asked to create communication for a given scenario, follow these steps:

Step 1: Identify the context (who, what, where, when, why)
Step 2: Determine the purpose (inform, persuade, instruct, entertain)
Step 3: Choose the appropriate form (speech, poem, skit, story, song)
Step 4: Select suitable register and style
Step 5: Incorporate appropriate non-verbal elements (for presentations)
Step 6: Consider your target audience
Step 7: Draft and revise your communication

EXAMPLE SCENARIO 1: Address the school on the importance of environmental conservation

Form: Speech

GOOD MORNING FELLOW STUDENTS, RESPECTED TEACHERS, AND THE SCH OOL ADMINISTRATION.

Today, I stand before you not just as a student, but as a concerned citizen of Uganda and a resident of this planet we all call home. I want to talk about something that affects each one of us, every single day—our environment.

[Establish connection]
Look around you. Notice the trees that provide shade as we walk to class. Feel the breeze that cools us during hot afternoons. Listen to the birds that greet us each morning. This is our environment, and it is beautiful.

[Present the problem]
But here is the uncomfortable truth: our environment is under threat.
Every day, we lose trees to deforestation. Our rivers are being polluted with plastic waste. The air in our cities is becoming increasingly difficult to breathe. Last term, during our geography field trip to the wetland near our school, we sa w with our own eyes how this precious ecosystem is being destroyed—drained f or cultivation, filled with rubbish, and neglected by those who should protect it.

[Provide evidence/examples]
According to the National Environment Management Authority, Uganda loses 122,000 hectares of forest every year. That is equivalent to 200 football pitches every single day! The consequences are already visible—unpredictable rainfall patterns, prolonged droughts in some areas, and devastating floods in others.

[Call to action]
So what can we do? As students of this great school, I propose three actions:

First, let us start a tree-planting club. Each of us can commit to planting and nurturing at least one tree per term. Imagine if all 1,500 students in this school did that we would have 6,000 new trees every year!

Second, let us eliminate single-use plastics from our school compound. Carry reusable water bottles and lunch boxes. Say no to plastic bags.

Third, let us educate others. Share what you learn about environmental conservation with your families, your neighbors, and your communities. Change begins with awareness.

[Inspire and conclude]
Fellow students, the great environmentalist Wangari Maathai once said, "In the course of history, there comes a time when humanity is called to shift to a new level of consciousness." That time is now. The responsibility to protect our environment does not belong to the government alone, or to adults alone. It belongs to us the young people of Uganda.

Let us be the generation that healed the planet, not the one that destroyed it. Let us be the students who planted trees, cleaned rivers, and protected wildlife. Let us make our school, our community, and our country proud.

Thank you for listening, and I urge you all join me in this fight for our future.

GOD BLESS OUR SCHOOL, AND GOD BLESS UGANDA.

Non-verbal elements for this speech:

- Stand straight and confident
- Make eye contact with different sections of the audience
- Use hand gestures to emphasize key points (counting on fingers for the three actions)
- Modulate voice serious when discussing problems, hopeful when presenting solutions
- Pause after important statements to let them sink in

EXAMPLE SCENARIO 2: Write a poem about the challenges faced by students in rural Uganda

Form: Poem

THE DUSTY PATH TO KNOWLEDGE

Before the sun awakes, I rise,

My feet find thorns with closed eyes.
Five kilometers to school I tread,
With swirling thoughts inside my head.

The lamp that lit my book last night
Burned kerosene, a costly light.
My uniform, though washed with care,
Shows patches that are far from rare.

At school, the chalk is rationed out,
One piece for lessons round about.
The textbook, shared by eight or ten,
Is passed from hand to hand again.

The teacher comes when terms allow,
We wait and hope, but don't know how
A nation that expects so much
Can leave us without books or such.

But still I learn, I read, I grow,
Through challenges that few can know.
For education is the key
That one day will unlock for me

A future brighter than the sun,
Where all the struggle isn't done
In vain, but builds a stronger me,
From roots deep in adversity.

So when you see me in my class,
Don't pity what has come to pass.
Just know that on this dusty road,
I carry more than just my load.

I carry dreams of what will be,
For my community and me.
And though the path is rough and long,
My spirit's resilient and strong.

Features of this poem:

- Rhyme scheme (AABB) for musical quality
- Imagery ("dusty path," "lamp that lit my book," "chalk is rationed")
- Emotional appeal
- First-person perspective for authenticity
- Themes of struggle, resilience, and hope

EXAMPLE SCENARIO 3: Write a short story about a community coming together to solve a problem

Form: Short Story (Prose)

THE BRIDGE OF UNITY

In the village of Kikandwa, nestled in the hills of central Uganda, there was a problem that had plagued the community for generations. The Kanyanja River, which separated the village from the main road, the market, and the health center, swelled every rainy season, cutting off access for weeks at a time.

Nakato, a fifteen-year-old Senior Three student, had missed her final exams the previous year because she couldn't cross the flooded river. Her mother, a widow who sold vegetables at the market, had lost countless harvests to the waters. Her younger brother had once been carried downstream while trying to cross, surviving only because a fisherman pulled him out.

One evening, as the family sat around the cooking fire, Nakato's mother sighed heavily. "The rains are coming again next month. I don't know how we will manage."

Nakato looked at her mother's worried face and felt something shift inside her. "Maama," she said quietly, "what if we built a bridge?"

Her mother laughed bitterly. "A bridge? With what money? With what strength? That is the government's work."

But Nakato couldn't let go of the idea. The next day at school, she approached her General Paper teacher, Mr. Okello, who had always encouraged them to identify problems in their community.

"Mr. Okello," she began hesitantly, "I have an idea for my Extended Essay, but it's more than just an essay. It's something I want to actually do."

Mr. Okello leaned forward with interest. "Tell me more."

For the next week, Nakato worked tirelessly. She interviewed elders about the river's history. She counted how many people crossed daily—over 200 during market days. She calculated how much time and money was lost when the river flooded. She even learned about different types of simple bridges from a construction worker she met at the trading center.

Armed with information, Nakato called a community meeting. To her surprise, over fifty people gathered under the big mango tree—farmers, shopkeepers, the local councilor, even the parish chief.

"Tujja kuzimba!" Nakato declared in the local language. "We will build!"

She presented her findings simply but powerfully. "Every rainy season, we lose over 50 million shillings as a community—in spoiled goods, missed work, and children failing to attend school. A simple wooden bridge will cost about 3 million shillings in materials. And we have something the government doesn't have—ourselves."

The murmuring grew into animated discussion. Mr. Katende, the richest farmer, stood up. "I will contribute timber from my land." Mama Fina, who ran the local restaurant, offered to cook for the workers. The youth, led by Nakato's classmates, volunteered their labor.

For two months, the community worked together. The men cut and shaped the timber. The women brought food and water. The children carried smaller materials. Mr. Okello helped document everything for Nakato's project.

When the last nail was hammered and the first person crossed safely, there was no official ceremony, no ribbon-cutting. But there were tears in many eyes as the community looked at what they had built together.

That night, Nakato sat down to write her Extended Essay. But as she wrote, she realized that the most important lesson wasn't in any book she had read. It was in the hands that had worked together, the hearts that had believed together, and the bridge that now stood as proof that ordinary people could do extraordinary things when they united for a common purpose.

Her essay concluded: "A bridge is not just wood and nails. A bridge is what happens when a community decides that waiting is no longer an option. We built more than a crossing that day. We built hope."

The following year, when the rains came, Nakato crossed the bridge to sit for her Senior Four exams. She passed with flying colors.

Features of this story:

- Clear narrative structure (beginning, middle, end)
- Character development (Nakato as protagonist)
- Conflict and resolution
- Descriptive details
- Theme of community action and empowerment
- Connection to Extended Essay process

EXAMPLE SCENARIO 4: Create a skit about conflict resolution among students

Form: Skit

TITLE: THE GROUP WORK DISASTER

CHARACTERS:
- SARAH: Group leader, serious about academics
- MOSES: Lazy group member, always on phone
- GRACE: Peacemaker, tries to keep harmony
- PETER: Hot-tempered, easily frustrated
- TEACHER: Appears at the end (cameo)

SETTING: School library, a table with four chairs

[SCENE 1]

(The four students are gathered around a table, books and papers scattered. MOSES is on his phone, ignoring the others.)

SARAH: (Frustrated) Moses, can you please put that phone away? We have to submit this group project tomorrow, and we haven't even finished half of it.

MOSES: (Without looking up) Relax, I'm just checking something important. I'll do my part later.

PETER: (Slamming hand on table) Later?! It's already 5 o'clock! You haven't done ANYTHING since we started this project two weeks ago! Every time we meet, you're on that stupid phone!

MOSES: (Finally looking up, defensive) Hey, who made you the boss? I have a life outside this group, you know.

PETER: Some life! Scrolling through TikTok while we do all the work!

GRACE: (Soothingly) Okay, okay, let's all calm down. Fighting won't help us finish. Moses, we really need your help. You were supposed to research the section on poverty in urban areas. Did you find anything?

MOSES: (Sheepishly) Well... I haven't exactly started yet. But I will tonight!

PETER: (Standing up angrily) Tonight?! We needed that information three days ago! I'm tired of carrying lazy people! I'm going to the teacher to ask for a group change!

(PETER storms out)

SARAH: (Head in hands) Great. Just great. Now we're down to three people, and one of them is still on his phone.

(MOSES finally puts his phone down, looking uncomfortable)

GRACE: Sarah, maybe we should take a five-minute break. We're all stressed, and that's not helping.

SARAH: We don't have time for breaks!

GRACE: We don't have time for fighting either.

[SCENE 2]

(Ten minutes later. PETER has returned and is sitting at a different table, arms crossed. MOSES approaches him hesitantly.)

MOSES: (Quietly) Peter, can I talk to you for a minute?

PETER: (Coldly) What?

MOSES: (Sitting down) Look, I know I messed up. I've been procrastinating, and it's not fair to you guys. I'm sorry.

(PETER looks surprised but doesn't respond immediately)

MOSES: The truth is... (pauses) I'm struggling. My parents are separating, and I can't concentrate on anything. The phone is just my escape. I should have told you all instead of just hiding.

PETER's expression softens. He's quiet for a moment.

PETER: I didn't know, man. Why didn't you say something?

MOSES: I don't know. Pride, I guess. And I didn't want everyone's pity.

PETER: (Moving closer) Listen, we've all got stuff going on. But you can't just disappear on us. We're a team. If you're struggling, we need to know.

MOSES: You're right. I'm sorry.

PETER: (Extending hand) Okay. Apology accepted. Now let's figure out how to fix this.

(They return to the main table together. SARAH and GRACE look up hopefully.)

PETER: Okay, new plan. Moses is going through some personal stuff, but he's ready to work now. We need to divide the remaining work differently.

GRACE: I can help Moses with his section. I already found some sources he can use.

SARAH: (More gently now) That would help a lot, Grace. And Moses, if you finish your part by tomorrow morning, we can still submit on time.

MOSES: I will. I promise. And I'm sorry for letting you all down.

SARAH: Apology accepted. Now let's get to work.

(They all start working together. MOSES is now fully engaged, taking notes and asking questions.)

[SCENE 3]

(The next morning. The group is gathered outside the staff room, project in hand.)

TEACHER: (Emerging from office) Ah, my favorite group! Ready to submit?

SARAH: (Handing over the project) Yes, madam. We finished it last night.

TEACHER: (Flipping through pages) This looks excellent! Very thorough research, good analysis. I'm impressed.

PETER: Madam, we learned something important from this project.

TEACHER: Oh? What's that?

PETER: (Looking at MOSES) That being a good group means being honest with each

other, even when it's hard. And that giving up on someone is never the answer.

TEACHER: (Smiling) That's a lesson worth more than any grade. Well done, all of you.

(The group shares a moment of unity as the skit ends.)

[END OF SKIT]

Features of this skit:

- Dialogue-driven
- Character conflicts and resolution
- Realistic school setting
- Clear message about communication and teamwork
- Multiple scenes showing progression
- Relatable situations for students

LEARNING OUTCOME 1(b): Analyse the value of media in promoting effective communication in contemporary society (u, s, gs)

1.6 UNDERSTANDING MEDIA

Definition of Media

Media refers to the various channels, tools, and platforms used to store, transmit, and deliver information, news, data, entertainment, and messages to a wide audience. The term "media" is plural of "medium," meaning the means through which something is communicated.

Categories of Media:

Category	Description	Examples

Print Media	Written content published on paper	Newspapers, magazines, books, brochures, newsletters
Broadcast Media	Audio and video content transmitted electronically	Radio, television
Digital/New Media	Internet-based content	Websites, social media, blogs, podcasts, streaming services
Outdoor Media	Public visual displays	Billboards, posters, banners, signage
Traditional Media	Indigenous communication systems	Drums, town criers, community meetings, oral storytelling

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1.7 TYPES OF MEDIA IN CONTEMPORARY SOCIETY

A. PRINT MEDIA

Newspapers

- Daily or weekly publications with news, opinions, and advertisements
- **Ugandan examples:** New Vision, Daily Monitor, Bukedde, The Observer
- **Audience:** General public, specific language groups

Magazines

- Periodicals focusing on specific topics
- **Ugandan examples:** The Independent (politics and business), Bride & Groom (lifestyle), African Farming (agriculture)
- **Audience:** Niche readers with specific interests

Books

- Long-form written works for education or entertainment
- Include textbooks, novels, biographies, reference materials

Brochures and Pamphlets

- Short printed materials for specific purposes
- Used for information campaigns, advertising, education

Advantages of Print Media:

- Provides permanent record
- Allows in-depth coverage
- Reader can control pace
- No technology required
- Credible and trusted

Disadvantages of Print Media:

- Limited distribution
- Delayed publication
- Environmental concerns (paper use)
- Declining readership
- Cannot be updated easily

B. BROADCAST MEDIA

Radio

Radio remains the most accessible medium in Uganda, reaching even remote areas with no electricity or internet.

Types of Radio Stations in Uganda:

Station Type	Examples	Focus
Public Broadcaster	UBC Radio	National coverage, multiple languages
Commercial Radio	Capital FM, Radio One, Sanyu FM	Entertainment, news, music
Community Radio	Radio Apac, Mega FM	Local issues, local languages
Vernacular Radio	Bukedde FM, CBS FM	Specific language communities

Why Radio is Powerful in Uganda:

- Affordable (cheap radios, low battery consumption)
- Accessible (works in areas with no electricity)
- Multi-lingual (programmes in local languages)
- Immediate (live coverage of events)

- Portable (can be listened to anywhere)

Television

Television combines audio and visual elements for powerful communication.

Ugandan Television Stations:

- **Public:** UBC TV
- **Private:** NTV Uganda, NBS TV, Bukedde TV, Spark TV, Top TV
- **Pay TV:** DStv, GoTV, StarTimes

Advantages of Television:

- Combines sight, sound, and motion
- Wide reach
- Credibility through visual evidence
- Entertainment value
- Immediate coverage

Disadvantages:

- Requires electricity
- Expensive equipment
- Passive consumption
- Limited depth
- Commercial interruptions

C. DIGITAL/NEW MEDIA

Social Media Platforms

Platform	Primary Use	Popular in Uganda?
Facebook	Connecting with friends, sharing updates	Very popular across all ages
WhatsApp	Instant messaging, group communication	Extremely popular for groups and broadcasts
Twitter/X	Short updates, news, public	Popular among youth, journalists,

	discussion	politicians
Instagram	Photo and video sharing	Growing among young people
TikTok	Short-form videos	Very popular among teenagers
YouTube	Video content	Used for tutorials, entertainment, news
LinkedIn	Professional networking	Growing among professionals

Websites and Blogs

- Information portals for organizations, news outlets, individuals
- Allow detailed content with multimedia elements
- Can be updated instantly

Podcasts

- Audio programmes available for download or streaming
- Growing in Uganda (e.g., The OPP Podcast, Agataliko Nfuufu)
- Allow in-depth discussion of specific topics

Streaming Services

- Video-on-demand platforms
- **Ugandan examples:** Pearl Magic Prime, Africa Magic
- International: Netflix, YouTube, Amazon Prime

Email

- Electronic mail for personal and professional communication
- Allows attachments, detailed messages, permanent records

Advantages of Digital Media:

- Instant communication
- Global reach
- Interactive (two-way communication)
- Multimedia capabilities
- Low cost
- Easily updated
- Targeted audiences

Disadvantages of Digital Media:

- Requires internet access
- Digital divide (not everyone has access)
- Information overload
- Fake news and misinformation
- Privacy concerns
- Addiction and distraction

D. TRADITIONAL MEDIA IN UGANDA

Traditional media remain vital in Ugandan communication, especially in rural areas.

Town Criers

- Individuals who make public announcements in villages
- Used for community meetings, important news, emergency alerts

Drums

- Used to convey messages across distances
- Different rhythms mean different messages (celebration, danger, meeting)

Oral Storytelling

- Elders sharing history, wisdom, and entertainment
- Preserves culture and traditions
- Passes knowledge between generations

Community Meetings (Barazas)

- Gatherings where leaders address communities
- Two-way communication allows questions and feedback

Value of Traditional Media:

- Accessible to all (no technology required)
- Culturally appropriate
- Builds community cohesion
- Trusted by communities
- Works where modern media doesn't

1.8 THE VALUE OF MEDIA IN SOCIETY

A. INFORMATION AND EDUCATION

1. News and Current Affairs
Media keeps citizens informed about local, national, and international events.

Example: During the COVID-19 pandemic, Ugandan media outlets provided daily updates on case numbers, Ministry of Health guidelines, and vaccination information. Radio stations broadcast in multiple languages to ensure all communities understood prevention measures.

2. Educational Content
Media delivers educational programmes and materials.

Example: During school closures, UBC and other stations broadcast educational programmes for students. The "School on Air" initiative allowed students to continue learning via radio. YouTube channels provide tutorials on various subjects.

3. Public Awareness Campaigns
Media spreads important public information.

Example: The Uganda Communications Commission runs campaigns about responsible internet use. Ministry of Health campaigns on malaria prevention, HIV/AIDS awareness, and maternal health use multiple media platforms.

B. SOCIAL AND CULTURAL FUNCTIONS

1. Cultural Preservation
Media documents and transmits cultural practices, languages, and traditions.

Example: Vernacular radio stations broadcast programmes in local languages, featuring traditional music, stories, and discussions about cultural practices. This helps preserve languages that might otherwise be lost.

2. Social Connection
Media connects people across distances.

Example: WhatsApp groups keep families, classmates, and community members connected. A student at boarding school can maintain contact with family through phone calls and messages. Social media helps diaspora Ugandans stay connected to home.

3. Entertainment
Media provides relaxation and enjoyment.

Example: Ugandan musicians use radio, TV, and streaming platforms to share their work. Comedians like Salvador and Anne Kansiime reach audiences through YouTube and TV. Local films (Ugawood) entertain and tell Ugandan stories.

C. POLITICAL AND DEMOCRATIC FUNCTIONS

1. Civic Education
Media educates citizens about their rights, responsibilities, and the political process.

Example: Before elections, media outlets explain voting procedures, candidate platforms, and the importance of participation. They may host debates where citizens can hear candidates discuss issues.

2. Public Participation
Media provides platforms for citizens to express opinions.

Example: Radio talk shows allow listeners to call in and discuss issues affecting their communities. Social media enables public discourse on national matters. Letters to the editor in newspapers give voice to ordinary citizens.

3. Government Accountability
Media monitors government actions and exposes wrongdoing.

Example: Investigative journalism has exposed corruption in government projects. Media coverage of the "Iron Sheets Scandal" led to investigations and accountability. This watchdog function is essential for democracy.

4. Platform for Diverse Voices
Media gives voice to different groups in society.

Example: Community radio stations broadcast programmes for women, youth, farmers, and other groups. Social media allows marginalized groups to organize and advocate for their rights.

D. ECONOMIC FUNCTIONS

1. Advertising and Marketing
Media helps businesses reach customers.

Example: A small business in Kampala can advertise on radio to reach potential customers. Social media advertising allows targeting specific demographics. Classified ads in newspapers help people find jobs, housing, and services.

2. Employment Opportunities
Media connects job seekers with employers.

Example: Newspapers carry job advertisements. LinkedIn and other professional networks help people find employment. Company websites post career opportunities.

3. Market Information
Media provides information essential for economic activity.

Example: Farmers listen to radio programmes that give current market prices for produce. Business news helps entrepreneurs make informed decisions. Financial media provides information for investors.

4. Business Networking
Media facilitates connections between businesses.

Example: Business publications feature profiles of companies and entrepreneurs. Industry-specific media helps professionals stay informed about their sectors. Trade fairs are promoted through various media.

E. EMERGENCY AND CRISIS COMMUNICATION

1. Disaster Alerts
Media warns communities about impending dangers.

Example: When Lake Victoria experiences storms, radio stations broadcast warnings to fishermen. During the 2022 Ebola outbreak in Mubende, media spread information about symptoms and prevention.

2. Coordination During Emergencies
Media helps coordinate response efforts.

Example: During floods in eastern Uganda, radio stations broadcast information about evacuation centers, relief distribution points, and missing persons.

3. Public Safety Information
Media educates about safety measures.

Example: Road safety campaigns during festive seasons. Information about crime prevention. Health and safety guidelines for various activities.

1.9 CHALLENGES AND CONCERNS WITH MEDIA

A. Misinformation and Disinformation

- **Misinformation:** False information shared without harmful intent
- **Disinformation:** Deliberately false information shared to deceive

Example: During the COVID-19 pandemic, false information circulated about "cures" and vaccines, leading some people to avoid vaccination. Social media amplified these falsehoods.

B. Media Bias

- Some media outlets present information with political or commercial bias
- Can manipulate public opinion

Example: During elections, some media may favor certain candidates, presenting their opponents negatively or ignoring them entirely.

C. Digital Divide

- Not everyone has equal access to digital media
- Rural areas, poor communities, older people may be excluded

Example: While Kampala has widespread internet access, many rural areas lack connectivity. Students in areas without internet cannot access online learning resources.

D. Privacy Concerns

- Personal information can be collected and misused
- Surveillance and data tracking

Example: Social media platforms collect vast amounts of user data, which can be used for targeted advertising or potentially shared without consent.

E. Media Ownership Concentration

- Few individuals or companies owning multiple media outlets
- Limits diversity of voices and perspectives

Example: In Uganda, some businesspeople own multiple media houses, potentially influencing what news is covered and how.

F. Addiction and Mental Health

- Excessive media use can affect mental health
- Social media can cause anxiety, depression, and FOMO (fear of missing out)

Example: Studies show that heavy social media use among teenagers is linked to decreased self-esteem and increased anxiety, as they compare themselves to curated, unrealistic portrayals of others' lives.

LEARNING OUTCOME 1(c): Apply skills of communication and relevant content to argue cases in given contexts (s, gs)

1.10 ARGUMENTATION AND DEBATE SKILLS

What is an Argument?

An argument is a reasoned, logical way of demonstrating that a particular position is true, valid, or preferable to alternatives. It is not simply a disagreement or quarrel, but a structured presentation of claims supported by evidence.

Components of a Strong Argument:

Component	Description	Example
Claim	The main point or position	"Social media does more harm than good among students."
Evidence	Facts, data, examples supporting the claim	"Studies show that students who spend more than 3 hours daily on social media have lower grades."
Warrant	Explanation of how evidence supports the claim	"This is because social media distracts from study time and disrupts concentration."
Counter-argument	Acknowledging opposing views	"Some argue that social media helps students connect with educational resources."
Rebuttal	Responding to counter-arguments	"However, the educational benefits are outweighed by the distraction, and educational content can be accessed through focused platforms."

1.11 TYPES OF DEBATE MOTIONS

Debate motions (topics) can be categorized in different ways:

By Format:

- **This House believes that...** (British Parliamentary style)
- **Should...** (Question format)

- **Is...** (Statement to be evaluated)

By Content Category:

Category	Example Motions
Education	"This House believes that boarding schools are better than day schools."
Technology	"Social media does more harm than good among youth."
Politics	"Uganda should adopt a federal system of government."
Social Issues	"The legal drinking age should be raised to 21."
Environment	"Economic development should take priority over environmental protection."
Health	"Traditional medicine is more effective than modern medicine."
Culture	"Globalization is destroying African cultures."
Economics	"Uganda should prioritize tourism over agriculture."

1.12 STRUCTURE OF A DEBATE SPEECH

First Speaker (Proposition/Government) - Usually defines the motion and presents first main point

1. INTRODUCTION (30 seconds)
   - Address the chair, judges, audience
   - State the motion
   - Define key terms

2. THESIS STATEMENT
   - State your team's position clearly

3. TEAM SPLIT
   - Explain what each speaker will cover

4. FIRST ARGUMENT
   - Point
   - Explanation

- Evidence
- Link back to motion

5. CONCLUSION
- Summarize main point
- Signal end

Example First Speaker Speech (Proposition):

text

Good morning, Mr. Chairman, honorable judges, members of the opposing team, and fellow students. The motion before us today is: "This House believes that boarding schools are better than day schools."

I shall define "boarding schools" as educational institutions where students reside during the term, and "day schools" as those where students commute daily from home. My team and I will be arguing that boarding schools offer superior educational outcomes and holistic development.

I will be addressing the academic advantages of boarding schools. My second speaker will discuss character development and discipline. Our third speaker will address counter-arguments and summarize our case.

My first point: Boarding schools provide a more conducive learning environment. In boarding schools, students have dedicated study time in the evenings, supervised by teachers. According to research by the Uganda National Examinations Board, students from boarding schools consistently achieve higher scores in national exams. This is because they have access to resources like libraries and laboratories after regular school hours, unlike day students who go home where they may lack such facilities or face domestic distractions.

Furthermore, boarding eliminates long commutes. A day student in Kampala may spend two to three hours daily traveling, time that could be spent studying or resting. Over a term, this amounts to hundreds of lost hours.

Therefore, Mr. Chairman, the structured environment and extended learning time in boarding schools clearly lead to better academic outcomes. I rest my case.

1.13 DEVELOPING ARGUMENTS FOR DEBATE

Using the AREL Framework:

Element	What to do	Example
Assertion	Make your point clearly	"Social media causes mental health problems among teenagers."
Reason	Explain WHY	"This is because it creates unrealistic expectations and constant social comparison."
Evidence	Support with facts	"A 2023 study by the Uganda Child Helpline found that 67% of teenage callers reporting anxiety cited social media as a contributing factor."
Link	Connect back to motion	"Therefore, given this significant harm to youth mental health, we must conclude that social media does more harm than good."

1.14 PREPARING FOR DEBATE

Step 1: Analyze the Motion

- Define key terms
- Identify what you need to prove
- Consider the scope and limitations

Step 2: Brainstorm Arguments

- List all possible arguments for your side
- Research to find evidence
- Anticipate opposing arguments

Step 3: Research

- Gather facts, statistics, examples, expert opinions
- Use credible sources (academic studies, government reports, reputable news)
- Note your sources for reference

Step 4: Structure Your Speech

- Organize arguments logically
- Prepare introduction and conclusion
- Create note cards with key points

Step 5: Practice

- Time your speech
- Practice delivery (eye contact, gestures, voice modulation)
- Anticipate questions and prepare responses

1.15 SAMPLE DEBATE PREPARATION

Motion: "This House believes that Uganda should prioritize tourism over agriculture for economic development."

Team Position: Proposition (Arguing FOR prioritizing tourism)

Research Notes:

Topic	Information Found	Source
Tourism revenue	Uganda earned $1.6 billion from tourism in 2023	Uganda Tourism Board Annual Report 2023
Employment	Tourism employs directly and indirectly 667,000 Ugandans	Ministry of Tourism Statistics
Growth rate	Tourism sector growing at 7% annually	World Bank Report
Agriculture challenges	Only 30% of arable land cultivated, post-harvest losses at 40%	Ministry of Agriculture
Agriculture employment	Employs 65% of population but contributes only 24% to GDP	UBOS Statistical Abstract

Arguments Developed:

Argument 1: Higher Economic Returns

- Assertion: Tourism generates more revenue per unit of investment

- Reason: Tourism leverages Uganda's natural assets (wildlife, scenery) with minimal infrastructure
- Evidence: Tourism contributes 7% to GDP despite using only 2% of land, while agriculture uses 70% of land for 24% of GDP
- Link: Therefore, prioritizing tourism makes better use of our resources

Argument 2: Employment Quality

- Assertion: Tourism creates better jobs with higher incomes
- Reason: Tourism jobs are in services sector with better wages and conditions
- Evidence: Average tourism worker earns 2.5 times agricultural worker (UBOS data)
- Link: Better jobs mean improved living standards for Ugandans

Argument 3: Sustainable Development

- Assertion: Tourism encourages conservation rather than exploitation
- Reason: Wildlife and nature become economically valuable alive, not dead
- Evidence: Gorilla tourism has funded conservation and communities earn from protection
- Link: This creates sustainable development rather than resource depletion

Argument 4: Diversification

- Assertion: Tourism diversifies economy away from rain-dependent agriculture
- Reason: Climate change makes rain-fed agriculture increasingly unreliable
- Evidence: Droughts in 2022-2023 caused 30% drop in crop production
- Link: Tourism provides climate-resilient economic alternative

Anticipated Opposing Arguments:

Opposing Argument	Rebuttal
Agriculture feeds people	Tourism revenue can import food while using land efficiently
Most Ugandans are farmers	They can transition to tourism-related work with training
Tourism is vulnerable to global shocks	Agriculture equally vulnerable to climate and price shocks
Tourism benefits only a few areas	Can be developed across country (mountains, lakes, culture)

1.16 PREPARING TARGETED TEXTS

Activity: Prepare a text targeting a specific audience

Scenario: You need to write a letter to the Local Council Chairperson requesting that the community construct a borehole (water well) in your village.

Considerations by Audience:

- **Audience:** Local Council Chairperson (adult, community leader, busy, decision-maker)
- **Purpose:** Persuade to take action
- **Tone:** Respectful, formal, practical
- **Content:** Problem, evidence, solution, benefits, feasibility

Sample Letter:

[Your Name]
[Your Village]
[Your Parish]
[Date]

The Chairperson
Local Council I
[Village/Parish]

Dear Mr./Madam Chairperson,

RE: **REQUEST FOR CONSTRUCTION OF A COMMUNITY BOREHOLE IN [VILLAGE NAME]**

I am a resident of [Village Name] and a student at [School Name]. I write this letter on behalf of concerned community members regarding the critical water shortage our village currently faces.

The Problem

Our village of approximately 300 households currently depends on one protected spring and two unprotected streams for all water needs. During the dry season (December to March), the spring reduces to a trickle, forcing residents, especially women and children, to walk up to 5 kilometers to access water from neighboring villages. This consumes 3-4 hours daily that could be used for productive activities or education.

Health Concerns

The unprotected streams we rely on are shared with livestock and contaminated with runoff from nearby gardens. The Village Health Team reports that in 2024, our village recorded 47 cases of waterborne diseases including typhoid and dysentery. Children under five are most affected, with 12 cases of severe diarrhea requiring hospitalization. Treatment costs strain family resources and time.

Education Impact

Girls in our village miss an average of 5 school days per month during the dry season due to water collection responsibilities. Three girls dropped out of school entirely last year, citing the burden of walking long distances for water as a primary reason.

The Solution

A community borehole, drilled to a depth of approximately 60 meters, would provide safe, reliable water throughout the year. The estimated cost is 25 million shillings, including drilling, pump installation, and protective casing.

Community Contribution

The community is prepared to contribute:
- 5 million shillings in cash collected through household contributions
- Local materials (sand, stones, bricks) valued at 3 million shillings
- Unskilled labor for construction and trench digging
- Formation of a Water User Committee for ongoing maintenance

Request

We respectfully request that the Local Council:
1. Allocate 15 million shillings from the council development fund
2. Assist us in applying for support from the Ministry of Water and Environment
3. Provide technical oversight for the project
4. Connect us with NGOs working on water access in our district

Conclusion

Access to clean water is not a luxury but a basic human right and a prerequisite for health, education, and economic development. Our community has demonstrated its commitment through the contributions we are prepared to make. We now seek your leadership to help us achieve this vital project.

Thank you for your consideration. We are available to meet with you at your convenience to discuss this proposal further.

Yours faithfully,

[Your Name]
[Your Contact]
[Community Member Representative]

CC: Parish Chief
Sub-county Chief
Area Member of Parliament

Key Features of This Letter:

- Formal structure with proper addressing
- Clear problem statement with evidence
- Data and specific examples
- Practical solution with cost estimate
- Community commitment demonstrated
- Specific request
- Respectful tone throughout
- Call to action

SENIOR FIVE TERM 2

TOPIC 2: LANGUAGE AND LITERATURE

Duration: 27 Periods

Competency: The learner demonstrates appreciation of different language categories, policies, and different literature forms in the local community by applying them to come up with write-ups using appropriate styles.

LEARNING OUTCOME 2(a): Understand the area, indigenous, first, second, and foreign language as used in their community (k, u)

2.1 UNDERSTANDING LANGUAGE CATEGORIES

Language is a complex human phenomenon that can be categorized in multiple ways based on how, when, and where it is acquired and used.

A. INDIGENOUS LANGUAGE / MOTHER TONGUE

Definition: An indigenous language is a language that is native to a particular region and spoken by the people who originally inhabited that area. It is often the first language learned by children from that community.

Characteristics:

- Originated in the specific region where it is spoken

- Carries the culture, traditions, and worldview of that community
- Often has oral traditions (stories, proverbs, songs) attached to it
- May have no written form or recently developed writing system
- Threatened in some areas by dominant languages

Examples in Uganda:

Language	Region	Approximate Speakers
Luganda	Central Region	5-6 million (first language)
Runyankore-Rukiga	Western Region	3-4 million
Luo (Acholi, Lango)	Northern Region	2-3 million
Ateso	Eastern Region	1.5-2 million
Lugbara	West Nile	1-1.5 million
Lusoga	Busoga Region	2-3 million

Importance of Indigenous Languages:

1. **Cultural Identity:** They connect people to their heritage and ancestors
2. **Knowledge Preservation:** Traditional knowledge (medicine, farming, customs) is encoded in indigenous languages
3. **Cognitive Development:** Children learn best in their mother tongue
4. **Community Cohesion:** Strengthens bonds within communities
5. **Artistic Expression:** Poetry, proverbs, songs, and stories are richest in indigenous languages

Example of Indigenous Language Use:

In a village in western Uganda, elders conduct meetings in Runyankore. When discussing traditional medicine, they use terms that have no direct English translation—words describing specific plants, preparation methods, and spiritual aspects of healing. A young person who has lost fluency in Runyankore cannot fully participate in these discussions or inherit this knowledge.

B. AREA LANGUAGE

Definition: An area language is a language that serves as a lingua franca (common language) in a particular geographic region, often used for trade, administration, or inter-ethnic communication.

Characteristics:

- May be indigenous to the area or introduced
- Used by people who may have different mother tongues
- Often simplified compared to the full language
- Facilitates communication across ethnic groups

Examples in Uganda:

Area Language	Region	Used By
Luganda	Central, parts of Eastern	Baganda and non-Baganda living in the region
Kiswahili	Urban areas, markets, military	Various ethnic groups
English	Formal settings nationwide	Educated population, government

Area Language vs. Indigenous Language:

Aspect	Indigenous Language	Area Language
Origin	Native to the area	May be native or introduced
Speakers	Ethnic community	Multiple ethnicities
Depth	Full cultural expression	Often functional/basic
Identity marker	Yes	No
Example	Luganda for Baganda	Luganda for non-Baganda in Kampala

Example of Area Language Use:

In Kampala's Owino market, a trader from the east (speaking Lusoga at home) interacts with a customer from the north (speaking Acholi at home) using Luganda, which both have learned as a second language. They use simplified Luganda focused on prices,

quantities, and basic negotiation—functional communication without deep cultural content.

C. FIRST LANGUAGE (L1)

Definition: A first language (also called native language or mother tongue) is the language a person learns from birth and typically has the strongest command of. For most people, this is their indigenous language.

Characteristics:

- Acquired naturally without formal instruction
- Usually the language of home and family
- The language in which a person thinks most naturally
- Often emotionally connected (language of feelings, dreams, intimate relationships)

Example: A child born to Acholi parents in Gulu grows up speaking Luo at home with family. This is their first language they learn it through natural interaction before starting school.

D. SECOND LANGUAGE (L2)

Definition: A second language is a language learned after the first language, often through formal education or exposure in the environment. It may be learned for practical purposes rather than identity reasons.

Characteristics:

- Learned after first language is established
- Usually acquired through formal instruction (though can be learned naturally)
- May not reach the same proficiency level as L1
- Often used for specific domains (education, work, official business)

Examples in Uganda:

- A Mukiga student learns English at school (second language)
- A Langi living in Kampala learns Luganda for market interactions (second language)
- A Muganda learns Kiswahili for military service (second language)

E. FOREIGN LANGUAGE

Definition: A foreign language is a language that is not native to the country and has no official status, but is learned for specific purposes such as international communication, business, or academic study.

Characteristics:

- Not widely spoken in the local community
- Learned for instrumental purposes
- Often associated with international opportunities
- Requires formal instruction

Examples in Uganda:

Foreign Language	Where Learned	Purpose
French	Schools, Alliance Française	Regional communication, OAU, job opportunities
German	Goethe-Zentrum, universities	Study in Germany, business
Chinese (Mandarin)	Confucius Institute	Business with China, scholarships
Arabic	Islamic institutions, some schools	Religious study, regional trade
Spanish	Language institutes	Travel, business, cultural interest

Distinguishing Foreign vs. Second Language:

Aspect	Second Language	Foreign Language
Local presence	Widely used in community	Not widely used locally
Official status	May have official status	No official status
Exposure	Available in environment	Limited to classrooms

Motivation	Often necessity	Usually choice or opportunity

2.2 LANGUAGE IN THE UGANDAN CONTEXT

Uganda's Linguistic Landscape:

Uganda is one of the most linguistically diverse countries in Africa, with:

- 43 living languages (according to Ethnologue)
- 5 major language families (Bantu, Nilotic, Central Sudanic, Kuliak, Cushitic)
- Multiple language categories coexisting

Bantu Languages (Southern and Central Uganda):

- Luganda, Runyankore, Rukiga, Runyoro, Rutooro, Lusoga, Lugwere, etc.

Nilotic Languages (Northern and Eastern Uganda):

- Luo (Acholi, Alur, Lango), Ateso, Karamojong, Kumam, etc.

Central Sudanic Languages (West Nile):

- Lugbara, Madi, Aringa, etc.

Kuliak Languages (Karamoja):

- Ik (endangered), Soo, Nyang'i

2.3 DIFFERENCES BETWEEN LANGUAGE CATEGORIES

Comparison Table:

Feature	Indigenous Language	First Language	Second Language	Foreign Language	Area Language
How	By birth in	By birth	Through learning	Through	Through

acquired	community	(usually)		study	exposure
Proficiency level	Native	Native	Varies (basic to fluent)	Usually basic to intermediate	Functional
Emotional connection	Strong	Strong	Weak to moderate	Minimal	Minimal
Cultural carrier	Yes	Usually yes	Not necessarily	No	No
Identity marker	Yes	Yes	No	No	No
Official use	Sometimes	No	Often yes	Rarely	Sometimes
Geographic scope	Local region	Individual	National/regional	International	Regional

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2.4 PRACTICAL ANALYSIS: WRITING ABOUT LANGUAGE CATEGORIES

Sample Essay: The Role of Different Language Categories in Ugandan Society

THE INTERPLAY OF LANGUAGE CATEGORIES IN CONTEMPORARY UGANDA

Uganda's linguistic diversity, with over 40 living languages, creates a complex ecosystem where different language categories serve distinct but interconnected functions. Understanding these categories—indigenous, area, first, second, and foreign languages—is essential for appreciating how Ugandans navigate their multilingual reality.

Indigenous languages form the foundation of Uganda's linguistic heritage. Languages such as Luganda, Runyankore, Luo, and Ateso are not merely communication tools but repositories of cultural knowledge, historical memory, and community identity. When an Acholi elder tells stories under a tree, the Luo language carries nuances that no translation can capture—proverbs that encode wisdom, terms that describe traditional practices, and rhythms that connect listeners to generations past. However, many indigenous languages face

pressures from urbanization, education policies, and the prestige of global languages.

For most Ugandans, their first language is their indigenous language, learned naturally in the home from birth. This L1 shapes cognitive development and emotional expression. A child who learns math concepts first in Runyankore develops different mental frameworks than one who learns in English. Research consistently shows that initial education in the mother tongue leads to better learning outcomes, yet Uganda's education system has historically privileged English from early primary levels.

Area languages emerge from practical necessity in Uganda's multi-ethnic communities. In Kampala, Luganda serves as the dominant area language, used by Baganda and non-Baganda alike in markets, workplaces, and neighborhoods. A trader from Mbale may speak Lusoga at home but uses Luganda to conduct business in the city. Kiswahili functions as an area language in urban centers, the military, and increasingly in East African regional contexts. These area languages facilitate daily interaction across ethnic boundaries but rarely carry the deep cultural content of indigenous languages.

English occupies a unique position as Uganda's official language and the primary second language for most educated Ugandans. It is the language of government, courts, higher education, formal employment, and international communication. Proficiency in English often determines access to opportunities, creating a linguistic hierarchy where English speakers enjoy advantages over those limited to indigenous languages. This dynamic raises questions about equity and cultural preservation.

Foreign languages like French, Arabic, Chinese, and German represent Uganda's engagement with the wider world. A student learning Mandarin through the Confucius Institute seeks opportunities in trade with China. Another learning French prepares for roles in regional organizations or diplomacy. While these languages touch relatively few Ugandans compared to other categories, their importance grows with globalization.

The reality for most Ugandans is multilingualism—moving between language categories depending on context. The same person might speak Luo at home (indigenous L1), use Luganda in the market (area language), conduct business in English (second language), and study French for international opportunities

(foreign language). This linguistic dexterity is a strength, allowing Ugandans to navigate multiple worlds.

However, challenges persist. The dominance of English in education means many children learn in a language they don't speak at home, slowing their academic progress. Indigenous languages receive minimal institutional support, leading to language shift where younger generations prefer more prestigious languages. Policies that recognize the value of all language categories while providing practical pathways for Ugandans remain urgently needed.

Understanding language categories is not merely an academic exercise—it is essential for developing education policies that work, preserving cultural heritage, ensuring equitable access to opportunities, and building a society where linguistic diversity is seen as strength rather than obstacle.

LEARNING OUTCOME 2(b): Appreciate the different forms of literature (in the indigenous and foreign languages) used in specific circumstances (u, s, gs)

2.5 UNDERSTANDING LITERATURE

Definition of Literature:

Literature refers to written and oral works that possess artistic merit, using language creatively to express human experiences, emotions, ideas, and imagination. It reflects society, critiques it, and shapes how people understand themselves and their world.

Branches of Literature:

text



↓

- Folktales
- Myths
- Legends
- Proverbs
- Riddles
- Tongue twisters
- Songs
- Oral poetry

↓

- Prose (Novels, Short Stories)
- Poetry
- Drama (Plays)
- Essays
- Biographies
- Diaries
- Letters

2.6 FORMS OF WRITTEN LITERATURE

A. PROSE

Prose is written language in its ordinary form, without metrical structure. It follows natural speech patterns and grammatical structure.

i) Short Stories

Definition: A brief work of fiction that typically focuses on a single incident, character, or theme, and can be read in one sitting.

Characteristics:

- Limited number of characters (usually 1-5 main characters)
- Single plot line
- Covers a short time period
- Focuses on one central theme or conflict
- Typically 1,000 to 20,000 words

Structure of a Short Story:

Element	Description	Example from "The Bridge of Unity"
Exposition	Introduces characters, setting, background	Nakato's family, the river problem, village setting
Rising Action	Builds conflict and tension	Nakato's research, community skepticism, planning challenges

Climax	Turning point, moment of highest tension	The community completing the bridge, first crossing
Falling Action	Events after climax	Community celebration, Nakato writing her essay
Resolution	Conclusion, tying up loose ends	Nakato crosses bridge to sit exams, passes

Examples of Short Stories in Uganda:

- "The Gentle Giant of Kyambura" by Goretti Kyomuhendo
- "A Song of Welcome" by Monica Arac de Nyeko
- Collections in anthologies like "Summoning the Rains"

ii) Novels

Definition: Extended works of fiction with complex plots, multiple characters, developed themes, and usually divided into chapters.

Characteristics:

- Lengthy (40,000+ words)
- Multiple characters with development
- Subplots alongside main plot
- Exploration of multiple themes
- Can cover extended time periods

Ugandan Novels and Novelists:

Novel	Author	Themes
Song of Lawino	Okot p'Bitek	Culture clash, tradition vs. modernity
We Need New Names	NoViolet Bulawayo	Migration, identity, childhood
Kintu	Jennifer Nansubuga Makumbi	Identity, history, family, tradition
The First Daughter	Kalafati Epalata	Politics, family, ambition
Season of the Hen	Ester Mirembe	Rural life, womanhood

iii) Novellas

Shorter than novels but longer than short stories, typically 20,000-40,000 words.

B. DRAMA (PLAYS)

Definition: Literature written to be performed by actors on a stage before an audience. It consists primarily of dialogue and stage directions.

Elements of Drama:

Element	Description
Plot	Sequence of events
Characters	People in the play
Dialogue	Words spoken by characters
Stage Directions	Instructions for performance (movement, setting, lighting)
Acts and Scenes	Divisions of the play
Conflict	Central struggle driving the action
Theme	Central idea or message

Types of Drama:

Type	Characteristics	Example
Tragedy	Serious, somber theme; protagonist meets unhappy end	"The Tragedy of King Christophe" by Aimé Césaire
Comedy	Light, humorous; happy ending	"The Marriage of Anansewa" by Efua Sutherland
Tragicomedy	Mix of tragic and comic elements	"The Dilemma of a Ghost" by Ama Ata Aidoo
Historical Drama	Based on historical events	"The Trials of Dedan Kimathi" by Ngũgĩ wa Thiong'o
Musical	Includes songs and music	"Sarafina!" by Mbongeni Ngema

Ugandan Playwrights:

- Rose Mbowa (Mother Uganda and Her Children)
- John Ruganda (The Burdens, The Floods)
- Robert Serumaga (Renga Moi)
- Charles Mulekwa

C. POETRY

Definition: Literature that uses aesthetic and rhythmic qualities of language to evoke meanings and emotions, often employing meter, rhyme, and figurative language.

Elements of Poetry:

Element	Description	Example
Speaker	The voice in the poem (not necessarily poet)	In "The Dusty Path to Knowledge," speaker is a rural student
Imagery	Language that appeals to senses	"The lamp that lit my book last night"
Figurative Language	Metaphors, similes, personification	"The sun sank like a golden coin" (simile)
Rhyme	Repetition of similar sounds	"rise/eyes," "tread/head"
Rhythm	Pattern of stressed/unstressed syllables	Creates musical quality
Stanza	Group of lines forming a unit	Verses in the poem

Types of Poetry:

Type	Description	Example
Lyric	Expresses personal emotions or thoughts	"The Dusty Path to Knowledge"
Narrative	Tells a story	"The Song of Lawino"
Sonnet	14-line poem with specific rhyme scheme	Shakespeare's sonnets
Ode	Praises or celebrates a subject	"Ode to a Nightingale"
Elegy	Mourns the dead	"In Memory of W.B. Yeats"
Free Verse	No regular meter or rhyme	Much contemporary poetry

Ugandan Poets:

- Okot p'Bitek (Song of Lawino, Song of Ocol)
- Timothy Wangusa (A Pattern of Dust, Salutations)
- Susan Kiguli (The African Saga)
- Mildred Barya (The Price of Memory)
- Richard Muhumuza

D. SONGS AS LITERATURE

Definition: Songs are musical compositions with lyrics that can be analyzed as poetic texts. They combine literary elements with musical elements.

Songs as Literature:

Songs share many features with poetry:

- Lyrics use figurative language
- Often have rhyme and rhythm
- Express emotions and tell stories
- Reflect cultural values and social commentary

Categories of Songs:

Category	Purpose	Ugandan Examples
Traditional songs	Cultural preservation, rituals	Wedding songs, funeral dirges, work songs
Popular music	Entertainment, social commentary	Jose Chameleone, Bobi Wine, Cindy
Religious songs	Worship, spiritual expression	Gospel music, hymns
Political songs	Protest, mobilization, praise	Songs during elections, liberation songs
Children's songs	Education, play	Nursery rhymes, game songs

Analyzing a Song as Literature:

Song: "Tubonga Nawe" by Jose Chameleone

Literary elements:

- Repetition for emphasis ("Tubonga nawe, tubonga nawe")
- Metaphor (comparing love to journey)
- Cultural references (Ugandan life, struggles)
- Emotional expression (longing, hope)

E. SKITS

Definition: Short, humorous plays or performances, often with simple plots and minimal staging. Skits are typically performed in informal settings for entertainment or education.

Characteristics of Skits:

- Short duration (5-15 minutes)
- Small cast (2-6 characters)
- Simple plot with quick resolution
- Often humorous
- Minimal props and sets
- Can address serious topics lightly

Uses of Skits:

- Entertainment at events
- Educational messaging (health, social issues)
- Ice-breakers in meetings
- Church and community performances
- School drama festivals

Example: "The Group Work Disaster" skit earlier in these notes demonstrates:

- Small cast (4 students)
- Simple school setting
- Humorous elements (Moses on phone)
- Educational message about communication and teamwork
- Quick resolution

2.7 WRITING IN INDIGENOUS VS. FOREIGN LANGUAGES

The Case for Writing in Indigenous Languages:

Argument	Explanation	Example
Cultural authenticity	Captures nuances untranslatable in other languages	Proverbs, idioms lose meaning in translation

Identity expression	Affirms cultural identity and pride	Writers like Okot p'Bitek chose to write in Luo
Accessibility	Reaches those not fluent in foreign languages	Rural audiences, elders
Language preservation	Contributes to keeping languages alive	Literature creates written records
Unique literary traditions	Develops forms specific to the culture	Oral poetry traditions

The Case for Writing in Foreign Languages:

Argument	Explanation	Example
Wider audience	Reaches readers across language boundaries	Ngũgĩ wa Thiong'o later wrote in English to reach more Africans
International recognition	Access to global publishing, prizes	Ugandan authors published internationally
Educational system	Aligns with language of education	Students read in English at school
Resource availability	More publishing opportunities	Limited publishing in indigenous languages
Cross-cultural dialogue	Participates in global conversations	Address universal themes for global audience

Notable Approaches:

Some writers choose bilingual or hybrid approaches:

- Okot p'Bitek wrote "Song of Lawino" first in Luo, then translated himself
- Some poets incorporate indigenous words into English poems
- Oral performances often mix languages naturally

2.8 ANALYZING LITERATURE FOR SPECIFIC CIRCUMSTANCES

Different forms of literature are appropriate for different circumstances:

Circumstance	Appropriate Form	Why
Funeral	Elegy, dirge, oral poetry	Expresses grief, honors deceased
Wedding	Song, praise poetry	Celebrates union, blesses couple
Political rally	Political song, short speech, slogan	Mobilizes, unites, inspires
Classroom teaching	Short story, poem, skit	Engages, illustrates, entertains
Community meeting	Proverb, oral narrative	Shares wisdom, resolves conflict
Religious service	Hymn, religious poem, skit	Worships, teaches, inspires
Cultural festival	Traditional song, oral epic	Celebrates heritage, educates youth

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2.9 SAMPLE DEBATE: BEST FORM OF LITERATURE FOR A SPECIFIC PURPOSE

Motion: "This House believes that oral literature is more valuable than written literature for preserving Ugandan culture."

Proposition Arguments (For Oral Literature):

1. **Accessibility:** Oral literature reaches all community members regardless of literacy. In rural Uganda where literacy rates may be lower, elders can still transmit culture through storytelling.
2. **Participatory Nature:** Oral performance involves the community—call and response, audience participation, immediate feedback. This creates shared experience and collective memory.
3. **Living Tradition:** Oral literature evolves with the community. New proverbs emerge, stories adapt to contemporary circumstances, songs respond to current events. Written literature freezes culture at a moment.
4. **Indigenous Languages:** Oral literature thrives in indigenous languages, carrying authentic cultural expression that translations lose.
5. **Intergenerational Bonding:** When grandparents tell stories to grandchildren, relationships strengthen and knowledge passes naturally.

Opposition Arguments (For Written Literature):

1. **Permanence:** Written literature preserves culture permanently. When an elder dies, their unwritten stories die with them. Writing ensures future generations can access cultural knowledge.
2. **Standardization:** Writing creates standardized versions of stories, preventing distortion over time. This is important for historical accuracy.
3. **Global Reach:** Written literature can reach Ugandans in the diaspora, non-speakers of indigenous languages, and international audiences interested in Ugandan culture.
4. **Educational Integration:** Written texts can be used in schools systematically, ensuring all students access cultural knowledge.
5. **Reference and Study:** Scholars can analyze, compare, and document written literature, contributing to cultural preservation and academic understanding.

Resolution: Most cultures benefit from both forms—oral literature for living, evolving community practice, and written literature for preservation, study, and wider access.

LEARNING OUTCOME 2(c): Apply different styles and diction in a given context (u, s, gs)

2.10 UNDERSTANDING STYLE IN WRITING

Definition of Style:

Style is the distinctive way a writer uses language—the choices they make in words, sentence structure, imagery, and tone that create their unique voice and achieve specific effects.

2.11 ELEMENTS OF STYLE

A. Diction (Word Choice)

Diction refers to the writer's selection of words, which creates tone, conveys meaning precisely, and affects how readers respond.

Types of Diction:

Type	Characteristics	Example
Formal	Sophisticated vocabulary, no contractions, standard grammar	"The individual's response to adversity reveals character."
Informal	Everyday language, contractions, colloquial	"How you handle tough times shows who you really are."
Concrete	Specific, tangible words	"She held a red mango, its skin smooth and warm."
Abstract	Conceptual, intangible words	"She experienced joy and anticipation."
Denotative	Literal dictionary meaning	"The temperature reached 35 degrees."
Connotative	Words with emotional associations	"The sweltering heat oppressed the village."

Example of Diction Choices:

Instead of "good," consider:

- excellent (stronger positive)
- adequate (minimally acceptable)
- satisfactory (meeting requirements)
- commendable (praiseworthy)
- mediocre (barely acceptable, negative connotation)

B. Sentence Structure

How writers construct sentences affects rhythm, emphasis, and readability.

Types of Sentences:

Type	Structure	Effect

Simple	One independent clause	Direct, clear, emphatic
Compound	Two independent clauses joined	Shows relationship between equal ideas
Complex	Independent + dependent clause	Shows hierarchy of ideas
Compound-Complex	Multiple independent and dependent	Handles complex relationships
Periodic	Main idea at end	Creates suspense, emphasis
Cumulative	Main idea followed by details	Adds details, natural flow

Examples:

Simple: "The rain stopped."

Compound: "The rain stopped, and the sun emerged."

Complex: "When the rain finally stopped, the sun emerged."

Periodic: "After hours of relentless pounding that flooded the fields and frightened the children, the rain finally stopped."

Cumulative: "The rain stopped, its last drops glistening on leaves, the fresh smell of wet earth rising, and birds beginning to sing."

C. Tone

Tone is the writer's attitude toward the subject and audience, conveyed through word choice and sentence structure.

Tone	Characteristics	Example
Formal	Serious, professional	"The research indicates significant correlation."
Informal	Casual, conversational	"So here's what we found out."
Humorous	Playful, witty	"The mosquito, that tiny vampire, struck again."
Serious	Grave, weighty	"This is a matter of life and death."
Sarcastic	Mocking, ironic	"Oh great, another government promise."

Optimistic	Hopeful, positive	"Despite challenges, the future looks bright."
Pessimistic	Negative, despairing	"Nothing will change; we are doomed to repeat."
Objective	Neutral, unbiased	"The data shows X, while other data suggests Y."
Subjective	Personal, opinionated	"In my experience, this approach fails."

D. Imagery

Imagery uses language to create sensory experiences for readers—sight, sound, smell, taste, touch.

Types of Imagery:

Type	Sense	Example
Visual	Sight	"The sun set like a ball of fire behind the hills."
Auditory	Sound	"The leaves whispered secrets to the wind."
Olfactory	Smell	"The sweet aroma of matoke cooking filled the compound."
Gustatory	Taste	"The mango's sweetness burst on her tongue."
Tactile	Touch	"The rough bark scratched his palms as he climbed."
Kinesthetic	Movement	"The dancers swayed like grasses in the wind."
Organic	Internal feelings	"Her heart pounded with fear and excitement."

E. Figurative Language

Figurative language uses words in non-literal ways to create special effects.

Device	Definition	Example
Simile	Comparison using "like" or "as"	"Her voice was like honey, smooth and sweet."
Metaphor	Direct comparison without "like/as"	"His words were daggers piercing her heart."
Personification	Giving human qualities to non-	"The sun smiled down on the harvest."

	human	
Hyperbole	Exaggeration for effect	"I've told you a million times."
Understatement	Deliberate minimization	"The exam was a bit challenging" (after failing).
Irony	Contrast between expectation and reality	"The fire station burned down."
Symbolism	Object representing abstract idea	"The river symbolized life and renewal."
Alliteration	Repetition of initial sounds	"Peter Piper picked a peck of pickled peppers."
Assonance	Repetition of vowel sounds	"The rain in Spain falls mainly on the plain."
Onomatopoeia	Words that sound like their meaning	"The beans sizzled in the pan."

2.12 FACTORS INFLUENCING STYLE

A. Purpose of Writing

Purpose	Appropriate Style
To inform	Clear, straightforward, objective
To persuade	Emotive, rhetorical, compelling
To entertain	Creative, vivid, engaging
To instruct	Clear, sequential, directive
To reflect	Personal, contemplative, descriptive

B. Audience

Audience	Style Considerations
Children	Simple vocabulary, short sentences, engaging
Academics	Formal, specialized vocabulary, complex ideas
General public	Accessible, clear, engaging

Professionals	Technical terms, concise, precise
Mixed audience	Balanced, definitions for specialized terms

C. Context/Genre

Genre	Typical Style Features
Academic essay	Formal, objective, evidence-based
Newspaper article	Clear, concise, inverted pyramid
Personal letter	Warm, conversational, personal
Official report	Formal, structured, factual
Poem	Figurative, rhythmic, condensed
Short story	Narrative, descriptive, engaging

D. Writer's Voice

Every writer develops a unique voice through:

- Characteristic word choices
- Preferred sentence patterns
- Recurring themes and subjects
- Distinctive tone
- Personal experiences and perspective

2.13 ANALYZING STYLE IN TEXTS

Sample Text 1: Academic Style

The proliferation of mobile money services in Uganda has fundamentally altered financial inclusion patterns among rural populations. According to the Uganda Communications Commission's 2023 report, mobile money transactions increased

by 47% between 2021 and 2023, with rural users accounting for 56% of new
subscriptions. This growth correlates with decreased reliance on infor mal
savings mechanisms and increased household investment in agricultur al inputs.

Analysis:

- **Diction:** Formal, specialized ("proliferation," "financial inclusion," "correlates")
- **Sentence structure:** Complex, carefully constructed
- **Tone:** Objective, academic
- **Evidence:** Data cited, source provided
- **Purpose:** Inform and analyze b

Sample Text 2: Narrative Style

Aisha clutched her mother's hand as they approached the mobile money agent under the mango tree. She had never seen so many people crowded in one place in her village. The agent, a young man in a yellow MTN vest, smiled and gestured for them to step forward. "Welcome, Mama," he said, his voice warm like the afternoon sun. "You've come for the school fees?" Mama nodded, her eyes bright with hope she hadn't felt in months.

Analysis:

- **Diction:** Concrete, sensory ("clutched," "crowded," "warm like afternoon sun")
- **Imagery:** Visual (mango tree, yellow vest), auditory (voice), tactile (clutched)
- **Sentence structure:** Varied, engaging
- **Tone:** Warm, hopeful, personal
- **Purpose:** Engage and create empathy

Sample Text 3: Persuasive Style

Imagine a Uganda where no child misses school because their parents cannot afford fees. Imagine a Uganda where every farmer can access capital for seeds and equipment. Imagine a Uganda where emergencies don't mean destitution. This is not a fantasy—this is the Uganda that mobile money is building, one transaction at a time. But to realize this vision, we must expand network coverage to every sub-county and reduce transaction costs that still burden the poor. The future is in our hands. Will we grasp it?

Analysis:

- **Rhetorical devices:** Repetition ("Imagine a Uganda"), rhetorical question at end
- **Diction:** Emotive ("fantasy," "burden," "future")
- **Sentence structure:** Short, punchy sentences building to climax
- **Tone:** Passionate, urgent, hopeful
- **Purpose:** Persuade and motivate action

2.14 APPLYING STYLE IN DIFFERENT CONTEXTS

Exercise: Write about the same topic (access to clean water) in different styles for different contexts.

Context 1: Academic Report for Government Ministry

ACCESS TO IMPROVED WATER SOURCES IN RURAL UGANDA: A SITUATION ANALYSIS

Executive Summary

This report examines current access levels to improved water sources across Uganda's 135 districts, with particular focus on rural communities. Data from the Ministry of Water and Environment indicates that while national coverage stands at 67%, significant disparities exist between urban (89%) and rural (53%) populations. The findings suggest that infrastructure investment, maintenance capacity, and geographic factors significantly influence access patterns. Recommendations include targeted investment in 20 high-need districts

and strengthened community-based management structures.

Context 2: Fundraising Appeal Letter

Dear Friend of Uganda,

Can you imagine walking 5 kilometers every day, every single day, just to collect water for your family? For Grace, a 14-year-old girl in rural Kamuli, this is not imagination—it is her daily reality.

The walk takes three hours. Three hours she could spend studying. Three hours that leave her exhausted before school even begins. Three hours that expose her to dangers no child should face.

But you can change this. A gift of just $50 can help provide clean water access for a family. $500 can help install a community tap. $5,000 can help drill a borehole serving 300 families.

Grace dreams of becoming a teacher. With clean water, her dream can come true. Please give generously.

With hope and gratitude,
[Name]

Context 3: Poem for School Magazine

WATER SONG

She walks at dawn when stars still shine,
A jerrycan her daily shrine.
The path worn smooth by feet before,
She joins the line and waits some more.

The water comes, a muddy brown,
The only water in the town.
She lifts it to her aching head,
And turns toward home with heavy tread.

But in her dreams, she hears the sound
Of clean, clear water—holy ground—
Flowing from a tap nearby,
A miracle beneath the sky.

Until that day, she walks alone,
Her future heavy as a stone.
But hope still rises with the sun—
Her journey's not yet done, not done.

LEARNING OUTCOME 2(d): Understand language policies on official, national language, and language in education used within our country (k, u, s, v)

2.15 UNDERSTANDING LANGUAGE POLICY

Definition:

Language policy refers to the deliberate decisions made by governments and institutions about which languages will be used for official purposes, in education, and in public life. These policies shape how languages function in society and affect speakers of different languages.

2.16 OFFICIAL LANGUAGE

Definition:

An official language is a language given special legal status in a country, used for government business, legislation, courts, and official documents.

Uganda's Official Language: English

English is the sole official language of Uganda, a status inherited from British colonial rule and maintained after independence.

Functions of English as Official Language:

Domain	Use of English
Parliament	All debates, bills, and proceedings
Courts	All legal proceedings, judgments, documents
Government documents	Official communications, forms, publications
International relations	Diplomacy, treaties, foreign affairs
Higher education	University instruction, academic publishing

Reasons for Maintaining English as Official Language:

1. **Colonial legacy:** English was established during colonial administration
2. **Neutrality:** English doesn't favor any particular ethnic group (unlike choosing a local language)
3. **International communication:** English connects Uganda globally
4. **Educational continuity:** Secondary and tertiary education conducted in English
5. **Economic advantages:** English facilitates business and employment

Criticisms of English as Official Language:

1. **Access barriers:** Many Ugandans don't speak English fluently
2. **Democratic deficit:** Citizens can't fully participate in governance
3. **Educational challenges:** Children learn in language they don't speak at home
4. **Cultural disconnection:** English carries Western cultural assumptions
5. **Elite privilege:** English proficiency correlates with wealth and opportunity

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2.17 NATIONAL LANGUAGE

Definition:

A national language is a language that symbolizes a country's identity and is used for national integration, though it may not have official legal status. Some countries have multiple national languages.

Uganda's National Language(s):

Uganda's constitution recognizes the need for a national language but doesn't definitively declare one. However, Kiswahili has been promoted as a national language.

Kiswahili in Uganda:

Aspect	Status
Constitutional status	Recognized; to be promoted as national language
Current usage	Widely used in military, police, markets, urban areas
Education	Taught as subject in some schools; being expanded
Regional role	East African Community official language

Advantages of Kiswahili as National Language:

1. **Regional integration:** Official language of East African Community
2. **Neutrality:** Not associated with any single Ugandan ethnic group
3. **Existing usage:** Already spoken in many contexts
4. **Pan-African identity:** Connects Uganda to broader African identity
5. **Simpler grammar:** Easier for non-native speakers to learn than some languages

Challenges for Kiswahili:

1. **Limited penetration:** Not widely spoken in some regions (especially west)
2. **Colonial associations:** Some associate it with colonial-era askaris (soldiers)
3. **Resource needs:** Requires investment in teaching materials and teacher training
4. **Political will:** Implementation has been inconsistent

Other Candidates Historically Proposed:

- Luganda (dominant language, but opposed by other ethnic groups)
- English (already official, but foreign)

2.18 LANGUAGE IN EDUCATION / MEDIUM OF INSTRUCTION

Definition:

Language in education policy determines which languages are used as the medium of instruction (the language teachers use to teach subjects) and which are taught as subjects.

Uganda's Language in Education Policy:

The policy has evolved over time. The current policy (as of various education reforms) includes:

Level of Education	Medium of Instruction
Early Childhood Development (Pre-primary)	Mother tongue / Local language
Lower Primary (P1-P3)	Mother tongue / Local language
Upper Primary (P4-P7)	Transition to English
Secondary (S1-S6)	English
Tertiary/University	English

Language Subjects:

Level	Languages Taught
Primary	Mother tongue (as subject), English, Kiswahili (in some schools)
Secondary	English, Kiswahili, French, Arabic, Latin (in some schools), indigenous languages (optional)
University	Various languages depending on programs

Rationale for Mother Tongue Instruction in Early Primary:

1. **Cognitive development:** Children learn best in language they understand
2. **Smooth transition:** Builds foundation before introducing English
3. **Cultural connection:** Maintains connection to heritage
4. **Research evidence:** UNESCO and global research support mother tongue education
5. **Equity:** Benefits children whose home language matches school language

Challenges in Implementation:

Challenge	Description
Language diversity	Many schools have children from multiple language backgrounds
Materials	Insufficient learning materials in indigenous languages
Teacher training	Teachers unprepared to teach in mother tongue

Parental pressure	Parents often prefer English instruction
Orthography	Some languages lack standardized writing systems
Political sensitivity	Choosing which language in multilingual areas

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2.19 COMPARATIVE ANALYSIS: LANGUAGE POLICIES IN EAST AFRICA

Country	Official Language(s)	National Language(s)	Medium of Instruction
Uganda	English	Kiswahili (promoted)	Mother tongue early, then English
Kenya	English, Kiswahili	Kiswahili	Mother tongue early, then English
Tanzania	English, Kiswahili	Kiswahili	Kiswahili (primary), English (secondary)
Rwanda	English, French, Kinyarwanda	Kinyarwanda	Kinyarwanda primary, English secondary
Burundi	French, Kirundi, English	Kirundi	Kirundi primary, French/English secondary

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2.20 CRITIQUING LANGUAGE POLICIES

Arguments For Current Policies:

1. **Practicality:** English connects Uganda globally and provides economic opportunities
2. **Neutrality:** Avoids ethnic tensions that selecting a local language might cause
3. **Continuity:** Maintains established system with existing resources
4. **Access to knowledge:** English provides access to global scientific and academic knowledge

Arguments For Reform:

1. **Democratic participation:** Citizens need access to governance in languages they understand
2. **Educational quality:** Children learn better in mother tongue; early English may hinder learning
3. **Cultural preservation:** Current policies marginalize indigenous languages
4. **Equity:** English proficiency creates and reinforces class divisions
5. **Authenticity:** True national identity requires an indigenous national language

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2.21 SAMPLE DEBATE ON LANGUAGE POLICY

Motion: "This House believes that Uganda should adopt Kiswahili as the sole official language."

Proposition Arguments:

1. **African identity:** Replaces colonial language with indigenous African language
2. **Regional integration:** Aligns with EAC partners (Kenya, Tanzania use Kiswahili)
3. **Unity:** Kiswahili is relatively neutral among Uganda's ethnic groups
4. **Simpler learning:** Easier grammar than English for many Ugandans
5. **Cultural authenticity:** Represents African renaissance and self-determination

Opposition Arguments:

1. **Practical barriers:** Massive retraining needed for government, judiciary, education
2. **Limited current usage:** Many Ugandans (especially west) don't speak it
3. **International isolation:** Loses English advantage in global economy, academia
4. **Resource costs:** Billions needed for materials, training, implementation
5. **Not truly neutral:** Some communities (especially western Uganda) resist Kiswahili

Possible Compromise: Maintain English as official language, strengthen Kiswahili as national language, and implement mother tongue education more effectively.

TOPIC 3: EXTENDED ESSAY WRITING

Duration: 27 Periods

Competency: The learner produces an extended essay in relation to a given situation identified in their immediate community by applying relevant knowledge to address community challenges.

LEARNING OUTCOME 3(a): Comprehend the structure of an Extended Essay and the purpose (u, s)

3.1 WHAT IS AN EXTENDED ESSAY?

Definition:

An Extended Essay is a guided mini-research project through which students conduct a systematic study on a topic of interest and share their findings in a structured written format. It is typically 3,000-4,000 words in length.

Purpose of the Extended Essay:

1. **Develop research skills:** Learn how to investigate a topic systematically
2. **Apply knowledge:** Use classroom learning to address real-world questions
3. **Practice academic writing:** Develop skills in formal, structured writing
4. **Explore personal interests:** Investigate topics you care about
5. **Contribute to community:** Address issues affecting your local area
6. **Prepare for higher education:** Experience the type of writing required at university
7. **Demonstrate competencies:** Show ability to think critically, analyze, and communicate

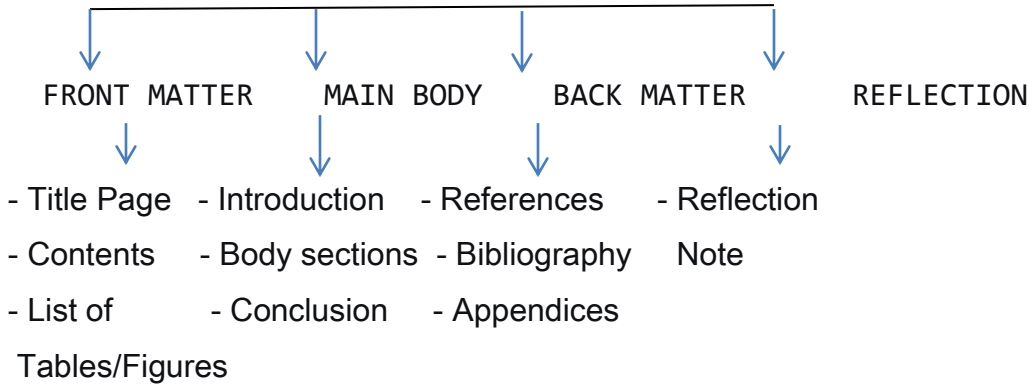
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3.2 STRUCTURE OF THE EXTENDED ESSAY

The Extended Essay has a specific structure that must be followed:

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EXTENDED ESSAY STRUCTURE



A. FRONT MATTER

i) Title Page / Cover Page

The title page is the first page and must include:

Element	Description	Example
Subject	General Paper	GENERAL PAPER
Title of Essay	Clear, specific topic	"The Impact of Mobile Money on Small-Scale Farmers in Kasese District"
Candidate Name	Your full name	NAMUTEBI SARAH
School Name	Your school	ST. MARY'S COLLEGE, KISUBI
Registration Number	Your school/ exam number	U1234/567
Year of Study	Current academic year	2025

Sample Title Page:

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GENERAL PAPER

THE IMPACT OF MOBILE MONEY ON SMALL-SCALE

FARMERS IN KASESE DISTRICT

NAMUTEBI SARAH

ST. MARY'S COLLEGE, KISUBI

REG NO: U1234/567

2025

ii) Contents Page / Table of Contents

The contents page lists all sections with page numbers:

text

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If your essay includes tables or figures, list them:

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B. MAIN BODY

i) Introduction

The introduction opens the essay and guides readers into your topic.

Elements of a Strong Introduction:

Element	What to Include	Example
Hook	Grab reader's attention	"In rural Kasese, where banks are few but mobile phones are many, a quiet revolution is changing how farmers do business."
Background	Context about topic	Mobile money was introduced in Uganda in 2009 and has since grown to reach over 25 million users.

Problem statement	What issue you're investigating	Despite mobile money's growth, little is known about its specific impact on small-scale farmers who form the backbone of Uganda's agriculture.
Purpose	Why you're doing this study	This study investigates how mobile money affects farmers' access to capital, input purchasing, and market participation.
Research questions	What you aim to answer	1. How do farmers in Kasese use mobile money? 2. What impact has mobile money had on their farming activities? 3. What challenges do they face?
Significance	Why it matters	Findings will inform policy on financial inclusion and agricultural development.

Sample Introduction:

CHAPTER ONE: INTRODUCTION

1.1 **Background to the Study**

In the hills of Kasese district, where the Rwenzori mountains cast long shadows over small farms, a quiet transformation is taking place. Here, where formal banks are as rare as snow on the equator, mobile money has become the financial lifeline for thousands of small-scale farmers.

Mobile money was introduced in Uganda in 2009 by mobile network operators, starting with MTN Mobile Money and followed by Airtel Money, M-Sente, and others. According to the Uganda Communications Commission, by 2024, over 30 million mobile money accounts were registered nationwide, processing transactions worth over 100 trillion shillings annually. This growth has been particularly notable in rural areas, where traditional banking infrastructure remains limited.

Small-scale farmers constitute approximately 70% of Uganda's agricultural sector, producing most of the food consumed in the country. However, these farmers face persistent challenges: limited access to credit, vulnerability to price fluctuations, difficulties in accessing markets, and the perennial problem of transporting cash safely. Mobile money promises to address some of these challenges by enabling digital transactions, savings, and access to financial

services through mobile phones.

1.2 Statement of the Problem

Despite the rapid expansion of mobile money services in Uganda, there is limited empirical evidence on how these services specifically impact small-scale farmers. While national statistics show increased transaction volumes and user numbers, they do not reveal whether farmers are actually benefiting—whether they can access inputs more easily, whether they receive better prices for their produce, or whether they are building financial resilience.

Preliminary observations in Kasese suggest that mobile money usage varies widely among farmers. Some enthusiastically adopt the technology, while others remain skeptical. Some report significant benefits; others complain of high fees and technical problems. Without systematic research, policymakers, agricultural extension workers, and mobile money providers lack the information needed to improve services and maximize benefits for this crucial sector.

1.3 Purpose of the Study

The purpose of this study is to investigate the impact of mobile money services on small-scale farmers in Kasese district, examining both benefits and challenges, and to make recommendations for improving financial inclusion in agricultural communities.

1.4 Research Questions

This study seeks to answer the following questions:

1. What is the extent and nature of mobile money usage among small-scale farmers in Kasese district?

2. How has mobile money affected farmers' access to agricultural inputs, credit, and markets?

3. What challenges do farmers face in using mobile money services?

4. What recommendations can be made to enhance the benefits of mobile money for small-scale farmers?

1.5 Scope of the Study

This study focuses on small-scale farmers in three sub-counties of Kasese district: Busongora, Kisinga, and Maliba. The research examines mobile money usage over the period 2020-2024. The study does not examine mobile money agents' perspectives in detail, nor does it cover large-scale commercial farmers.

1.6 Significance of the Study

This research will contribute to understanding how digital financial services can support agricultural development in Uganda. Findings may inform:
- Policy decisions by the Ministry of Agriculture and Ministry of ICT
- Service improvements by mobile money providers
- Training programs for farmers on using digital financial services
- Further academic research on financial inclusion in rural areas

---

ii) Body of the Essay

The body is the main part where you present your research, analysis, and arguments.

Typical Body Sections:

Section	Purpose	Content
Literature Review	Show what others have found	Review of books, articles, reports on your topic
Methodology	Explain how you did your research	Methods, tools, participants, procedures
Findings/Presentation	Show what you discovered	Data, quotes, observations, analysis
Discussion	Interpret your findings	What the findings mean, implications

Chapter Two: Literature Review

The literature review demonstrates that you understand what is already known about your topic.

Structure of Literature Review:

CHAPTER TWO: LITERATURE REVIEW

2.1 Introduction
- Brief overview of what this chapter covers

2.2 [Theme 1: Mobile Money in Uganda]
- History and development
- Current statistics and trends
- Regulatory framework

2.3 [Theme 2: Small-Scale Agriculture in Uganda]
- Characteristics of small-scale farmers
- Challenges faced
- Role in food security and economy

2.4 [Theme 3: Financial Inclusion and Agriculture]
- Link between financial access and agricultural productivity
- Studies from other countries
- Ugandan studies (if any)

2.5 [Theme 4: Benefits and Challenges of Mobile Money for Farmers]
- Documented benefits (savings, remittances, payments)
- Documented challenges (fees, literacy, network issues)

2.6 Summary
- Gaps in existing knowledge
- How your study addresses these gaps

Sample Literature Review Excerpt:

text

2.2 Mobile Money in Uganda: A Review

Mobile money has transformed financial services in Uganda since its introduction in 2009. According to the Bank of Uganda (2023), the number of registered mobile money accounts grew from 5 million in 2012 to over 30 million by 2023, with

active users averaging 12 million monthly. Transaction values increased from 10 trillion shillings in 2015 to 105 trillion in 2023, indicating deep penetration into economic activities.

Jack and Suri (2019), in their study of mobile money across East Africa, found that mobile money reduced transaction costs, increased savings, and improved household resilience to shocks. In Kenya, where M-PESA pioneered the model, research showed that access to mobile money lifted 2% of households out of poverty (Suri & Jack, 2016).

In Uganda specifically, studies have examined mobile money's role in various sectors. Mwangi and colleagues (2021) found that mobile money users in urban areas had higher savings rates than non-users. However, rural studies remain limited. Kiconco (2022) studied mobile money agents in Masaka district and found that while the service created employment, agents faced challenges including liquidity management and security concerns.

The regulatory environment has evolved alongside the industry. The National Payment Systems Act (2020) provided a legal framework for mobile money operations, requiring interoperability between providers and consumer protection measures. Despite this framework, concerns persist about data privacy, fraud, and the high cost of transactions for low-income users (Uganda Consumer Protection Association, 2023).

Chapter Three: Methodology

The methodology explains exactly how you conducted your research.

Elements of Methodology:

Element	Description	Example
Research Design	Overall approach	Mixed methods (quantitative and qualitative)
Study Area	Where research took place	Three sub-counties in Kasese district
Population	Who you're studying	Small-scale farmers (1,500 estimated)
Sample	Who you actually studied	100 farmers surveyed, 15 interviewed
Sampling Method	How you selected participants	Stratified random sampling by sub-county

Data Collection Methods	How you gathered information	Questionnaires, interviews, observation
Data Analysis	How you processed information	Descriptive statistics, thematic analysis
Ethical Considerations	How you protected participants	Informed consent, anonymity, confidentiality

Sample Methodology Excerpt:

CHAPTER THREE: METHODOLOGY

3.1 Introduction

This chapter describes the methods used to conduct this research, including the research design, study area, population, sample, data collection techniques, and data analysis procedures.

3.2 Research Design

This study employed a mixed-methods research design, combining quantitative and qualitative approaches. The quantitative component involved a survey of 100 farmers to gather numerical data on mobile money usage patterns, while the qualitative component included in-depth interviews with 15 farmers to explore their experiences, perceptions, and challenges in detail. This combination allows for both breadth (understanding general patterns) and depth (understanding individual experiences).

3.3 Study Area

The research was conducted in Kasese district, Western Uganda, specifically in three sub-counties: Busongora, Kisinga, and Maliba. Kasese was selected because:
- It has a high concentration of small-scale farmers
- Mobile money services are widely available
- The district represents both opportunities (near urban centers) and challenges (remote areas with poor network)
- The researcher has familiarity with the area, facilitating access

3.4 Population and Sample

The target population was small-scale farmers (cultivating less than 2 hectares) in the three sub-counties, estimated at approximately 1,500 households.

From this population, a sample of 100 farmers was selected using stratified random sampling. Sub-counties formed the strata, with sample size proportional to estimated population:

- Busongora: 40 farmers (estimated 600 households)
- Kisinga: 35 farmers (estimated 500 households)
- Maliba: 25 farmers (estimated 400 households)

Within each sub-county, farmers were randomly selected from village lists provided by local agricultural extension officers.

For the qualitative component, 15 farmers (5 from each sub-county) were purposively selected from survey respondents who indicated willingness to participate in interviews, ensuring diversity in age, gender, and mobile money usage patterns.

3.5 Data Collection Methods

Questionnaire: A structured questionnaire was developed with both closed-ended questions (multiple choice, Likert scale) and open-ended questions. The questionnaire covered:
- Demographic information (age, gender, education, farm size)
- Mobile money usage (frequency, types of transactions, amounts)
- Perceived impacts (access to inputs, savings, markets)
- Challenges faced

The questionnaire was translated into Lukonzo (local language) and pre-tested with 10 farmers in a pilot study, leading to minor revisions for clarity.

Interviews: Semi-structured interview guides were used for in-depth interviews with 15 farmers. Interviews explored:
- Farmers' history with mobile money
- Specific examples of how mobile money helped or hindered
- Stories of successes and failures

- Suggestions for improvement

Interviews were conducted in Lukonzo, audio-recorded with permission, and later transcribed and translated into English.

Observation: The researcher observed mobile money transactions at five agent locations, noting waiting times, interactions, and any problems observed.

3.6 Data Analysis

Quantitative data from questionnaires were entered into Microsoft Excel and analyzed using descriptive statistics (frequencies, percentages, means) and presented in tables and charts.

Qualitative data from interviews were analyzed using thematic analysis: transcripts were read repeatedly, codes were developed, and themes were identified. Direct quotes from participants are used in the findings to illustrate key points.

3.7 Ethical Considerations

This research adhered to ethical principles:
- Informed consent: All participants were informed about the purpose of the research and their rights, and signed consent forms
- Anonymity: Participants' names are not used; pseudonyms or codes are used
- Confidentiality: Data is stored securely and only accessible to the researcher
- Voluntary participation: Participants could withdraw at any time without penalty
- Do no harm: The research avoided causing any distress or disadvantage to participants

Chapter Four: Findings

This chapter presents what you discovered through your research.

Structure for Findings Chapter:

CHAPTER FOUR: PRESENTATION AND ANALYSIS OF FINDINGS

4.1 Introduction

- Brief overview of chapter contents

4.2 Demographic Characteristics of Respondents
- Tables showing age, gender, education, farm size, etc.
- Description of the sample

4.3 Mobile Money Usage Patterns
- How many farmers use mobile money
- Frequency of use
- Types of transactions
- Amounts transacted

4.4 Impact on Agricultural Activities
- Access to inputs
- Access to credit/savings
- Market participation
- Income and productivity

4.5 Challenges Faced
- Technical problems (network, agent liquidity)
- Financial challenges (fees, fraud)
- Personal challenges (literacy, trust)

4.6 Farmers' Suggestions for Improvement
- What farmers want changed or improved

Sample Findings Excerpt:

text

CHAPTER FOUR: PRESENTATION AND ANALYSIS OF FINDINGS

4.1 Introduction

This chapter presents the findings from the survey of 100 small-scale farmers and interviews with 15 farmers in Kasese district. Data is presented in tables and figures, with qualitative quotes illustrating key themes.

4.2 Demographic Characteristics of Respondents

Table 4.1: Demographic Characteristics of Survey Respondents

Characteristic	Category	Number	Percentage
Gender	Male	58	58%
	Female	42	42%
Age	18-30	23	23%
	31-45	41	41%
	46-60	27	27%
	Over 60	9	9%
Education	No formal	18	18%
	Primary	52	52%
	Secondary	26	26%
	Tertiary	4	4%
Farm size	Less than 1 ha	64	64%
	1-2 ha	36	36%

The sample was predominantly male (58%) though with substantial female representation (42%). Most farmers (52%) had primary education, with 18% having no formal education. The majority (64%) cultivated less than one hectare, confirming their status as small-scale farmers.

4.3 Mobile Money Usage Patterns

Frequency of Mobile Money Use

Table 4.2: Frequency of Mobile Money Transactions

Frequency	Number	Percentage
Daily	12	12%
Weekly	38	38%
Monthly	31	31%
Rarely	11	11%
Never	8	8%

Eighty-four percent of farmers reported using mobile money at least monthly, with 50% using it weekly or daily. Only 8% had never used mobile money. This indicates high penetration of mobile money among the farming population.

Reasons for Not Using Mobile Money

Among the 8% who never used mobile money, the main reasons cited were:
- Lack of a mobile phone (3 respondents)
- No trust in the system (2 respondents)
- Prefer cash (2 respondents)
- No agent nearby (1 respondent)

Types of Transactions

Farmers reported using mobile money for various purposes:

Table 4.3: Types of Mobile Money Transactions

Transaction Type	Percentage Using
Receiving money	82%
Sending money	67%
Saving money	45%
Paying for goods	38%
Buying airtime	71%
Taking loans	8%

Receiving money (82%) and sending money (67%) were the most common uses. Notably, 45% reported using mobile money for savings, indicating its role as an informal banking mechanism. Only 8% used mobile money for loans, suggesting underutilization of this potential benefit.

Interview with a female farmer in Busongora illustrated typical usage:

"I use mobile money mostly when my son in Kampala sends me money for school fees. Before mobile money, he would send through a bus driver, and sometimes

the money would get lost or delayed. Now, I receive it instantly."
(45-year-old female farmer, Busongora)

4.4 Impact on Agricultural Activities

Access to Agricultural Inputs

Farmers were asked whether mobile money had improved their ability to access seeds, fertilizers, and other inputs.

Table 4.4: Perceived Impact on Input Access

Response	Number	Percentage
Greatly improved	32	35%
Somewhat improved	41	45%
No change	15	16%
Worsened	4	4%

Note: Percentages based on 92 mobile money users

Eighty percent of mobile money users reported improved access to inputs. Farmers explained that receiving money quickly allowed them to purchase inputs when they were available, rather than waiting for cash to arrive.

"Before, I would sometimes miss buying seeds because the money would come late. Now, when my brother sends money, I can go immediately to the agro-vet and buy before the seeds run out." (52-year-old male farmer, Kisinga)

Market Participation

Mobile money appeared to facilitate market participation, with 62% of users reporting improved ability to sell their produce:

Table 4.5: Impact on Market Participation

Response	Number	Percentage
Easier to sell	57	62%

No change	28	30%
More difficult	7	8%

Farmers reported that mobile money enabled them to receive payments from buyers electronically, reducing the risks of carrying cash.

Savings and Financial Resilience

Forty-five percent of farmers reported using mobile money for savings. Interviews revealed that mobile money provided a way to save safely:

"I keep money on my phone because at home, relatives might ask for it, or I might spend it on small things. On the phone, it's safer until I need it for something important." (38-year-old female farmer, Maliba)

4.5 Challenges Faced

Despite benefits, farmers reported significant challenges:

Table 4.6: Challenges Experienced by Mobile Money Users

Challenge	Percentage Affected
High withdrawal fees	76%
Network problems	68%
Agent lacks cash	52%
Fraud concerns	41%
Difficulty using phone	23%

High withdrawal fees were the most commonly reported challenge (76%), with farmers expressing frustration that cashing out their money consumed a significant portion.

"Every time I withdraw, I lose money to fees. If I receive 50,000 shillings, I might pay 2,000 to withdraw. That adds up over time." (41-year-old male farmer, Busongora)

Network problems affected 68% of users, particularly in remote areas:

"When the network is down, I cannot access my money. Sometimes I travel 5 kilometers to find a place with network." (33-year-old female farmer, Kisinga)

Fraud was a concern for 41% of users:

"My neighbor was tricked by someone who called pretending to be from the mobile money company. They asked for his PIN and took all his money. Now I am afraid." (55-year-old male farmer, Maliba)

4.6 Farmers' Suggestions for Improvement

Farmers offered several suggestions:
- Reduce withdrawal fees (mentioned by 76%)
- Improve network coverage in remote areas (68%)
- Provide education on safe usage (52%)
- Increase agent liquidity (44%)
- Introduce farmer-specific products (31%)

Chapter Five: Discussion, Conclusions, and Recommendations

Structure:

CHAPTER FIVE: DISCUSSION, CONCLUSIONS AND RECOMMENDATIONS

5.1 Introduction
- Brief overview

5.2 Discussion of Findings
- Interpret findings in light of literature
- Explain what findings mean
- Compare with other studies
- Discuss implications

5.3 Conclusions
- Summarize main answers to research questions

- State what has been learned

5.4 Recommendations
- Practical suggestions based on findings
- For different stakeholders (farmers, providers, government)
- Suggestions for further research

Sample Discussion Excerpt:

text

5.2 Discussion of Findings

This study investigated the impact of mobile money on small-scale farmers in Kasese district. The findings reveal both significant benefits and persistent challenges.

Mobile Money Adoption and Usage

The finding that 92% of farmers have used mobile money, with 50% using it weekly or daily, demonstrates deep penetration of this technology in rural areas. This aligns with national statistics showing rapid growth in mobile money subscriptions (Bank of Uganda, 2023) and suggests that digital financial services have successfully reached populations traditionally excluded from formal banking.

The predominance of receiving and sending money as primary uses (82% and 67%) reflects mobile money's role in facilitating remittances, consistent with Jack and Suri's (2019) findings across East Africa. The finding that 45% use mobile money for savings is particularly significant, indicating that farmers are using this tool for financial management beyond simple transactions. This supports Kiconco's (2022) observation that mobile money serves as an informal banking mechanism in areas without physical bank branches.

Impact on Agricultural Activities

The finding that 80% of farmers reported improved access to agricultural inputs through mobile money has important implications. Quick access to funds enables timely purchase of seeds, fertilizers, and tools, potentially improving agricultural productivity. This aligns with broader research showing

that financial inclusion supports agricultural development (FAO, 2021).

Similarly, the 62% reporting improved market participation suggests that mobile money facilitates agricultural commerce. Electronic payments reduce the risks and inconvenience of cash transactions, potentially encouraging more farmers to engage with distant markets.

Challenges and Barriers

The significant challenges identified—particularly high fees (76%), network problems (68%), and agent liquidity issues (52%)—suggest that mobile money services are not yet optimally designed for small-scale farmers' needs.
High fees disproportionately affect those making small transactions, which characterizes many farmers' usage. This finding echoes concerns raised by the Uganda Consumer Protection Association (2023) about the cost burden on low-income users.

Network problems reflect infrastructure gaps that require investment from telecommunications companies and government. The finding that 41% express fraud concerns highlights the need for consumer education and stronger consumer protection mechanisms.

5.3 Conclusions

Based on the findings, this study concludes that:

1. Mobile money has achieved high penetration among small-scale farmers in Kasese district, with the majority using services regularly.

2. Mobile money positively impacts farmers' agricultural activities by facilitating access to inputs, enabling savings, and supporting market participation.

3. However, significant barriers limit the full potential of mobile money for farmers, including high transaction costs, infrastructure gaps, and concerns about security.

4. Despite challenges, farmers demonstrate strong interest in using mobile money and have clear ideas about how services could be improved to better

serve their needs.

5.4 Recommendations

For Mobile Money Service Providers:
1. Develop farmer-specific products with lower transaction fees for agricultural transactions
2. Invest in agent network expansion in remote areas and ensure adequate liquidity
3. Implement farmer education programs on safe mobile money usage
4. Consider interest-bearing savings products designed for farmers' seasonal income patterns

For Government and Regulators:
1. Expand telecommunications infrastructure to improve network coverage in rural areas
2. Strengthen consumer protection mechanisms, particularly regarding fraud
3. Consider regulating transaction fees to ensure affordability for low-income users
4. Integrate mobile money into agricultural extension and financial inclusion policies

For Farmers and Farmer Organizations:
1. Form farmer groups to negotiate better terms with mobile money providers
2. Participate in training programs on digital financial services
3. Share experiences and knowledge with fellow farmers
4. Provide feedback to providers about service gaps and needed improvements

For Further Research:
1. Conduct longitudinal studies tracking mobile money's long-term impact on farmer incomes and productivity
2. Compare mobile money impact across different agricultural regions of Uganda
3. Investigate the potential of mobile money-linked credit products for farmers
4. Examine gender dimensions of mobile money access and usage among farmers

C. BACK MATTER

i) References

References list all sources cited in your essay.

Common Referencing Styles:

Style	Common In	Key Features
APA (American Psychological Association)	Social sciences, education	Author-date format
MLA (Modern Language Association)	Humanities, literature	Author-page format
Chicago	History, some humanities	Footnotes or author-date
Harvard	Widely used in UK	Author-date

APA Style Examples:

Book:
Suri, T., & Jack, W. (2016). *Mobile money and financial inclusion in Kenya*. MIT Press.

Journal Article:
Kiconco, A. (2022). Mobile money agents and rural financial inclusion in Uganda. *Journal of African Economics*, 31(4), 412-428.

Report:
Bank of Uganda. (2023). *Annual report on financial inclusion 2023*. Kampala: Bank of Uganda.

Website:
Uganda Communications Commission. (2024). *Mobile money statistics Q1 2024*. Retrieved from www.ucc.co.ug/statistics

Newspaper Article:
Muhumuza, R. (2023, June 15). Farmers embrace mobile money in Kasese. *Daily Monitor*, p. 12.

Sample Reference List:

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Jack, W., & Suri, T. (2019). Mobile money and financial inclusion in East Africa. Journal of Development Economics, 141(3), 234-251.

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Uganda Communications Commission. (2024). Mobile money statistics Q1 2024. Retrieved from www.ucc.co.ug/statistics

Uganda Consumer Protection Association. (2023). Consumer experiences with mobile money services in Uganda. Kampala: UCPA.

World Bank. (2022). Digital financial services and agricultural development in Sub-Saharan Africa. Washington, DC: World Bank.

ii) Bibliography

A bibliography lists all sources consulted, whether cited or not. If you've used the same format for references, you can combine them.

iii) Appendices

Appendices contain supplementary material that supports your essay but is too detailed for the main text.

Common Appendices:

Appendix	Content
Appendix A	Questionnaire used for survey
Appendix B	Interview guide
Appendix C	Consent form
Appendix D	Transcripts of interviews (if relevant)
Appendix E	Photographs from field work
Appendix F	Maps of study area
Appendix G	Statistical tables (detailed)

Sample Appendix: Questionnaire

APPENDIX A**: QUESTIONNAIRE FOR FARMERS**

Title of Study: The Impact of Mobile Money on Small-Scale Farmers in Kasese District

Researcher: Namutebi Sarah
School: St. Mary's College, Kisubi

Dear Participant,

I am a Senior Five student conducting research on how mobile money affects farmers in Kasese. Your participation is voluntary and anonymous. Information you provide will be used only for this research. You may withdraw at any time.

Please tick (✓) or fill in the appropriate response.

SECTION A: **BACKGROUND INFORMATION**

1. Gender: Male [ ] Female [ ]

2. Age: 18-30 [ ] 31-45 [ ] 46-60 [ ] Over 60 [ ]

3. Education level:
No formal education [ ]

Primary [ ]
Secondary [ ]
Tertiary [ ]

4. Sub-county: _____

5. Size of farm: Less than 1 hectare [ ] 1-2 hectares [ ] Over 2 hectares [ ]

SECTION B: **MOBILE MONEY USAGE**

6. Do you use mobile money services? Yes [ ] No [ ]

(If No, skip to Section D)

7. How often do you use mobile money?
Daily [ ] Weekly [ ] Monthly [ ] Rarely [ ]

8. What do you use mobile money for? (Tick all that apply)
Receiving money [ ]
Sending money [ ]
Saving money [ ]
Paying for goods [ ]
Buying airtime [ ]
Taking loans [ ]
Other (specify): _____

9. Approximately how much money do you transact monthly through mobile money?
Less than 50,000 [ ]
50,000 - 200,000 [ ]
200,000 - 500,000 [ ]
Over 500,000 [ ]

SECTION C**: IMPACT ON FARMING**

10. Has mobile money improved your access to agricultural inputs (seeds, fertilizer, tool s)?
Greatly improved [ ]
Somewhat improved [ ]
No change [ ]

Worsened [ ]

11. Has mobile money made it easier to sell your produce?
Easier [ ]
No change [ ]
More difficult [ ]

12. Do you use mobile money for savings related to farming?
Yes [ ] No [ ]

13. Has mobile money helped you during emergencies (crop failure, illness, etc.)?
Yes, greatly [ ]
Yes, somewhat [ ]
No [ ]

SECTION D: **CHALLENGES**

14. What challenges have you experienced with mobile money? (Tick all that apply)
High withdrawal fees [ ]
Network problems [ ]
Agent lacks cash [ ]
Fraud/being cheated [ ]
Difficulty using the phone [ ]
Other (specify): _____

15. If you do NOT use mobile money, why not?
No mobile phone [ ]
No agent nearby [ ]
Don't trust it [ ]
Prefer cash [ ]
Other (specify): _____

SECTION E: **SUGGESTIONS**

16. What would make mobile money more useful for farmers like you?
_____
_____
_____

Thank you for your participation!

LEARNING OUTCOME 3(b): Generate topic ideas from a scenario that can be addressed through Extended Essay writing (u, s, gs, v)

3.3 IDENTIFYING PROBLEMS IN YOUR COMMUNITY

The Extended Essay should address a real issue affecting your community. This requires careful observation and critical thinking about your environment.

Areas to Observe for Potential Topics:

Area of Life	Questions to Ask
Your school	What problems do students face? What could be improved?
Your village/community	What challenges do people experience daily?
Local economy	How do people earn a living? What difficulties do they face?
Health	What health issues affect your community?
Environment	What environmental problems exist?
Education	What educational challenges are evident?
Agriculture	What farming problems do people face?
Youth	What issues affect young people?
Gender	Are there gender-related challenges?
Infrastructure	What facilities are lacking or inadequate?

3.4 BRAINSTORMING TOPIC IDEAS

Step 1: Observe and List Problems

Walk around your community and list problems you observe:

Example Observation List (Kasese Student):

- Farmers struggle to access loans
- Children walk long distances to school
- The health center lacks medicines
- Youth unemployment is high
- Soil fertility seems to be declining
- Mobile money agents often run out of cash
- Women spend hours collecting water
- Crop prices fluctuate wildly
- Some children are not in school
- The wetland is being encroached upon

Step 2: Choose a Problem That Interests You

Select problems that genuinely interest you—you'll spend months on this research.

Step 3: Turn the Problem into a Researchable Topic

Problem	Research Topic
Farmers struggle to access loans	"Access to Agricultural Credit Among Small-Scale Farmers in [Area] District"
Children walk long distances to school	"The Impact of Distance to School on Primary Completion Rates in [Area]"
Health center lacks medicines	"Availability and Access to Essential Medicines at [Name] Health Center"
Youth unemployment	"Causes and Consequences of Youth Unemployment in [Area] Town"
Soil fertility declining	"Farmers' Perceptions of Soil Fertility Decline and Adaptation Strategies in [Area]"
Mobile money agents run out of cash	"Liquidity Management Challenges Among Mobile Money Agents in [Area]"

3.5 TOPIC AREAS FROM THE SYLLABUS

The syllabus provides eleven core topics for Extended Essays. Your topic should fall within one of these areas:

Topic Area	Possible Sub-topics
1. Human Rights	Child rights, women's rights, access to justice, rights awareness, discrimination
2. Education	Access to education, quality of education, girls' education, school dropout, adult literacy
3. Culture	Cultural preservation, language loss, traditional practices, cultural tourism, rites of passage
4. Social Issues	Poverty, health, housing, water access, sanitation, gender-based violence, child protection
5. Economics	Employment, income generation, savings groups, market access, entrepreneurship
6. Globalisation	Cultural change, foreign influence, technology adoption, trade impacts
7. Challenges of Developing Countries	Food security, disease, conflict, corruption, infrastructure deficits
8. Science and Technology	Technology adoption, appropriate technology, innovation, digital divide
9. Agriculture	Farming practices, food production, market access, climate adaptation
10. Historical Perspective	Local history, traditional governance, historical events, heritage
11. Politics and Governance	Local governance, service delivery, citizen participation, decentralization

3.6 CRITERIA FOR A GOOD TOPIC

Criterion	Explanation	Ask Yourself
Relevant	Addresses a real community problem	Does this matter to people in my community?

Researchable	You can find information	Can I get data? Are people available to interview?
Specific	Not too broad, not too narrow	Can I cover this in 3,000-4,000 words?
Interesting	You care about it	Will I stay motivated for months?
Feasible	Possible with your resources	Can I access the area? Do I have time?
Ethical	Won't harm participants	Is this sensitive? Can I protect people?

3.7 SAMPLE TOPIC GENERATION

Scenario: You live in a trading center near a wetland in central Uganda. You've noticed that the wetland is being drained for farming, and some community members are concerned about environmental effects.

Brainstorming:

Question	Answer
What's happening?	Wetland being converted to farmland
Who is involved?	Farmers, local council, environment office
Why is it happening?	Need for farmland, population pressure, weak enforcement
What are the effects?	Water levels dropping, crops failing in dry spells
What do people think?	Some support, others oppose
What could be done?	Better enforcement, alternative livelihoods

Potential Topics:

1. "Causes and Consequences of Wetland Degradation in [Name] Wetland, [District] District"
2. "Community Perceptions of Wetland Conservation Versus Agricultural Expansion in [Area]"
3. "The Role of Local Government in Wetland Protection: A Case Study of [Name] Wetland"
4. "Alternative Livelihoods for Communities Dependent on Wetland Resources in [Area]"
5. "Compliance with Environmental Regulations Among Farmers in [Name] Wetland Area"

3.8 NARROWING AND REFINING YOUR TOPIC

Too Broad: "The Impact of Mobile Money in Uganda"

- Cannot cover entire country
- Too many aspects to address

Better: "The Impact of Mobile Money on Small-Scale Farmers in Kasese District"

- Geographic focus (Kasese)
- Specific population (small-scale farmers)

Too Narrow: "How Mr. Okello Uses Mobile Money to Buy Seeds"

- One person, not generalizable
- Limited significance

Better: "Mobile Money and Access to Agricultural Inputs Among Farmers in Busongora Sub-county"

- Multiple farmers
- Specific aspect (input access)
- Defined area

3.9 FORMULATING PRELIMINARY TOPIC IDEAS

Worksheet for Topic Development:

Step	Your Response
What problem have I observed?	
Where does this problem occur?	
Who is affected by this problem?	
Why does this problem interest me?	
What do I want to find out?	
What category from syllabus does this fit?	
Preliminary topic idea:	

Example Completed Worksheet:

Step	Your Response
What problem have I observed?	Girls missing school during their periods
Where does this problem occur?	My school and surrounding villages
Who is affected by this problem?	Secondary school girls
Why does this problem interest me?	I've seen friends fall behind in class
What do I want to find out?	How many girls miss school? Why? What can be done?
What category from syllabus does this fit?	Education, Social Issues
Preliminary topic idea:	"Menstrual Hygiene Management and Its Impact on Girls' School Attendance in [Area] Sub-county"

LEARNING OUTCOME 3(c): Comprehend information relevant to their topic (u, s, gs)

3.10 SOURCES OF INFORMATION

For your Extended Essay, you need information from various sources:

Source Type	Examples	Strengths	Weaknesses
Books	Textbooks, academic books	In-depth, credible	May be outdated
Journal Articles	Academic journals	Current research, peer-reviewed	May be technical, access limited

Reports	Government, NGO reports	Official data, specific topics	May be biased
Newspapers	Daily Monitor, New Vision	Current events, local issues	May lack depth
Websites	Official sites, educational sites	Current, accessible	Quality varies
Experts	Teachers, officers, professionals	Firsthand knowledge, local insights	Availability
Community members	Farmers, traders, elders	Local experience, perspectives	May be subjective
Observations	What you see	Firsthand, authentic	Limited scope
Official data	UBOS, ministry statistics	Reliable, comprehensive	May be aggregate, not specific

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3.11 SEARCHING FOR INFORMATION

Library Research:

- Use the school library
- Check public libraries
- Ask librarian for help
- Use reference sections

Online Research:

- Use search engines (Google, Google Scholar)
- Visit official websites (government ministries, UBOS, World Bank)
- Use academic databases if available
- Check NGO websites for reports

Key Search Terms:

For the mobile money topic, useful search terms:

- "mobile money Uganda"
- "financial inclusion agriculture Uganda"

- "small-scale farmers Uganda"
- "Kasese district agriculture"
- "mobile money impact rural areas"
- "Bank of Uganda mobile money statistics"

3.12 EVALUATING SOURCES

Use the CRAAP Test to evaluate sources:

Criterion	Questions to Ask
Currency	When was this published? Is it up to date?
Relevance	Does this relate to my topic? Is it appropriate?
Authority	Who wrote it? Are they qualified? Is the source reputable?
Accuracy	Is the information supported by evidence? Can it be verified?
Purpose	Why was this created? Is there bias?

Example Evaluation:

Source: "Mobile Money and Financial Inclusion" from a blog

Criterion	Evaluation
Currency	Published 2024, recent
Relevance	Directly related to topic
Authority	Unknown author, personal blog
Accuracy	No sources cited, opinion-based
Purpose	Personal opinions, may be biased

Verdict: Not suitable for academic research; seek more authoritative sources.

3.13 READING AND NOTE-TAKING

Effective Reading Strategies:

1. **Preview:** Skim headings, introduction, conclusion first
2. **Read actively:** Highlight key points, make notes
3. **Summarize:** Write brief summaries in your own words
4. **Record sources:** Note all bibliographic details immediately

Note-Taking Methods:

Method	Description	Example
Summary	Brief overview in your words	"Kiconco (2022) found that mobile money agents in Masaka face liquidity challenges, especially on market days."
Quotation	Exact words, with page numbers	"Mobile money has 'fundamentally altered financial inclusion patterns' in Uganda (Bank of Uganda, 2023, p. 15)."
Paraphrase	Rewriting in your words	According to Bank of Uganda (2023), mobile money has significantly changed how Ugandans access financial services.
Notes with comments	Your thoughts on the source	"This study is from 2021, so statistics may be outdated. Useful for methodology, but need more current data."

Sample Note Card:

SOURCE: Kiconco, A. (2022). Mobile money agents and rural financial inclusion in Uganda. Journal of African Economics, 31(4), 412-428.

MAIN POINTS:
- Study of mobile money agents in Masaka district (N=50 agents)
- Found that 68% of agents experience liquidity shortages at least weekly
- Market days create highest demand, but agents lack cash
- Agents with formal banking relationships had fewer problems
- Recommends improved agent-bank linkages and agent training

QUOTATIONS:
"Liquidity management remains the single greatest challenge for rural mobile money agents" (p. 420).

MY COMMENTS:
- Useful for understanding agent perspective
- Masaka similar to Kasese (rural, agricultural)
- Could use similar methodology
- Need to check if situation has changed since 2022

3.14 ORGANIZING YOUR INFORMATION

Create a Research Log:

Date	Source	Key Information	Pages	Notes
10/2/25	Bank of Uganda (2023)	30 million mobile money accounts, 105 trillion transactions	23-25	Use for introduction
12/2/25	Kiconco (2022)	Agent liquidity challenges	415-418	Use for literature review, challenges section
15/2/25	Daily Monitor (15/6/23)	Farmers in Kasese using mobile money	12	Use for local context

Create a Source Folder:

Keep all your sources organized:

- Printed articles in a folder
- Bookmarked websites in a folder
- Notes in a notebook or digital document
- PDFs saved with clear file names

LEARNING OUTCOME 3(d): Apply relevant literature appropriately into their work (u, s, gs)

3.15 INTEGRATING SOURCES INTO YOUR WRITING

There are three main ways to use sources in your essay:

A. Direct Quotation

Using the exact words from a source, with quotation marks.

When to use:

- The wording is particularly powerful or memorable
- The exact definition is important
- You want to analyze the specific language used

Example:
According to Kiconco (2022), "Liquidity management remains the single greatest challenge for rural mobile money agents" (p. 420). This finding highlights the operational difficulties that affect service delivery in areas like Kasese.

B. Paraphrasing

Restating the source's ideas in your own words.

When to use:

- The idea is important but the exact wording isn't
- You want to simplify complex information
- You're combining multiple sources

Example:
Kiconco's (2022) study of mobile money agents in Masaka revealed that most agents experience cash shortages regularly, particularly on market days when demand is highest. This suggests that agent liquidity is a systemic issue affecting rural areas across Uganda.

C. Summarizing

Condensing a source's main ideas into a brief overview.

When to use:

- You want to give an overview of a longer work
- You're synthesizing multiple sources
- The specific details aren't needed

Example:
Several studies have examined mobile money in Uganda. Research has focused on user adoption patterns (Jack & Suri, 2019), agent operations (Kiconco, 2022), and impacts on household welfare (Mwangi et al., 2021). However, few studies have specifically examined small-scale farmers' experiences.

3.16 AVOIDING

PLAGIARISM

Plagiarism is using someone else's work without acknowledgment. It is a serious academic offense.

Types of Plagiarism:

Type	Example	How to Avoid
Copy-paste	Copying text directly without quotation marks	Use quotation marks and cite
Mosaic plagiarism	Changing a few words but keeping structure	Paraphrase properly and cite
Idea theft	Using someone's idea without credit	Cite the source of ideas
Self-plagiarism	Reusing your own previous work	Create new work for each assignment
Source fabrication	Making up sources	Only cite sources you actually used

Tips to Avoid Plagiarism:

- Take notes carefully, marking quotes
- Cite everything that isn't your own idea or common knowledge
- When in doubt, cite
- Keep a working bibliography

- Understand what "common knowledge" means for your topic

3.17 CONSTRUCTING REFERENCES AND BIBLIOGRAPHIES

In-Text Citations (APA Style):

Situation	Format	Example
One author	(Author, year)	(Kiconco, 2022)
Two authors	(Author & Author, year)	(Jack & Suri, 2019)
Three or more	(First author et al., year)	(Mwangi et al., 2021)
Direct quote	(Author, year, p. X)	(Kiconco, 2022, p. 420)
Organization as author	(Organization, year)	(Bank of Uganda, 2023)
No date	(Author, n.d.)	(Ministry of Agriculture, n.d.)

Reference List Format (APA):

Book:
Author, A. A. (Year). *Title of book*. Publisher.

Journal Article:
Author, A. A. (Year). Title of article. *Journal Title, Volume*(Issue), Page range.

Report:
Organization. (Year). *Title of report*. Publisher.

Newspaper Article:
Author, A. A. (Year, Month Day). Title of article. *Newspaper Title*, Page.

Website:
Author, A. A. (Year). *Title of page*. Site Name. URL

LEARNING OUTCOME 3(e): Demonstrate an understanding of research questions for their essay, based on existing information (k, u, s, v/a)

3.18 WHAT ARE RESEARCH QUESTIONS?

Research questions guide your investigation by specifying exactly what you want to find out.

Characteristics of Good Research Questions:

Characteristic	Poor Question	Good Question
Specific	What is mobile money?	How do small-scale farmers in Kasese use mobile money?
Researchable	Is mobile money good?	What benefits and challenges do farmers report from using mobile money?
Focused	How does mobile money affect Uganda?	How has mobile money affected access to agricultural inputs among farmers in Busongora?
Clear	What's up with farmers and phones?	What is the relationship between mobile money usage and farmers' ability to purchase inputs?
Answerable	Will mobile money save the world?	What improvements do farmers suggest for mobile money services?

3.19 DEVELOPING RESEARCH QUESTIONS FROM YOUR TOPIC

Process:

1. Start with your general topic
2. Brainstorm everything you want to know
3. Group related questions
4. Refine and focus
5. Select the most important 3-5 questions

Example:

Topic: Mobile Money and Small-Scale Farmers in Kasese

Brainstorm Questions:

- Do farmers use mobile money?
- How often do they use it?
- What do they use it for?
- Does it help them with farming?
- Does it help them save money?
- Do they have problems?
- Are fees too high?
- Is the network reliable?
- Do agents have enough cash?
- Has it changed their lives?
- Do women and men use it differently?
- What do farmers want improved?

Group Questions:

Group	Questions
Usage patterns	Do farmers use it? How often? What for?
Impacts	Help with farming? Save money? Change lives?
Challenges	Problems? Fees? Network? Agent cash?
Demographics	Gender differences? Age differences?
Improvements	What do farmers want?

Refine into Research Questions:

1. What is the extent and nature of mobile money usage among small-scale farmers in Kasese district? (Usage patterns)
2. How has mobile money affected farmers' access to agricultural inputs, savings, and markets? (Impacts)
3. What challenges do farmers face in using mobile money services? (Challenges)
4. How do mobile money usage patterns differ between male and female farmers? (Demographics)
5. What recommendations do farmers have for improving mobile money services? (Improvements)

3.20 USING PREPARATORY READING TO DEVELOP QUESTIONS

Your initial reading should help you refine your questions:

What You Learn from Reading → How It Refines Your Questions

- Existing studies show certain impacts → You can ask about those specific impacts
- Gaps in research identified → You can address those gaps
- Methodologies used elsewhere → You can adapt for your context
- Local context differences → You can ask context-specific questions

Example:

Reading reveals that studies in Kenya found mobile money helped farmers access inputs (Suri & Jack, 2016). Your refined question: "Has mobile money improved access to agricultural inputs for farmers in Kasese?"

Reading reveals that few studies examine gender differences. Your refined question: "Are there gender differences in mobile money usage patterns among farmers in Kasese?"

3.21 SAMPLE RESEARCH QUESTIONS BY TOPIC AREA

Topic Area	Sample Research Questions
Education	What factors contribute to primary school dropout in [Area]? How do parents perceive the value of girls' education? What challenges do teachers face in multigrade classrooms?
Health	What barriers do community members face in accessing [health facility]? How do traditional healers and modern medicine coexist in [Area]? What factors influence malaria prevention practices?
Agriculture	What challenges do farmers face in accessing agricultural extension services? How has climate change affected farming practices? What factors influence farmers' adoption of improved seeds?
Environment	What are community perceptions of wetland conservation? How has deforestation affected local water sources? What waste management practices exist in [trading center]?

Youth	What are the main causes of youth unemployment in [Area]? How do young people perceive vocational training? What factors influence youth participation in local governance?
Gender	What barriers do women face in accessing credit? How has women's participation in income generation affected household dynamics? What challenges do girl mothers face in returning to school?

LEARNING OUTCOME 3(f): Develop an introduction, body, and conclusion related to their research questions (k, u, s, v/a)

3.22 WRITING THE INTRODUCTION

Purpose of the Introduction:

- Orient the reader to your topic
- Establish why the topic matters
- State what you intend to find out
- Provide roadmap for the essay

Structure of a Strong Introduction:

Element	Purpose	Approx. Length
Hook	Grab attention	1-2 sentences
Background context	Provide necessary information	2-3 paragraphs
Problem statement	Explain what gap/issue you're addressing	1 paragraph
Purpose statement	State what your study does	1 sentence
Research questions	List what you'll answer	Bullet points or paragraph
Significance	Explain why it matters	1 paragraph
Scope/delimitations	Clarify boundaries	1 paragraph
Structure preview	Roadmap for reader	1-2 sentences

Sample Introduction for Mobile Money Topic:

(See complete sample in section 3.2 above)

3.23 WRITING THE BODY

The body develops your argument and presents your research.

Organizing the Body:

Section	Purpose	Content
Literature Review	Show what's already known	Review and synthesize existing research
Methodology	Explain how you did your research	Methods, tools, participants, procedures
Findings	Present what you discovered	Data, quotes, observations, organized by theme
Discussion	Interpret your findings	What it means, implications, limitations

Tips for Each Section:

Literature Review:

- Organize by theme, not by source
- Synthesize: show relationships between sources
- Identify gaps your research addresses
- Use transitions to connect ideas

Methodology:

- Be specific and detailed
- Justify your choices (why this method? why this sample?)
- Acknowledge limitations
- Show ethical considerations

Findings:

- Organize by research question or theme
- Use tables and figures to present data clearly
- Include quotes from participants
- Stay descriptive (save interpretation for discussion)

Discussion:

- Interpret what findings mean
- Connect back to literature (confirm? contradict? extend?)
- Explain implications
- Acknowledge limitations

3.24 WRITING THE CONCLUSION

Purpose of the Conclusion:

- Summarize main findings
- Answer research questions
- State conclusions
- Make recommendations
- Suggest further research

Structure:

Element	Purpose	Example
Restate purpose	Remind reader what you set out to do	"This study investigated..."
Summarize main findings	Brief overview of key results	"The research found that..."
Answer research questions	Directly address each question	"Regarding the first question..."
State conclusions	What you conclude overall	"It can be concluded that..."
Make recommendations	Practical suggestions	"Based on these findings..."
Suggest further research	What else needs study	"Future research should..."
Concluding thought	Final statement (optional)	"Mobile money, despite

		challenges..."

Sample Conclusion for Mobile Money Topic:

(See complete sample in section 3.2 above)

3.25 MAINTAINING COHERENCE

Coherence means your essay flows logically and all parts connect.

Strategies for Coherence:

1. **Use your research questions as organizing framework:**
   - Introduction presents questions
   - Findings organized by questions
   - Conclusion answers questions
2. **Use topic sentences:**
   - Each paragraph begins with sentence stating main point
   - Everything in paragraph supports that point
3. **Use transitions:**
   - Between paragraphs: "In addition to usage patterns, farmers also reported..."
   - Between sections: "Having examined what farmers reported, the next chapter discusses what these findings mean."
4. **Refer back to your research questions:**
   - "Regarding the first research question, the findings reveal..."
   - "This addresses the question of how farmers use mobile money..."
5. **Connect findings to literature:**
   - "This finding aligns with Kiconco's (2022) observation that..."
   - "However, contrary to Suri and Jack's (2016) findings, this study found..."

3.26 SAMPLE PARAGRAPH WITH COHERENCE

Topic sentence → [Regarding the impact on access to agricultural inputs, the findings reveal significant improvements for most farmers.]

Evidence → [Eighty percent of survey respondents reported that mobile money had improved their ability to access seeds, fertilizers, and tools. One farmer explained: "Before mobile money, I would sometimes miss buying seeds because the money would come late. Now, when my brother sends money, I can go immediately to the agro-vet."]

Connection to research question → [This directly addresses the second research question about mobile money's impact on farming activities.]

Connection to literature → [These findings align with Suri and Jack's (2016) research in Kenya, which found that mobile money facilitated input purchases among smallholder farmers.]

Transition to next point → [However, while access improved, farmers also reported significant challenges that limited these benefits, which will be discussed in the following section.]

SENIOR FIVE TERM 3

TOPIC 4: DATA COLLECTION AND ANALYSIS

Duration: 18 Periods

Competency: The learner supports evidence-based decision making through collecting, analysing, interpreting and communicating data using a range of media to solve societal problems.

LEARNING OUTCOME 4(a): Analyse appropriate methods for data collection in relation to their area of research (u, s, gs)

4.1 UNDERSTANDING DATA

Data is factual information (such as measurements, statistics, or observations) used as a basis for reasoning, discussion, or calculation.

Types of Data:

Type	Description	Example
Primary data	Collected firsthand by researcher	Surveys you conduct, interviews you do
Secondary data	Already collected by others	Government statistics, previous studies
Quantitative data	Numerical data	Percentages, averages, counts
Qualitative data	Non-numerical data	Interviews, observations, descriptions

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4.2 DATA COLLECTION METHODS

A. QUESTIONNAIRES

Definition: A written set of questions given to respondents to answer.

Types of Questions:

Question Type	Description	Example
Closed-ended	Fixed response options	Gender: Male [ ] Female [ ]
Open-ended	Free response	"What suggestions do you have?"
Likert scale	Rate agreement	"Mobile money is easy to use": Strongly agree [ ] Agree [ ] Neutral [ ] Disagree [ ] Strongly disagree [ ]
Multiple choice	Select from options	"How often do you use mobile money?" Daily [ ] Weekly [ ] Monthly [ ] Rarely [ ]

Advantages of Questionnaires:

- Can reach many people
- Anonymous, may encourage honesty
- Easy to analyze quantitative data
- Consistent questions for all
- Relatively inexpensive

Disadvantages:

- Low response rates possible
- Cannot clarify questions if misunderstood
- Limited depth
- Requires literacy
- May miss unexpected information

When to Use: When you need information from many people, want to quantify responses, have clear questions.

B. INTERVIEWS

Definition: A conversation where researcher asks questions and records responses.

Types of Interviews:

Type	Description	Example
Structured	Same questions, same order, all respondents	Like a spoken questionnaire
Semi-structured	Guided by topics, but flexible	Interview guide with main questions, can probe
Unstructured	Open conversation about topic	"Tell me about your experience with mobile money"
Key informant	With experts or knowledgeable people	Interview with agricultural officer
Focus group	Group interview with discussion	6-8 farmers discussing together

Advantages of Interviews:

- Deep, detailed information
- Can clarify and probe
- Observe non-verbal cues
- Flexible, can follow unexpected topics
- Good for sensitive topics (with rapport)

Disadvantages:

- Time-consuming
- Small sample size
- Interviewer may influence responses
- Difficult to analyze
- Requires skill

When to Use: When you need depth, want to understand experiences, have time for few respondents.

C. OBSERVATION

Definition: Watching and recording behaviors, events, or conditions.

Types of Observation:

Type	Description	Example
Participant observer	Researcher participates in activity	Helping at mobile money agent while observing
Non-participant	Researcher just watches	Sitting and watching transactions
Structured	Systematic recording of specific behaviors	Counting how many customers per hour
Unstructured	Open observation	Noting everything interesting

Advantages of Observation:

- See what people actually do (not just what they say)
- Rich contextual information
- Can discover unexpected things
- No reliance on respondent's memory or honesty

Disadvantages:

- Time-consuming
- Observer may influence behavior
- Cannot observe past events
- May be subjective
- Ethical considerations

When to Use: When behavior matters, when you want context, to supplement other methods.

D. DOCUMENT ANALYSIS

Definition: Analyzing existing documents and records.

Types of Documents:

- Official records (government reports, statistics)
- Organizational records (school registers, health center records)
- Personal documents (diaries, letters)
- Media (newspapers, websites)
- Historical documents

Advantages:

- Unobtrusive (no interaction needed)
- Can cover long time periods
- Often free/accessible
- Provides official data

Disadvantages:

- May be incomplete
- May have biases
- Not collected for your purpose
- May be outdated

E. FOCUS GROUP DISCUSSIONS

Definition: A facilitated group discussion with 6-10 participants on a specific topic.

Advantages:

- Interaction generates ideas
- Participants build on each other's comments
- Can observe group dynamics
- Efficient way to get multiple perspectives

Disadvantages:

- Dominant voices may prevail
- Groupthink possible
- Less depth than individual interviews
- Requires skilled facilitator

4.3 CHOOSING APPROPRIATE METHODS

Factors to Consider:

Factor	Consideration
Research questions	What kind of information do you need?
Population	Who are your respondents? How many?
Resources	Time, money, materials available
Skills	What methods can you implement well?
Access	Can you reach respondents?
Sensitivity	Is the topic sensitive?
Purpose	Do you need breadth (many people) or depth (detailed understanding)?

Matching Methods to Research Questions:

If you want to know...	Appropriate methods
How many people do something	Survey/questionnaire
Why people do something	Interviews, focus groups
What people actually do	Observation
Official statistics	Document analysis
Range of experiences	Survey + interviews (mixed)
Community norms	Focus groups

4.4 MIXED METHODS APPROACH

Many researchers combine methods to get both breadth and depth.

Example:

- Survey 100 farmers (breadth, quantitative)
- Interview 15 farmers (depth, qualitative)
- Observe 5 mobile money agents (context)
- Review government statistics (secondary data)

LEARNING OUTCOME 4(b): Develop sample tools for data collection in their area of research (k, u, s, gs)

4.5 DEVELOPING A QUESTIONNAIRE

Step-by-Step Process:

Step 1: Define what you need to know

- List your research questions
- For each question, what information do you need?

Step 2: Draft questions

- Write questions that will give you that information
- Use appropriate question types

Step 3: Organize logically

- Start with easy, non-threatening questions
- Group related questions
- Save sensitive questions for later

Step 4: Write clear instructions

- Explain purpose
- Explain how to answer
- Thank respondents

Step 5: Pilot test

- Try with 5-10 people like your sample
- Identify confusing questions
- Revise based on feedback

Step 6: Finalize

4.6 QUESTIONNAIRE DESIGN PRINCIPLES

Do's:

- Keep questions clear and simple
- Use language respondents understand
- Ask one thing at a time
- Provide all needed response options
- Include "Other (specify)" when appropriate
- Pilot test

Don'ts:

- Don't use leading questions ("Don't you agree that...")
- Don't ask double-barreled questions ("Do you use mobile money and save regularly?")
- Don't use jargon
- Don't make questions too long
- Don't assume knowledge

Examples of Good vs. Poor Questions:

Poor Question	Problem	Improved Version
"Do you use mobile money frequently?"	"Frequently" is vague	"How often do you use mobile money?" with specific options
"Don't you think mobile money fees are too high?"	Leading, assumes answer	"What do you think about mobile money fees?"
"Do you use mobile money for saving and buying inputs?"	Two things in one	Separate questions
"What is your annual income from farming?"	May not know annual, sensitive	Range options: Less than 500,000, 500,000-1 million, etc.

4.7 SAMPLE QUESTIONNAIRE

(See complete questionnaire in Appendix A example in section 3.2)

4.8 DEVELOPING AN INTERVIEW GUIDE

Structure of Interview Guide:

INTERVIEW GUIDE FOR FARMERS

Title of Study: The Impact of Mobile Money on Small-Scale Farmers in Kasese District

Researcher: Namutebi Sarah
School: St. Mary's College, Kisubi

INTRODUCTION (to be read to participant):
Thank you for agreeing to talk with me. I am a student researching how mobile money affects farmers in this area. The interview will take about 30 minutes. Your responses are confidential, and your name will not be used. You can stop at any time. Do you have any questions before we begin?

PART 1: **BACKGROUND**
1. Tell me a little about yourself and your farming.
   (Probes: How long have you been farming? What do you grow? How large is your farm?)

PART 2: **MOBILE MONEY USAGE**
2. Do you use mobile money? If yes, how did you start using it?
3. What do you use mobile money for? Can you give me examples?
   (Probes: Receiving money? Sending? Saving? Paying? Loans?)
4. How often do you use it? When do you use it most?

PART 3**: IMPACT ON FARMING**
5. Has mobile money changed how you farm? How?
   (Probes: Access to inputs? Buying seeds/fertilizer? Selling produce?)
6. Can you tell me about a time when mobile money really helped you with farming?
7. Has mobile money helped you save money? How do you save?

PART 4: **CHALLENGES**
8. What problems have you experienced with mobile money?
   (Probes: Fees? Network? Agent issues? Fraud?)
9. Tell me about a time when mobile money caused you difficulty.

10. Are there things you wish you could do with mobile money but can't?

PART 5: **SUGGESTIONS**
11. What would make mobile money more useful for farmers like you?
12. Is there anything else you'd like to tell me about mobile money and farming?

CLOSING:
Thank you very much for your time and help. Your insights are valuable for my research. If I have any follow-up questions, may I contact you again?

[Thank participant and end]

4.9 PILOT TESTING

Why Pilot Test:

- Identify confusing questions
- Check if questions get useful answers
- Estimate time needed
- Practice your interviewing skills
- Identify problems with your process

How to Pilot:

- Select 5-10 people similar to your sample
- Administer questionnaire or conduct interviews exactly as planned
- Ask for feedback: "Were any questions unclear?"
- Note problems: questions people skip, misunderstand, or find uncomfortable
- Revise based on feedback

LEARNING OUTCOME 4(c): Establish how best they can present data for their topics (u, s, gs)

4.10 DATA PRESENTATION METHODS

Different types of data require different presentation methods.

A. TABLES

Tables organize data in rows and columns, making comparisons easy.

When to Use Tables:

- Showing exact numbers
- Comparing multiple categories
- Presenting detailed data

Example Table:

Table 4.1: Mobile Money Usage by Gender

Usage Frequency	Male (n=58)	Female (n=42)	Total(N=100)
Daily	8 (14%)	4 (10%)	12 (12%)
Weekly	24 (41%)	14 (33%)	38 (38%)
Monthly	16 (28%)	15 (36%)	31 (31%)
Rarely	6 (10%)	5 (12%)	11 (11%)
Never	4 (7%)	4 (10%)	8 (8%)

Table Design Principles:

- Clear title
- Column and row labels
- Units specified
- Totals where relevant
- Consistent formatting

B. BAR CHARTS

Bar charts use rectangular bars to compare categories.

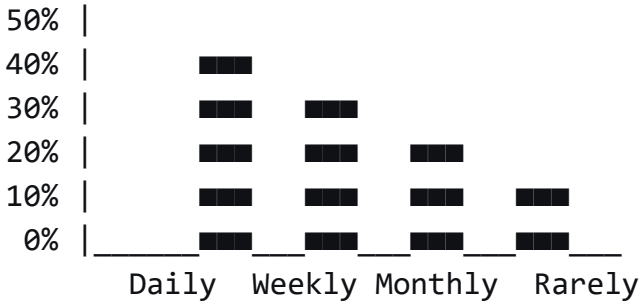
When to Use Bar Charts:

- Comparing categories
- Showing frequencies
- Simple, clear visual

Example Bar Chart Description:

text

Figure 4.1: Frequency of Mobile Money Use Among Farmers



C**. PIE CHARTS**

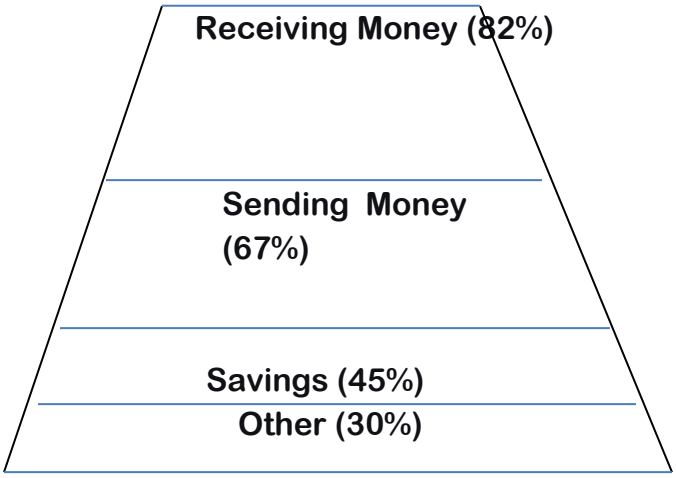
Pie charts show proportions of a whole.

When to Use Pie Charts:

- Showing percentage breakdown
- When categories sum to 100%
- Limited number of categories (5 or fewer)

Example Pie Chart Description:

Figure 4.2: Types of Mobile Money Transactions



D. LINE GRAPHS

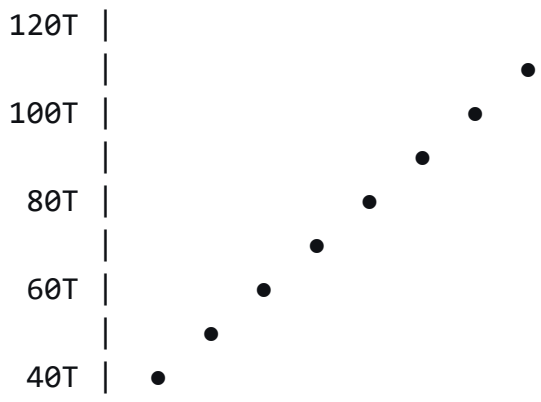
Line graphs show trends over time.

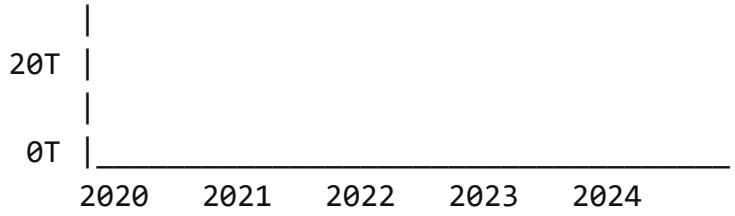
When to Use Line Graphs:

- Showing change over time
- Comparing trends
- Continuous data

Example Line Graph Description:

Figure 4.3: Mobile Money Transactions in Uganda 2020-2024 (Trillions UGX)





E. OTHER VISUALIZATIONS

Type	Use For	Example	
Histogram	Distribution of continuous data	Age distribution of farmers	
Scatter plot	Relationship between two variables	Farm size vs. mobile money usage	
Maps	Geographic data	Location of mobile money agents	
Infographics	Combining multiple visuals	Summary of key findings	

4.11 CHOOSING APPROPRIATE PRESENTATION METHODS

Type of Data	Appropriate Presentation
Categories (nominal)	Bar chart, pie chart, table
Ordered categories (ordinal)	Bar chart, table
Numbers (interval/ratio)	Table, line graph, histogram
Comparisons	Bar chart, table
Trends over time	Line graph
Proportions	Pie chart, stacked bar chart
Relationships	Scatter plot, table
Geographic patterns	Map

4.12 LABELING AND TITLING

Every table and figure must have:

1. **Number:** Table 1, Figure 1 (numbered sequentially)
2. **Title:** Clear description of what is shown
3. **Labels:** What each axis/column represents
4. **Units:** What the numbers mean (percentages, counts, shillings)
5. **Source:** If from secondary data

Example:

```
Table 4.3: Farmers' Reported Challenges with Mobile Money (N=92)
--------------------------------------------------
Challenge                    Number    Percentage
--------------------------------------------------
High withdrawal fees          70           76%
Network problems               63          68%
Agent lacks cash               48          52%
Fraud concerns                 38          41%
Difficulty using phone         21          23%
--------------------------------------------------
Source: Field survey, 2025
```

LEARNING OUTCOME 4(d): Understand mathematical and statistical concepts used in data presentation (u, s, gs, v, a)

4.13 BASIC STATISTICAL CONCEPTS

A. FREQUENCY AND PERCENTAGE

Frequency: The number of times something occurs.

Percentage: Frequency divided by total, multiplied by 100.

Formula: Percentage = (Frequency ÷ Total) × 100

Example:
If 70 out of 92 farmers report high fees as a challenge:
Percentage = (70 ÷ 92) × 100 = 76.1%

B. MEASURES OF CENTRAL TENDENCY

Mean (Average): Sum of all values divided by number of values.

Example: Daily mobile money transactions: 5, 8, 12, 6, 9
Mean = (5+8+12+6+9) ÷ 5 = 40 ÷ 5 = 8 transactions

Median: Middle value when data is arranged in order.

Example: Transaction amounts: 2,000, 5,000, 10,000, 15,000, 50,000
Median = 10,000 (middle value)

Mode: Most frequently occurring value.

Example: Common transaction amounts: 5,000 appears 12 times, 10,000 appears 8 times
Mode = 5,000

C. MEASURES OF DISPERSION

Range: Highest value minus lowest value.

Example: Farmer incomes: 200,000 to 2,000,000
Range = 2,000,000 - 200,000 = 1,800,000

D. TABULATION

Tabulation is the process of organizing data into tables.

Steps in Tabulation:

1. **Code responses:** Assign numbers to categories (Male=1, Female=2)
2. **Enter data:** In Excel or by hand in a tally sheet
3. **Count frequencies:** How many in each category
4. **Calculate percentages:** Convert to percentages
5. **Create table:** Organize in clear format

Tally Sheet Example:

```
Question: How often do you use mobile money?

Response        Tally                                   Frequency
Daily           ||||| ||||| ||                             12
Weekly          ||||| ||||| |||| |||| ||||| ||||| ||||| |||   38
Monthly         ||||| ||||| |||| |||| |                    31
Rarely          ||||| ||||| |                              11
Never           ||||| |||                                  8
```

E. PERCENTILES

A percentile is the value below which a given percentage of observations fall.

Example: If your score is in the 80th percentile, you scored higher than 80% of people.

4.14 COMPUTATION EXAMPLES

Example 1: Calculating Percentages

Survey of 100 farmers:

- 58 male, 42 female
- 82 use mobile money

Percentage male = (58 ÷ 100) × 100 = 58%
Percentage female = (42 ÷ 100) × 100 = 42%
Percentage using mobile money = (82 ÷ 100) × 100 = 82%

Example 2: Calculating Mean

Daily mobile money transactions for one week:
Monday: 45, Tuesday: 52, Wednesday: 38, Thursday: 61, Friday: 73, Saturday: 84, Sunday: 29

Sum = 45+52+38+61+73+84+29 = 382
Mean = 382 ÷ 7 = 54.6 transactions per day

Example 3: Creating a Frequency Table

Age distribution of 100 farmers:

Age Group	Frequency	Percentage
18-30	23	23%
31-45	41	41%
46-60	27	27%
Over 60	9	9%
Total	**100**	**100%**

4.15 CONVERSIONS

Percentage to Decimal: Divide by 100

- 76% = 0.76

Decimal to Percentage: Multiply by 100

- 0.45 = 45%

Fraction to Percentage: Divide numerator by denominator, multiply by 100

- 3/4 = 3 ÷ 4 = 0.75 × 100 = 75%

4.16 MENSTRUATION (MEASUREMENT)

In research, measurement involves assigning numbers to observations according to rules.

Levels of Measurement:

Level	Description	Example	Statistics Possible
Nominal	Categories, no order	Gender, district	Frequencies, mode
Ordinal	Ordered categories	Education level (Primary, Secondary, Tertiary)	Median, percentiles
Interval	Equal intervals, no true zero	Temperature, year	Mean, standard deviation
Ratio	Equal intervals, true zero	Income, age, farm size	All statistics

---

SENIOR SIX

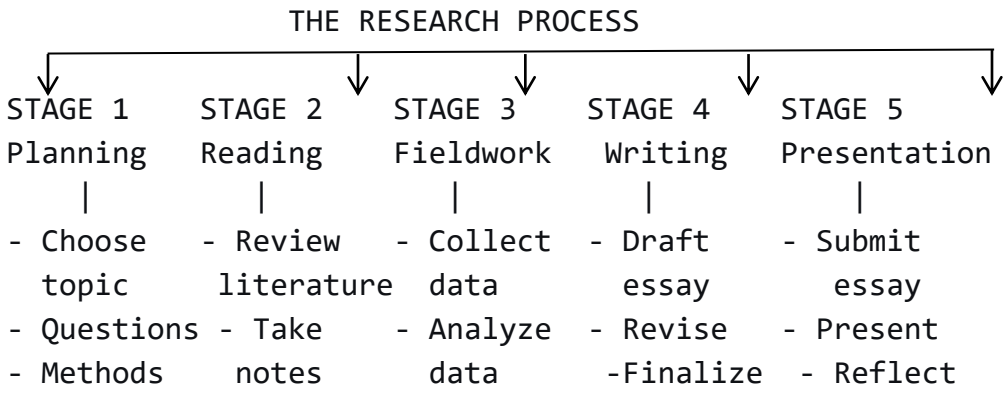
TOPIC 5: INDIVIDUAL PROJECT

Duration: 90 Periods

Competency: The learner devises innovative ways of solving societal problems through carrying out an independent investigation and proposing feasible solutions in order to improve community wellbeing.

LEARNING OUTCOME 5(a): Carry out individual research projects on a societal challenge and present findings in an Extended Essay between 3,000-4,000 words (k, u, s, v/a)

5.1 THE RESEARCH PROCESS: OVERVIEW



5.2 STAGE 1: PLANNING (Completed in S.5)

By Senior Six, you should have:

- Chosen your topic
- Developed research questions
- Reviewed initial literature
- Selected methods
- Developed data collection tools
- Obtained necessary permissions

5.3 STAGE 2: FIELDWORK (Data Collection)

Before You Go:

- Ensure tools are ready (enough copies)
- Have identification (school letter)
- Know how to reach your study area
- Arrange appointments if needed
- Prepare materials (notebooks, pens, recording device, camera)

During Data Collection:

Activity	Tips
Administering questionnaires	Explain purpose, assure confidentiality, check completeness before leaving
Conducting interviews	Build rapport, listen actively, probe, record (with permission), take notes
Observation	Be unobtrusive, take detailed notes, record time/date/location
Document collection	Note source, date, record details for citation

Ethical Practices During Data Collection:

1. **Informed consent:** Explain purpose and get agreement
2. **Confidentiality:** Don't share personal information
3. **Respect:** Be polite, respectful of culture and norms
4. **Do no harm:** Avoid causing distress
5. **Thank participants:** Express gratitude
6. **Keep promises:** If you promised to share findings, do so

Sample Consent Form:

CONSENT FORM

Title of Study: _____

Researcher: _____

```
I understand that:
- My participation is voluntary
- I can withdraw at any time
- My responses will be kept confidential
- My name will not be used in any report

I agree to participate in this research.

Name: _____ Signature: _____

Date: _____

Researcher's Signature: _____
```

5.4 STAGE 3: DATA ANALYSIS

For Quantitative Data (Numbers):

1. **Clean data:** Check for errors, missing responses
2. **Code data:** Assign numbers to categories
3. **Enter data:** In Excel or by hand
4. **Calculate frequencies:** Count responses
5. **Calculate percentages:** Convert to percentages
6. **Create tables and charts:** Organize visually
7. **Interpret:** What do the numbers mean?

For Qualitative Data (Words):

1. **Transcribe:** Write out interviews verbatim
2. **Read thoroughly:** Get familiar with data
3. **Code:** Label segments with themes
4. **Group codes:** Organize into categories
5. **Identify themes:** What patterns emerge?
6. **Select quotes:** Choose illustrative examples
7. **Interpret:** What do themes mean?

Example of Coding Qualitative Data:

```
Interview excerpt:                                          Codes:
"I use mobile money mostly when my son in Kampala     - Receiving money
sends me money for school fees. Before mobile         - Remittances
money, he would send through a bus driver, and        - Before/after co
mparison
sometimes the money would get lost or delayed.        - Problems before
Now, I receive it instantly. It has helped a lot      - Benefits now
because I can pay fees on time and the children       - School fees
don't get sent home."                                  - Impact on educ
ation

Themes emerging:
- Mobile money facilitates remittances
- Previous methods were risky
- Mobile money improves timeliness
- Benefits extend to children's education
```

5.5 STAGE 4: WRITING THE EXTENDED ESSAY

Writing Process:

Step	Activity	Timeline
1	Draft introduction	Week 1-2
2	Draft literature review	Week 2-4
3	Draft methodology	Week 4-5
4	Draft findings	Week 5-7
5	Draft discussion/conclusion	Week 7-8
6	Complete first draft	Week 8
7	Revise and edit	Week 9
8	Finalize references and appendices	Week 10
9	Proofread	Week 10
10	Submit	Week 11

5.6 WRITING TIPS

General Tips:

- Write regularly, don't leave everything to the end
- Start with the sections you find easiest
- Keep your research questions visible as you write
- Save frequently and back up your work
- Show drafts to your teacher for feedback

For Each Section:

Introduction:

- Write after you know what you found? Or write first and revise later?
- Keep it focused on setting up your research questions

Literature Review:

- Group sources by theme, not by source
- Show relationships between studies
- End with gap that your research addresses

Methodology:

- Be specific enough that someone could replicate your study
- Justify your choices
- Acknowledge limitations

Findings:

- Organize by research question or theme
- Use subheadings
- Present data first, then quotes as illustration
- Let your data speak

Discussion:

- Don't just repeat findings—interpret them
- Connect to literature

- Explain implications
- Be honest about limitations

Conclusion:

- Summarize main answers to research questions
- Make concrete recommendations
- Suggest future research

5.7 REVISING AND EDITING

Checklist for Revision:

Content:

- Does the essay answer the research questions?
- Is the argument clear and logical?
- Is there sufficient evidence for claims?
- Are sources properly integrated and cited?

Structure:

- Is there a clear introduction with research questions?
- Does each paragraph have a clear topic sentence?
- Are there smooth transitions between sections?
- Does the conclusion summarize and recommend?

Clarity:

- Is the writing clear and understandable?
- Are sentences varied in length and structure?
- Is jargon explained?
- Would someone outside your topic understand?

Accuracy:

- Are facts and figures correct?
- Are names spelled correctly?
- Are citations accurate?

- Is the reference list complete and correct?

Presentation:

- Is the title page complete?
- Is there a table of contents?
- Are tables and figures numbered and titled?
- Are appendices labeled?
- Is the formatting consistent?

5.8 WORD COUNT GUIDELINES

Section	Approximate Word Count
Introduction	400-600 words
Literature Review	800-1,000 words
Methodology	400-600 words
Findings	800-1,000 words
Discussion	400-600 words
Conclusion	200-400 words
Total	**3,000-4,000 words**

Note: Word count excludes title page, contents, references, appendices, and reflection.

5.9 COMMON PITFALLS TO AVOID

Pitfall	How to Avoid
Topic too broad	Narrow focus geographically or by population
Too many research questions	Stick to 3-5 focused questions
Weak literature review	Read widely, synthesize, identify gaps
Poor methodology	Be specific, justify choices, pilot test
Insufficient data	Collect more than you think you need

Description without analysis	Always ask "So what? What does this mean?"
Ignoring contradictory data	Address it honestly, explain
Weak conclusion	Summarize, answer questions, recommend
Plagiarism	Cite everything, paraphrase carefully
Last-minute rush	Start early, write regularly

LEARNING OUTCOME 5(b): Presentation of Extended Essay and addressing concerns raised after presentation (s, gs)

5.10 PREPARING FOR PRESENTATION

After submitting your essay, you may be required to present your findings to teachers and peers.

Purpose of Presentation:

- Demonstrate your knowledge
- Share findings with others
- Receive feedback
- Defend your work
- Practice communication skills

5.11 STRUCTURE OF PRESENTATION

Element	Time	Content
Introduction	1-2 minutes	Title, topic, why you chose it, research questions
Methods	1-2 minutes	How you conducted research (who, where, how)
Key findings	3-4 minutes	Main results, with visual aids

Conclusions	1-2 minutes	What you concluded, recommendations
Questions	3-5 minutes	Answer questions from audience

5.12 PREPARING VISUAL AIDS

Tips for Effective Slides:

Do	Don't
Use bullet points, not paragraphs	Don't crowd slides with text
Include visuals (charts, photos)	Don't use clipart
Large font (at least 24pt)	Don't use tiny fonts
Simple, consistent design	Don't use distracting animations
Practice with your slides	Don't read directly from slides

Sample Presentation Slides:

```
SLIDE 1: TITLE
----------------------------------------
THE IMPACT OF MOBILE MONEY ON SMALL-SCALE
FARMERS IN KASESE DISTRICT

Namutebi Sarah
St. Mary's College, Kisubi
General Paper Extended Essay
2025
----------------------------------------

SLIDE 2: INTRODUCTION
----------------------------------------
Research Questions:
1. How do farmers in Kasese use mobile money?
2. What impact has mobile money had on their
   farming activities?
```

3. What challenges do they face?
4. What improvements do they suggest?

Why this topic?
- Mobile money is widespread
- Farmers are crucial to Uganda's economy
- Limited research on farmers' experiences

SLIDE 3: METHODOLOGY

Study Area: Kasese district (3 sub-counties)

Methods:
- Survey: 100 farmers
- Interviews: 15 farmers
- Observation at 5 agent locations

Sample:
- 58% male, 42% female
- 64% farm less than 1 hectare

SLIDE 4: KEY FINDING 1 - USAGE

Mobile Money Usage Among Farmers:

Daily: 12%
Weekly: 38%
Monthly: 31%
Rarely: 11%
Never: 8%

[Bar chart showing these percentages]

SLIDE 5: KEY FINDING 2 - IMPACTS

Positive Impacts Reported:

Access to inputs improved: 80%
Easier to sell produce: 62%
Use for savings: 45%

"Now, when my brother sends money, I can go
immediately to buy seeds before they run out."
- Farmer, Kisinga

SLIDE 6: KEY FINDING 3 - CHALLENGES

Challenges Reported:

High withdrawal fees: 76%
Network problems: 68%
Agent lacks cash: 52%
Fraud concerns: 41%

[Pie chart showing challenges]

SLIDE 7: CONCLUSIONS

- Mobile money is widely used by farmers
- It improves access to inputs and markets
- But significant barriers limit benefits
- Farmers want lower fees and better service

Recommendations:
- Providers: Lower fees, farmer-specific products
- Government: Improve network, consumer protection
- Farmers: Form groups, seek training

SLIDE 8: THANK YOU

Thank you for listening!

```
Questions?
----------------------------------------
```

5.13 PRESENTATION SKILLS

Before the Presentation:

- Practice several times
- Time yourself
- Anticipate questions
- Prepare notes (not full script)
- Check equipment

During the Presentation:

Skill	Tips
Eye contact	Look at audience, not just slides
Voice	Speak clearly, vary tone, not too fast
Posture	Stand straight, don't fidget
Gestures	Use hands naturally to emphasize
Pacing	Don't rush, pause at key points
Handling nerves	Breathe deeply, remember you know your topic

Handling Questions:

Situation	Response
Question you know	Answer clearly, concisely
Question you're unsure	"That's a good question. Based on my research..."
Question you can't answer	"I didn't investigate that aspect, but it would be interesting for future research."
Hostile question	Stay calm, respond professionally
Unclear question	"Could you please clarify what you mean?"

LEARNING OUTCOME 5(c): Writing and presentation of a reflection note (s, gs, v/a)

5.14 WHAT IS A REFLECTION NOTE?

A reflection note is a personal account of your learning journey through the Extended Essay process. It captures what you learned, how you changed, challenges you faced, and how you grew.

Purpose of Reflection:

- Document your learning process
- Demonstrate self-awareness
- Connect experience to personal growth
- Provide insights for future researchers
- Complete the research cycle

5.15 STRUCTURE OF REFLECTION NOTE

Element	What to Include
Introduction	Briefly describe your topic and why you chose it
The journey	Describe the process: planning, reading, fieldwork, writing
Challenges	What difficulties did you face? How did you overcome them?
Learning	What did you learn about your topic? About research? About yourself?
Skills developed	What skills did you gain or improve?
Changes	How have you changed through this process?
Advice	What advice would you give future students?
Conclusion	Final thoughts on the experience

5.16 SAMPLE REFLECTION NOTE

REFLECTION NOTE

Topic: The Impact of Mobile Money on Small-Scale Farmers in Kasese District

When I first chose my topic, I thought I knew what I was getting into.
My father is a farmer, and I had seen him use mobile money many times.
How difficult could it be to study something so familiar? As I sit here
now, months later, with my completed essay before me, I realize how much
I underestimated the journey ahead and how much I have grown because of it.

The Journey

My research began with excitement and naivety. I loved my topic and couldn't
wait to dive in. But when I started reading, I was overwhelmed. There were
so many articles, reports, and studies! How would I ever read them all?
My teacher advised me to focus on the most relevant ones and to read with
Purpose always asking "How does this help answer my research questions?"
This became my mantra throughout the process.

Developing my questionnaire was harder than I expected. My first draft had
questions that were too vague or too complicated. My pilot test with 10 farmers
was humbling—they pointed out confusing wording, questions they didn't
understand, and options I had forgotten to include. I revised three times
before I felt confident.

Fieldwork was both the most challenging and most rewarding part. Waking at
dawn to reach farmers before they went to their gardens. Walking long distances
between villages. Being welcomed into people's homes and hearing their stories.
One farmer invited me to share lunch with his family after our interview.
Another walked with me to introduce me to his neighbors. These moments reminded
me that research is ultimately about people, not just data.

The writing phase tested my discipline. Some days the words flowed; other days
I stared at a blank screen for hours. I learned to write even when I didn't
feel inspired, knowing I could revise later. My teachers' feedback was

invaluable—pointing out gaps in my arguments, questions I hadn't fully answered, and sections that needed more evidence.

Challenges

I faced numerous challenges. Network problems meant some interviews had to be rescheduled. Several farmers were initially suspicious, wondering why a student would want to ask them questions. I learned to explain my purpose clearly and to build trust by being respectful and patient.

The biggest challenge was balancing this project with my other subjects. There were weeks when I felt overwhelmed, with assignments piling up and my essay progress slow. I learned to break the work into smaller tasks and to celebrate small victories—completing a section, analyzing one set of data, writing one paragraph.

What I Learned

About my topic, I learned that mobile money has transformed farmers' lives in ways I hadn't imagined. Beyond the obvious benefits of receiving and sending money, farmers use it to save, to access inputs, to respond to emergencies. But I also learned about the barriers—the fees that eat into their earnings, the network failures that leave them stranded, the fraud that preys on the vulnerable.

About research, I learned that it is messy and unpredictable. Things don't always go according to plan. But that's okay—adaptability is part of the process. I learned that good research requires patience, attention to detail, and the humility to listen.

About myself, I discovered strengths I didn't know I had. I can persevere through difficulties. I can talk to strangers and make them feel comfortable. I can analyze information and draw conclusions. I am more capable than I thought.

Skills Developed

Through this process, I developed:
- Research skills: formulating questions, designing tools, collecting data

- Analytical skills: interpreting data, identifying patterns, drawing conclusions
- Writing skills: structuring arguments, integrating evidence, citing sources
- Communication skills: interviewing, presenting, explaining my work
- Time management: planning, prioritizing, meeting deadlines
- Resilience: coping with setbacks, persisting through difficulties

Changes in Me

This project has changed me in subtle but significant ways. I now notice things I previously overlooked—the mobile money agent under the tree, the farmer checking her phone, the challenges people face daily. I ask more questions and accept simple answers less readily. I have more confidence in my ability to investigate problems and contribute to solutions.

I also feel more connected to my community. The farmers who shared their time with me are not just research subjects—they are people with hopes and struggles, and I now understand them better. I want to use what I have learned to help, even in small ways.

Advice for Future Students

To students who will undertake this journey next year, I offer this advice:

1. Choose a topic you genuinely care about. You will spend months with it; make sure you love it.

2. Start early and work steadily. Small, consistent effort beats last-minute cramming.

3. Listen to your teachers. Their feedback is gold.

4. Pilot test everything. It saves heartache later.

5. Be present during fieldwork. Put away your phone, listen deeply, and appreciate the privilege of hearing people's stories.

6. Write something every day, even if it's just a paragraph.

7. Take care of yourself. Rest, eat well, and don't let the project consume you.

8. Celebrate completing each stage. Acknowledge your progress.

9. Remember why you started. When it gets hard, reconnect with your purpose.

10. Be proud of what you accomplish, whatever the outcome. You did something difficult and meaningful.

Conclusion

As I close this reflection, I feel grateful—for the farmers who trusted me with their stories, for my teachers who guided me, for my family who supported me, and for this opportunity to grow. The essay I produced is important, but the person I became through producing it is even more so.

I am no longer just a student who learns from books. I am a researcher who investigates, a writer who communicates, and a young person who contributes. This is just the beginning.

Namutebi Sarah
2025

5.17 PRESENTING THE REFLECTION

You may be asked to share your reflection orally.

Tips for Reflection Presentation:

- Be honest and personal
- Share specific stories and examples
- Focus on your learning and growth
- Include both struggles and successes
- Keep it to 5-7 minutes
- End with what you'll take forward

FINAL CHECKLIST FOR EXTENDED ESSAY

Before Submission:

Front Matter:

- Title page complete with all required information
- Table of contents with page numbers
- Lists of tables and figures (if applicable)

Main Body:

- Introduction with background, problem, purpose, research questions
- Literature review synthesizing relevant sources
- Methodology with clear description of methods
- Findings presented clearly with tables/figures
- Discussion interpreting findings
- Conclusion answering research questions with recommendations

Back Matter:

- References complete and correctly formatted
- Appendices with tools, consent forms, etc.
- Reflection note

Quality Checks:

- Word count within 3,000-4,000 range
- All sources cited in text match reference list
- No plagiarism (all quotes and paraphrases cited)
- Writing clear and error-free
- Formatting consistent
- Read by teacher for feedback

GLOSSARY OF KEY TERMS

Term	Definition
Abstract	Brief summary of the entire essay

Analysis	Breaking down information to understand it
Appendix	Supplementary material at end of essay
Bibliography	List of all sources consulted
Citation	Reference to a source within the text
Conclusion	Final section summarizing findings
Data	Information collected during research
Discussion	Section interpreting findings
Findings	What the research discovered
Hypothesis	Proposed explanation to be tested
Literature review	Survey of existing research on topic
Methodology	How research was conducted
Plagiarism	Using others' work without credit
Qualitative	Non-numerical data (words, observations)
Quantitative	Numerical data
Recommendation	Suggestions based on findings
Reference	Source cited in essay
Reliability	Consistency of measurement
Sample	Subset of population studied
Validity	Whether research measures what it claims

COMPREHENSIVE COVERAGE OF DATA COLLECTION METHODS

For General Paper Extended Essay

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1. QUESTIONNAIRES

1.1 Definition

A **questionnaire** is a research instrument consisting of a series of questions and other prompts for the purpose of gathering information from respondents. It is a structured way of collecting data, usually from a large number of people.

1.2 Types of Questionnaires

Type	Description	Example Use
Self-administered	Respondents complete on their own	Distributed in schools, offices
Interviewer-administered	Researcher reads questions and records answers	For respondents with low literacy
Online/Digital	Distributed via internet (Google Forms, SurveyMonkey)	For respondents with internet access
Postal/Mail	Sent and returned by post	For geographically dispersed populations
Group-administered	Given to groups together (classes, meetings)	Efficient for captive audiences

1.3 Types of Questions in Questionnaires

A. Closed-Ended Questions

Questions that provide predetermined response options.

1. Dichotomous Questions (Two options)

```
text
Example:
Do you use mobile money?
[ ] Yes
[ ] No
```

2. Multiple Choice Questions (Single answer)

```
text
Example:
How often do you use mobile money?
[ ] Daily
```

[ ] Weekly
[ ] Monthly
[ ] Rarely
[ ] Never

3. Multiple Response Questions (Select all that apply)

text
Example:
What do you use mobile money for? (Tick all that apply)
[ ] Receiving money from family/friends
[ ] Sending money to family/friends
[ ] Saving money
[ ] Paying for goods in shops
[ ] Buying airtime
[ ] Paying school fees
[ ] Taking loans
[ ] Other (please specify): _____

4. Likert Scale Questions (Rating agreement)

Example:
Please indicate your level of agreement with the following statements:

	Strongest agree	agree	neutral	disagree	Strongly disagree
Mobile money is easy to use					
Mobile money fees are too high					
Mobile money has improved my farming					
I trust mobile money services					

5. Semantic Differential Scale (Opposite adjectives)

```
Example:
How would you describe mobile money services?

Convenient   [ ] [ ] [ ] [ ] [ ]   Inconvenient
Affordable   [ ] [ ] [ ] [ ] [ ]   Expensive
Reliable     [ ] [ ] [ ] [ ] [ ]   Unreliable
```

6. Ranking Questions

```
Example:
Rank the following challenges you face with mobile money from 1 (most
challenging)
to 5 (least challenging):

___ High withdrawal fees
___ Network problems
___ Agent running out of cash
___ Fear of fraud
___ Difficulty using the phone
```

7. Numerical/Quantity Questions

```
Example:
How much money do you typically transact monthly using mobile money?
[ ] Less than 50,000 UGX
[ ] 50,000 - 200,000 UGX
[ ] 200,001 - 500,000 UGX
[ ] 500,001 - 1,000,000 UGX
[ ] More than 1,000,000 UGX
```

B. Open-Ended Questions

Questions that allow respondents to answer in their own words.

1. Free Response Questions

```
Example:
```

What suggestions do you have for improving mobile money services for farmers?

_____
_____
_____

2. Short Answer Questions

Example:
Why do you prefer using mobile money over traditional banking?
_____

3. Sentence Completion

Example:
The main reason I started using mobile money was _____
_____
_____

4. Probing Questions (follow-ups)

Example:
You mentioned that you sometimes have problems with mobile money.
Can you describe a specific time when this happened?

_____
_____

1.4 Questionnaire Design Principles

DO's:

Principle	Explanation	Example

Keep it clear	Use simple language respondents understand	Instead of: "What is your frequency of mobile money utilization?" Use: "How often do you use mobile money?"
Keep it brief	Respect respondents' time	Limit to 4-6 pages, 20-30 questions
Logical flow	Group related questions	Demographics first, then main content
Easy to easy	Start with simple, non-threatening questions	Age, gender before sensitive topics
Specific	Avoid vague terms	Instead of "Do you use mobile money often?" Use specific frequency options
Mutually exclusive options	No overlapping categories	Age: 18-25, 26-35, 36-45 (not 18-25, 25-35)
Exhaustive options	Cover all possibilities	Include "Other (specify)" option
Pilot test	Try before final use	Test with 5-10 similar respondents

DON'Ts:

Mistake	Problem	Example	Improved
Leading questions	Suggests desired answer	"Don't you agree that mobile money fees are too high?"	"What do you think about mobile money fees?"
Double-barreled questions	Asks two things at once	"Do you use mobile money for saving and paying bills?"	Separate into two questions
Ambiguous questions	Unclear meaning	"Do you use mobile money frequently?"	"How often do you use mobile money?" with options
Jargon/technical terms	Respondents may not understand	"Do you utilize fintech solutions?"	"Do you use mobile money?"
Presuming knowledge	Assumes respondents know something	"How has mobile money affected your liquidity?"	"How has mobile money affected your ability to access cash

			when needed?"
Negative wording	Can be confusing	"Do you disagree that mobile money is not beneficial?"	"Do you think mobile money is beneficial?"
Overlapping categories	Respondent unsure where to tick	Age: 20-30, 30-40	Age: 20-29, 30-39

1.5 Advantages and Disadvantages of Questionnaires

1.6 Steps to Develop a Questionnaire

Advantages	Disadvantages
Can reach many respondents	Low response rates possible
Relatively inexpensive	Cannot clarify misunderstandings
Anonymous, encouraging honesty	Requires literacy
Easy to analyze quantitative data	Limited depth
Consistent questions for all	May miss unexpected information
Can be completed at respondent's convenience	No control over who actually responds
Less pressure than interviews	Cannot observe non-verbal cues
Standardized format	Questions may be misinterpreted
Easy to compare responses	Cannot probe for more detail
Can cover sensitive topics	May get superficial answers

Step 1: Define Objectives

- What do you need to know?
- Link each question to a research question

Step 2: Draft Questions

- Write more questions than you need

- Use appropriate question types

Step 3: Review and Refine

- Check for clarity, bias, and relevance
- Remove duplicates and unnecessary questions

Step 4: Organize

- Logical flow (funnel approach: broad to specific)
- Group similar topics
- Place sensitive questions later

Step 5: Write Instructions

- Clear explanation of purpose
- How to answer each section
- Confidentiality assurance
- Thank you note

Step 6: Pilot Test

- Test with 5-10 people
- Get feedback on clarity
- Identify problems
- Revise accordingly

Step 7: Finalize and Produce

- Professional layout
- Enough copies
- Coding system if needed

1.7 Sample Complete Questionnaire

QUESTIONNAIRE FOR FARMERS

Topic: The Impact of Mobile Money on Small-Scale Farmers in Kasese District

Researcher: _____ Date: _____

School: _____

Dear Participant,
I am a Senior Five student conducting research on how mobile money affects farmers in this area. Your participation is voluntary and anonymous. Information you provide will be used only for this research and will be kept confidential. You may withdraw at any time.

Please tick (✓) or write your response where appropriate.

SECTION A: **BACKGROUND INFORMATION**

A1. Gender:

- [ ] Male
- [ ] Female

A2. Age group:

- [ ] 18-25 years
- [ ] 26-35 years
- [ ] 36-45 years
- [ ] 46-60 years
- [ ] Over 60 years

A3. Highest level of education:

- [ ] No formal education
- [ ] Primary level
- [ ] Secondary level
- [ ] Tertiary level
- [ ] University level

A4. Marital status:

- [ ] Single
- [ ] Married
- [ ] Divorced/Separated
- [ ] Widowed

A5. Sub-county of residence:

- [ ] Busongora
- [ ] Kisinga
- [ ] Maliba
- [ ] Other (specify): _____

A6. How long have you been farming?

- [ ] Less than 5 years
- [ ] 5-10 years
- [ ] 11-20 years
- [ ] More than 20 years

A7. What is the size of your farm?

- [ ] Less than 1 acre
- [ ] 1-2 acres
- [ ] 3-5 acres
- [ ] More than 5 acres

A8. What are your main crops? (Tick all that apply)

- Matoke/bananas
- [ ] Coffee
- [ ] Maize
- [ ] Beans
- [ ] Cassava
- [ ] Vegetables
- Other (specify): _____

SECTION B: MOBILE MONEY ACCESS AND USAGE

B1. Do you own a mobile phone?

[ ] Yes

[ ] No (If No, skip to Section E)

B2. Do you use mobile money services?

[ ] Yes

[ ] No (If No, skip to Section E)

B3. Which mobile money service(s) do you use? (Tick all that apply)

[ ] MTN Mobile Money

[ ] Airtel Money

[ ] M-Sente

[ ] Africell Money

[ ] Other (specify): _____

B4. How long have you been using mobile money?

[ ] Less than 1 year

[ ] 1-2 years

[ ] 3-4 years

[ ] 5 years or more

B5. How often do you use mobile money?

[ ] Daily

[ ] 2-3 times per week

[ ] Once a week

[ ] 2-3 times per month

[ ] Once a month

[ ] Less than once a month

B6. What do you use mobile money for? (Tick all that apply)

[ ] Receiving money from family/friends

[ ] Sending money to family/friends

[ ] Saving money

[ ] Paying for goods in shops

[ ] Buying airtime

[ ] Paying school fees

[ ] Paying utility bills (water, electricity)

[ ] Receiving payments for produce

[ ] Taking loans

[ ] Other (specify): _____

B7. Approximately how much money do you transact monthly using mobile money?

[ ] Less than 50,000 UGX

[ ] 50,000 - 200,000 UGX

[ ] 200,001 - 500,000 UGX

[ ] 500,001 - 1,000,000 UGX

[ ] More than 1,000,000 UGX

B8. How far is the nearest mobile money agent from your home?

[ ] Less than 500 metres

[ ] 500 metres - 1 kilometre

[ ] 1-2 kilometres

[ ] 2-5 kilometres

[ ] More than 5 kilometres

SECTION C: IMPACT ON FARMING ACTIVITIES

C1. To what extent has mobile money improved your access to agricultural inputs (seeds, fertilizers, tools)?

[ ] Greatly improved

[ ] Somewhat improved

[ ] No change

[ ] Made it worse

[ ] Not applicable

C2. To what extent has mobile money made it easier to sell your produce?

[ ] Much easier

[ ] Somewhat easier

[ ] No change

[ ] More difficult

[ ] Not applicable

C3. Do you use mobile money to save money for farming purposes?

[ ] Yes, regularly

[ ] Yes, sometimes

[ ] No

C4. Has mobile money helped you during farming emergencies (crop failure, livestock disease, etc.)?

[ ] Yes, greatly

[ ] Yes, somewhat

[ ] No

[ ] Not applicable

C5. Please indicate your level of agreement with the following statements:

STATEMENT	Strongly agree	agree	Neutral	Disagree	Strongly disagree
Mobile money has increased my farm income					
I can respond faster to farming opportunities					
Mobile money has reduced my transport cost					
I feel more financially secure with mobile money					
Mobile money has improved my family's welfare					

C6. Can you describe one way mobile money has positively affected your farming?

_____

_____

_____

SECTION D: CHALLENGES AND BARRIERS

D1. What challenges have you experienced with mobile money? (Tick all that apply)

[ ] Withdrawal fees are too high

[ ] Network problems/poor connectivity

[ ] Agent runs out of cash

[ ] Agent runs out of float (e- money)

[ ] Fear of being cheated/fraud

[ ] Difficulty using the phone/menu

[ ] Transactions take too long

[ ] Agents charge extra fees illegally

[ ] PIN/security concerns

[ ] No agent nearby

[ ] Other (specify): _____

D2. Which of these challenges is the MOST significant to you? (Choose one)

[ ] High fees

[ ] Network problems

[ ] Agent liquidity issues

[ ] Fraud concerns

[ ] Other (specify): _____

D3. How often do you experience network problems when trying to use mobile money?

[ ] Always

[ ] Often

[ ] Sometimes

[ ] Rarely

[ ] Never

D4. Have you ever lost money through mobile money fraud?

[ ] Yes

[ ] No

D5. If yes to D4, approximately how much did you lose?

[ ] Less than 50,000 UGX

[ ] 50,000 - 200,000 UGX

[ ] 200,001 - 500,000 UGX

[ ] More than 500,000 UGX

[ ] Prefer not to say

D6. Have you ever received any training on how to use mobile money safely?

[ ] Yes

[ ] No

D7. If yes to D6, who provided the training?

[ ] Mobile money company (MTN/Airtel etc.)

[ ] Fellow farmers

[ ] Family member

[ ] Government extension worker

[ ] NGO

[ ] Other (specify): _____

-

SECTION E: **FOR NON-USERS OF MOBILE MONEY**

(Answer this section ONLY if you DO NOT use mobile money)

E1. What is the main reason you do not use mobile money?

[ ] I don't have a mobile phone

[ ] I don't know how to use it

[ ] I don't trust it

[ ] No agent nearby

[ ] Prefer using cash

[ ] Fees are too high

[ ] I don't see the need

[ ] Other (specify): _____

E2. Would you be interested in learning to use mobile money?

[ ] Yes

[ ] No

[ ] Not sure

E3. What would encourage you to start using mobile money?

_____

_____

SECTION F: SUGGESTIONS AND RECOMMENDATIONS

F1. What improvements would you like to see in mobile money services?

_____

_____

_____

F2. Do you have any other comments about mobile money and farming?

_____

_____

_____

THANK YOU FOR YOUR PARTICIPATION!

Your time and responses are greatly appreciated. If you have any questions about this research, please contact:

[Researcher Name]
[School Name]
[Contact Information]

For Official Use Only:
Questionnaire Number: _____
Date Collected: _____
Data Entry Completed: [ ] Yes [ ] No
Checked by: _____

---

2. INTERVIEWS

2.1 Definition

An **interview** is a qualitative data collection method involving a conversation between a researcher (interviewer) and a participant (interviewee) where questions are asked to gather in-depth information about a topic.

2.2 Types of Interviews

A. Based on Structure

Type	Description	Advantages	Disadvantages	Best For
Structured Interview	Predetermined questions, same order, same wording for all respondents	Consistent, easy to compare, reliable, requires less skill	Limited flexibility, cannot probe, may miss unexpected information	When you need comparable data from many respondents
Semi-Structured Interview	Interview guide with key questions, but flexibility to probe and explore	Balance of consistency and flexibility, can explore unexpected topics, rich data	Requires skill, harder to compare, time-consuming	Most common for qualitative research
Unstructured Interview	Open conversation guided by broad topics, no predetermined questions	Very flexible, deep exploration, unexpected insights	Very time-consuming, hard to compare, requires high skill, may go off-topic	Exploratory research, when little is known about topic

B. Based on Purpose

Type	Description	Example
Key Informant Interview	With experts or people with special knowledge	Agricultural officer, village elder, mobile money agent
In-depth Interview	Detailed exploration of one person's experience	A farmer's complete story of using mobile money

Focus Group Interview	Group discussion with 6-10 participants	Group of farmers discussing mobile money together
Life History Interview	Person's entire life story related to topic	An elder's experience with financial services over time
Elite Interview	With people in positions of power/authority	LC Chairperson, bank manager

C. Based on Mode

Mode	Description	Advantages	Disadvantages
Face-to-face	In-person conversation	Build rapport, observe non-verbal cues, rich data	Time, travel costs, scheduling challenges
Telephone	Interview by phone	Cheaper, faster, can reach distant respondents	No visual cues, may be interrupted, harder to build rapport
Video call	Using Zoom, WhatsApp, etc.	Visual contact, can record, reach distant	Requires internet, technical issues
Online chat	Text-based interview	Convenient, transcript automatic	Lacks verbal/visual cues, slow

2.3 Interview Question Types

Question Type	Description	Example
Opening questions	Easy, non-threatening to start	"Tell me a little about your farming."
Introductory questions	Introduce the main topic	"How did you first start using mobile money?"
Key questions	Core of the interview	"How has mobile money changed your farming practices?"
Probing questions	Follow up for more detail	"You mentioned it helps with buying inputs. Can you tell me more about how that works?"
Specifying questions	Ask for specific examples	"Can you give me a specific example of a time mobile money really helped you?"

Direct questions	Straightforward	"Do you trust mobile money agents?"
Indirect questions	Ask about others' experiences	"What do other farmers in this area think about mobile money?"
Structuring questions	Move to new topic	"Now I'd like to ask about challenges you face."
Silence	Allow thinking time	(Pause after response to encourage more)
Interpreting questions	Check understanding	"So what you're saying is that fees are your biggest concern. Is that right?"
Closing questions	Wind down, final thoughts	"Is there anything else you'd like to add about mobile money and farming?"

2.4 Probing Techniques

Probes encourage respondents to elaborate and provide richer data.

Probe Type	Description	Example
Silent probe	Pause and wait	(Nod and remain silent)
Echo probe	Repeat last few words	Respondent: "The fees are too high." Interviewer: "Too high?"
Uh-huh probe	Encouraging sounds	"Mm-hmm," "I see," "Interesting"
Tell-me-more probe	Direct request	"Can you tell me more about that?"
Example probe	Ask for specific instance	"Can you give me an example?"
Clarifying probe	Check understanding	"What do you mean by 'difficult'?"
Detail probe	Ask for specifics	"How much were the fees?" "When did that happen?"
Comparison probe	Compare situations	"How is it different now compared to before mobile money?"
Leading probe	Guide gently (use carefully)	"You mentioned network problems. How do they affect your transactions?"

2.5 Interview Guide Development

An interview guide lists the topics and questions to be covered.

Sample Semi-Structured Interview Guide:

INTERVIEW GUIDE FOR FARMERS

Topic: The Impact of Mobile Money on Small-Scale Farmers in Kasese District

Researcher: _____ Date: _____
Interviewee Code: _____ Location: _____
Start Time: _____ End Time: _____

BEFORE INTERVIEW:
- Thank participant for agreeing
- Explain purpose of research
- Explain confidentiality and anonymity
- Ask permission to record
- Get signed consent
- Explain they can stop anytime
- Ask if they have questions

SECTION 1: BACKGROUND AND FARMING (Warm-up, 5-10 minutes)

1. Tell me a little about yourself and your farming.
   (Probes: How long have you been farming? What do you grow?
   How large is your farm? Do you farm alone or with family?)

2. Can you describe a typical day on your farm?
   (Probes: What time do you start? What activities do you do? Who helps you?)

SECTION 2: INTRODUCTION TO MOBILE MONEY (5-10 minutes)

3. When did you first hear about mobile money?

(Probes: From whom? What did you think then?)

4. When did you start using mobile money yourself?
(Probes: What made you decide to start? Was it easy or difficult to learn?)

5. Can you walk me through how you typically use mobile money?
(Probes: What do you use it for most? How often? What amounts?)

SECTION 3: IMPACT ON FARMING (15-20 minutes)

6. How has mobile money changed the way you farm, if at all?
(Probes: Buying inputs? Selling produce? Getting information?
Managing money? Responding to problems?)

7. Can you tell me about a specific time when mobile money really helped you with your farming?
(Probes: What happened? How much did you transact?
What would have happened without mobile money?)

8. Has mobile money affected how you save money for farming?
(Probes: Do you save on your phone? For what purposes?
Is it different from how you saved before?)

9. Has mobile money affected your ability to respond to farming emergencies (like crop disease, livestock sickness, etc.)?
(Probes: Example? How quickly could you get money?)

10. Do you think mobile money has affected your farm income?
(Probes: How? Can you estimate how much?)

11. Are there any ways mobile money has negatively affected your farming?
(Probes: Problems? Unexpected costs? Risks?)

SECTION 4: CHALLENGES AND PROBLEMS (10-15 minutes)

12. What problems or challenges have you experienced with mobile money?
(Probes: Fees? Network? Agents? Fraud? Phone issues?)

13. Tell me about the most frustrating experience you've had with mobile money.
(Probes: What happened? How did you resolve it?
How did it affect you?)

14. How do you feel about mobile money fees?
(Probes: Are they fair? Too high? Do you understand how they work?)

15. Have you ever had problems with mobile money agents?
(Probes: Running out of cash? Extra charges? Rudeness?
Long waiting times?)

16. Have you ever experienced or worried about mobile money fraud?
(Probes: What happened? How did you deal with it?
Do you feel safe using mobile money?)

17. How reliable is the mobile network in your area for mobile money?
(Probes: When are problems worst? How do you cope when network is down?)

SECTION 5: COMPARISONS AND PREFERENCES (5-10 minutes)

18. How does mobile money compare to other ways of handling money
(banks, savings groups, keeping cash at home)?
(Probes: Which do you prefer? Why? For which purposes?)

19. If you could design the perfect mobile money service for farmers,
what would it look like?
(Probes: What features? What fees? What support?)

20. Would you recommend mobile money to other farmers? Why or why not?

SECTION 6: SUGGESTIONS AND CLOSING (5-10 minutes)

21. What would make mobile money more useful for farmers like you?
(Probes: From providers? From government? From farmer groups?)

22. Is there anything you wish mobile money providers understood about farmers?

23. Is there anything else you'd like to tell me about mobile money and farming?

24. Do you have any questions for me?

AFTER INTERVIEW:
- Thank participant warmly
- Stop recording
- Ask if they'd like summary of findings
- Note any observations about setting, non-verbal cues
- Write immediate reflections

POST-INTERVIEW NOTES:

Observations about setting/environment:
_____

Observations about participant (mood, body language, etc.):
_____

Anything unusual or particularly interesting:
_____

Initial thoughts/themes:
_____

Follow-up needed? [ ] Yes [ ] No
If yes, on what?
_____

2.6 Conducting Effective Interviews

Before the Interview

Task	Details
Prepare thoroughly	Know your topic, questions, and equipment
Arrange logistics	Confirm time, place, duration
Test equipment	Ensure recorder works, has batteries, enough memory
Prepare materials	Interview guide, consent forms, notebook, pen, identification
Dress appropriately	Respect local norms and culture
Arrive early	Show respect for participant's time

During the Interview

Phase	Key Actions
Introduction	Greet warmly, explain purpose, get consent, build rapport
Beginning	Start with easy, non-threatening questions
Middle	Ask key questions, probe for depth, listen actively
End	Wind down, ask for final thoughts, thank participant
After	Stop recording, make notes, thank again

Active Listening Skills

Skill	Description
Pay attention	Focus completely on respondent, not on next question
Show you're listening	Nod, maintain eye contact, use encouraging sounds
Provide feedback	Reflect, paraphrase, summarize
Defer judgment	Don't interrupt or criticize
Respond appropriately	Be respectful, empathetic, non-judgmental

Common Interview Mistakes to Avoid

Mistake	Why It's Problematic	Better Approach
Talking too much	You learn from listening, not talking	Let respondent do 80-90% of talking

Leading questions	Biases responses	Ask neutral, open questions
Interrupting	Disrupts respondent's thought	Wait for natural pause
Rushing	Misses depth	Allow silence, let respondent finish
Judging responses	Makes respondent defensive	Stay neutral and accepting
Poor recording	Loses data	Check equipment, take notes too
Not probing	Misses rich detail	Ask follow-up questions
Sticking rigidly to guide	Misses unexpected insights	Follow interesting threads
Multitasking	Shows disrespect	Give full attention
Forgetting non-verbal cues	Misses important information	Observe body language, tone

2.7 Advantages and Disadvantages of Interviews

Advantages	Disadvantages
Rich, detailed, in-depth data	Time-consuming
Can clarify and probe	Small sample size
Observe non-verbal cues	Interviewer may bias responses
Flexible, can follow unexpected topics	Difficult to analyze
High response rate	Requires skill and training
Build rapport, trust	May be influenced by power dynamics
Suitable for sensitive topics	Transcribing is tedious
Can adapt language to respondent	Scheduling challenges
Immediate follow-up possible	Travel costs
Respondent can ask for clarification	Recording may inhibit some

2.8 Recording and Transcribing Interviews

Recording Options

Method	Advantages	Disadvantages
Audio recording	Complete record, can focus on	May inhibit some, technical

	interview	issues
Video recording	Captures non-verbal, complete record	More inhibiting, larger files
Note-taking	Less inhibiting, immediate	May miss details, affects flow
Both record and take notes	Best of both	Requires more preparation

Transcription Guidelines

Guideline	Explanation
Transcribe verbatim	Every word, including ums, pauses, false starts
Include non-verbal	[laughs], [long pause], [crying]
Note interruptions	[phone rings], [child enters]
Use consistent notation	Develop system for pauses, emphasis, etc.
Anonymize	Replace names with codes or pseudonyms
Check accuracy	Listen while reading
Note emotional tone	[angry], [excited], [sad]

Sample Transcription Excerpt:

```
I: So tell me about your experience with mobile money.

R: [sighs] Well, it's... it's been both good and bad, you know?
   [pause 3 seconds] When it works, it's really helpful. Like last mon
th,
   my son in Kampala sent me money for seeds. [voice brightens] I rece
ived
   it immediately and went straight to buy before the rains came.

I: Mm-hmm.

R: But [voice changes, becomes frustrated] sometimes the network... aa
h!
   You go to the agent, you queue for 30 minutes, and then the network
is
   down. [sighs] You have to come back tomorrow. Wasted time.
```

Aspect	Recommendation	Reason
Group size	6-10 participants	Small enough for all to speak, large enough for diversity
Number of	3-5 groups	Until saturation (no new

```
I: That sounds frustrating.

R: [emphatically] Very frustrating! And the fees... [shakes head]
   Every time you withdraw, they eat your money.
```

---

3. FOCUS GROUP DISCUSSIONS

3.1 Definition

A **focus group discussion (FGD)** is a qualitative research method where a small group of people (typically 6-10) discuss a specific topic guided by a moderator, while a researcher observes and takes notes.

3.2 When to Use Focus Groups

Appropriate When	Not Appropriate When
Exploring group norms and shared experiences	Topic is very sensitive/private
Generating ideas through interaction	Individuals might feel intimidated
Understanding community perspectives	Need individual in-depth stories
Testing reactions to ideas	Group dynamics might bias responses
Complementing survey data	Participants don't know each other
Exploring why people think/believe something	Power differences might silence some

3.3 Focus Group Composition

groups		information)
Homogeneity	Similar characteristics (farmers together, not mixed with agents)	People speak more freely with peers
Diversity within group	Mix of ages, genders if appropriate	Captures range of views
Familiarity	Should not be close friends or relatives	Avoids pre-existing dynamics

3.4 Focus Group Process

Before the Focus Group

Task	Details
Define purpose	What do you want to learn?
Develop discussion guide	Key questions, probes, activities
Select participants	Recruit 8-12 (expect some no-shows)
Arrange venue	Neutral, comfortable, quiet, private
Schedule	Convenient time for participants
Prepare materials	Recording equipment, refreshments, name tags, consent forms

During the Focus Group

Stage	Activities
Arrival and setup	Arrange seating (circle), test equipment, prepare refreshments
Welcome and introduction	Welcome participants, explain purpose, introduce team (moderator, note-taker)
Ground rules	One person speaks at a time, respect different views, confidentiality, no right/wrong answers
Consent	Explain, get written consent, ask permission to record
Ice-breaker	Simple activity to make people comfortable
Discussion	Follow guide, probe, ensure all participate, manage dominant voices

Closing	Summarize key points, ask for final thoughts, thank participants, provide refreshments

After the Focus Group

- Debrief with note-taker immediately
- Transcribe recording
- Analyze data
- Write report

3.5 Focus Group Discussion Guide Sample

FOCUS GROUP DISCUSSION GUIDE
Farmers and Mobile Money

Group: _____ Date: _____
Location: _____ Time: _____
Moderator: _____ Note-taker: _____
Number of participants: ____ Duration: _____

BEFORE DISCUSSION:
- Welcome and introductions
- Explain purpose
- Ground rules
- Consent forms
- Permission to record

ICE-BREAKER (5 minutes)
Go around and each person shares: Name, what they farm, and one word about how they feel about mobile money.

TOPIC 1: MOBILE MONEY EXPERIENCES (20 minutes)

Let's start by talking about your experiences with mobile money.

Q1: How did each of you first start using mobile money?
(Probe: What encouraged you? Was it easy?)

Q2: What do you use mobile money for most?
(Probe: Receiving? Sending? Saving? Paying?)

Q3: How has mobile money changed your daily life?

TOPIC 2: MOBILE MONEY AND FARMING (25 minutes)

Now let's talk specifically about farming.

Q4: How has mobile money affected your farming activities?
(Probe: Inputs? Selling? Information? Savings?)

Q5: Can anyone share a story about a time mobile money really helped with farm ing?

Q6: Has mobile money created any new challenges for farming?
(Probe: Dependence? Costs? Risks?)

TOPIC 3: CHALLENGES AND PROBLEMS (20 minutes)

Q7: What are the biggest problems you face with mobile money?
(Probe: Fees? Network? Agents? Fraud?)

Q8: [Write problems on flip chart as they're mentioned]
Looking at this list, which is the biggest challenge? Why?

Q9: How do you cope with these challenges?

TOPIC 4: SUGGESTIONS AND FUTURE (15 minutes)

Q10: If you could change one thing about mobile money, what would it be?

Q11: What would make mobile money work better for farmers like you?

Q12: What advice would you give to mobile money companies?

CLOSING (5 minutes)

- **Summarize main points discussed**
- **"Is there anything important we missed?"**
- **Thank participants**
- **Explain what will happen with the information**
- **Distribute refreshments**

OBSERVER NOTES:

Group dynamics (who spoke most, who was quiet):

_____

Non-verbal observations:

_____

Any problems or issues:

_____

Key themes that emerged:

_____

Quotes to remember:

_____

3.6 Moderator Skills

Skill	Description
Neutral but engaged	Interested but not judgmental
Manages time	Keeps discussion on track without rushing
Balances participation	Encourages quiet members, gently manages dominant ones
Active listening	Hears what's said and unsaid
Probing effectively	Asks follow-up questions for depth
Handles difficult situations	Manages conflict, emotional responses
Flexible	Follows interesting threads while maintaining focus
Good memory	Remembers earlier comments to connect later

3.7 Advantages and Disadvantages of Focus Groups

Advantages	Disadvantages
Interaction generates rich data	Dominant voices may prevail
Efficient (multiple perspectives at once)	Groupthink possible
Participants build on each other's ideas	Less depth than individual interviews
Can observe group dynamics	Confidentiality harder
Less intimidating than individual interviews	Sensitive topics difficult
Generates diverse views	Requires skilled moderator
Can uncover unexpected topics	Transcribing complex
Good for community norms	Scheduling difficult

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4. OBSERVATION

4.1 Definition

Observation is a data collection method where the researcher watches and records behaviors, events, or conditions in their natural setting.

4.2 Types of Observation

Type	Description	Advantages	Disadvantages
Participant observation	Researcher participates in activities	Insider perspective, rich data	May lose objectivity, time-consuming
Non-participant observation	Researcher watches without participating	More objective, less influence	May miss insider meaning
Structured observation	Systematic recording of specific behaviors	Consistent, comparable, quantifiable	May miss unexpected
Unstructured observation	Open recording of everything	Flexible, captures unexpected	Hard to compare, subjective
Overt observation	Participants know they're being observed	Ethical, can ask questions	May change behavior (Hawthorne effect)
Covert observation	Participants unaware	Natural behavior	Ethical concerns

4.3 What to Observe

Category	Examples
Physical setting	Location, layout, facilities, environment
People	Who is present? Demographics, roles
Activities	What is happening? Sequence, duration
Interactions	How do people interact? Verbal, non-verbal
Conversations	What do people say? To whom?
Behaviors	What do people do? Frequency, patterns
Events	What events occur? Regular or special
Time	Timing, duration, frequency
Emotions	Expressed feelings, mood
Objects/material culture	What objects are present? How used?

4.4 Observation Guide Sample

OBSERVATION GUIDE
Mobile Money Agent Location Observation

Observer: _____ Date: _____
Location: _____ Time: Start _____ End _____
Agent name/code: _____ Weather: _____

BEFORE OBSERVATION:
- Position yourself where you can see but not interfere
- Take notes unobtrusively
- Record time at intervals

PHYSICAL SETTING

Describe the location (market, roadside, shop, etc.):
_____
_____

Physical features (shelter, signage, queue area, etc.):
_____
_____

Equipment visible (phone, float, ledger, etc.):
_____

AGENT CHARACTERISTICS

Gender: [ ] Male [ ] Female
Estimated age: _____

Appearance/dress:

_____

How many phones/ lines does agent have?

_____

CUSTOMERS

Number of customers during observation period: _____

Estimated demographics of customers:
Male: _____ Female: _____
Estimated ages: _____

Did customers appear to be farmers? How could you tell?

_____

TRANSACTIONS (record each transaction observed)

Transaction 1:
Time: _____
Customer gender/age: _____
Type of transaction (withdraw/deposit/other): _____
Approximate amount: _____
Duration: _____
Any issues? _____

Transaction 2:
Time: _____
Customer gender/age: _____
Type of transaction: _____
Approximate amount: _____
Duration: _____
Any issues? _____

[Continue for all transactions observed]

INTERACTIONS

How does agent greet customers?

_____

How do customers behave (patient, impatient, friendly)?

_____

Are there conversations? What about?

_____

How does agent handle multiple customers?

_____

Any conflicts or problems observed?

_____

AGENT BEHAVIORS

Does agent check float/cash frequently?

_____

How does agent handle requests for large amounts?

_____

Does agent explain fees?

_____

Does agent help customers who have difficulty?

_____

QUEUE/BUSY PERIODS

Peak times observed:

_____

How long do people wait?

_____

How is queue managed (orderly, chaotic)?

_____

NETWORK/TECHNICAL ISSUES

Any network problems observed?

_____

How does agent handle technical issues?

_____

OTHER OBSERVATIONS

Anything unusual or notable?

_____

_____

_____

POST-OBSERVATION REFLECTIONS

Initial impressions:

_____

Questions this observation raises:

_____

What to look for in next observation:

_____

OBSERVER SIGNATURE: _____

4.5 Advantages and Disadvantages of Observation

Advantages	Disadvantages
See what people actually do (not just what they say)	Time-consuming
Rich contextual information	Observer may influence behavior (Hawthorne effect)
Can discover unexpected things	Cannot observe past events
No reliance on memory or honesty	May be subjective
Can supplement other methods	Ethical considerations
Useful for studying non-verbal behavior	Difficult to record everything
Can observe sensitive topics indirectly	Access may be limited

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5. DOCUMENT ANALYSIS

5.1 Definition

Document analysis is a systematic procedure for reviewing or evaluating documents—both printed and electronic material.

5.2 Types of Documents

Category	Examples
Official records	Government reports, ministry statistics, UBOS data, district records
Organizational records	School registers, health center records, NGO reports, meeting minutes
Public records	Census data, parliamentary reports, policy documents

Media	Newspapers, magazines, news websites, radio transcripts
Personal documents	Diaries, letters, autobiographies
Historical documents	Archives, colonial records, old maps
Visual documents	Photographs, videos, films
Digital documents	Websites, social media posts, blogs, emails

5.3 Document Analysis Process

Step 1: Locate Documents

- Identify what documents exist
- Determine where to find them
- Seek permissions if needed

Step 2: Assess Authenticity and Quality

- Who created it? When? Why?
- Is it complete?
- Is it reliable?

Step 3: Extract Information

- Read systematically
- Take notes
- Record bibliographic information

Step 4: Analyze Content

- What does it say?
- What themes emerge?
- What is missing?

Step 5: Synthesize

- Combine with other data
- Draw conclusions

5.4 Document Analysis Guide Sample

DOCUMENT ANALYSIS GUIDE

Document title: _____
Author/creator: _____
Date of publication: _____
Source location: _____
Type of document: _____
Date analyzed: _____
Analyzer: _____

DOCUMENT ASSESSMENT

1. Who created this document and for what purpose?

_____

2. Who was the intended audience?

_____

3. Is the document complete? [ ] Yes [ ] No [ ] Unknown
If no, what's missing?

_____

4. What is the main topic/focus?

_____

5. What are the key facts/statistics presented?

_____
_____
_____

6. What are the main arguments or messages?

_____
_____

CONTENT ANALYSIS

7. What information is relevant to my research?

_____
_____
_____

8. Key quotes (with page numbers):

"_____" p. ___
"_____" p. ___
"_____" p. ___

9. What themes emerge from this document?

_____
_____

10. What is missing from this document? What isn't discussed?

_____

11. How does this document compare to other sources?

_____

REFLECTION

12. How credible/reliable is this document? Why?

_____

13. What biases might be present?

_____

14. How will I use this document in my research?

_____

15. Questions this document raises:

_____

BIBLIOGRAPHIC INFORMATION (for reference list)

Author: _____
Year: _____
Title: _____
Publisher/Journal: _____
Volume/Issue: _____
Pages: _____
URL (if online): _____
Date accessed: _____

5.5 Advantages and Disadvantages of Document Analysis

Advantages	Disadvantages
Unobtrusive (no interaction needed)	Documents may be incomplete
Can cover long time periods	May be difficult to access
Often free/low cost	May have biases
Provides official/authoritative data	Not collected for your purpose
Can supplement other methods	May be outdated
Good for historical research	Authenticity questions
Can analyze large amounts	Time-consuming to analyze
Provides context	May raise copyright issues

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6. TRIANGULATION OF METHODS

6.1 What is Triangulation?

Triangulation means using multiple methods or sources to get a more complete and accurate understanding of your research topic.

6.2 Why Triangulate?

Reason	Explanation
Completeness	Different methods reveal different aspects
Cross-verification	Check findings from one method against another
Credibility	Findings more convincing if multiple sources agree
Compensation	Weaknesses of one method offset by strengths of another
Richness	Richer, deeper understanding

6.3 Example of Triangulation for Mobile Money Study

Research Question	Method 1	Method 2	Method 3
How do farmers use mobile money?	Survey (100 farmers)	Interviews (15 farmers)	Observation at agent
What challenges do they face?	Survey (quantitative)	Interviews (qualitative)	Document analysis (reports)
What is the impact on farming?	Survey (self-report)	Interviews (stories)	Comparison with official data

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7. CHOOSING THE RIGHT METHOD(S)

7.1 Decision Framework

If you want to know...	Best Method(s)
How many people do something?	Survey/questionnaire
What percentage think something?	Survey/questionnaire
Why people think/believe something?	Interviews, focus groups
What people actually do (vs. say)?	Observation
Historical trends/patterns?	Document analysis
Official statistics?	Document analysis

Community norms and discussions?	Focus groups
Individual stories and experiences?	Interviews
Quick overview from many people?	Survey
Deep understanding from few people?	Interviews, observation

7.2 Resource Considerations

Method	Time	Cost	Skill Needed	Sample Size
Survey	Medium	Low-Medium	Medium	Large
Interviews	High	Medium	High	Small
Focus groups	High	Medium	High	Medium
Observation	High	Low	Medium	Small
Document analysis	Medium	Low	Medium	Varies

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8. ETHICAL CONSIDERATIONS IN DATA COLLECTION

8.1 Key Ethical Principles

Principle	Meaning	Practice
Informed consent	Participants agree knowing what's involved	Explain purpose, procedures, risks, benefits; get signature
Voluntary participation	No coercion	Emphasize they can refuse or withdraw anytime
Confidentiality	Information not shared with others	Don't share names; store data securely
Anonymity	Identity not known to researcher	Don't collect names if possible; use codes
Do no harm	No physical or emotional harm	Avoid sensitive topics; be respectful; stop if distress
Respect	Treat participants with dignity	Be polite, grateful, culturally sensitive
Beneficence	Research should benefit	Consider how findings can help

		community

8.2 Sample Consent Form

CONSENT FORM

Title of Study: _____

Researcher: _____
School: _____
Contact: _____

PART 1: INFORMATION SHEET

I am a student at the above school conducting research for my General Paper Extended Essay. I am studying _____
_____
_____
_____

Your participation would involve:
- [ ] Completing a questionnaire (about ____ minutes)
- [ ] Participating in an interview (about ____ minutes)
- [ ] Participating in a focus group discussion (about ____ minutes)
- [ ] Being observed

Your participation is completely voluntary. You may:
- Refuse to answer any question
- Withdraw at any time without penalty
- Ask questions at any time

All information you provide will be kept confidential. Your name will not appear in any report. Data will be stored securely and only accessible to the researcher.

There are no known risks from participating. Benefits may include contributing to understanding of this topic and potential improvements in services for your community.

If you have questions, you may contact me at [contact information] or my supervisor at [supervisor contact].

PART 2: CONSENT STATEMENT

I have read and understood the information above. I understand that:
- My participation is voluntary
- I can withdraw at any time
- My responses will be kept confidential
- My name will not be used

I agree to participate in this research.

Name: _____ Signature: _____

Date: _____

[ ] I agree to be audio recorded during interview/focus group

Researcher's Signature: _____ Date: _____

Aspect	Questionnaire	Interview	Focus Group	Observation	Document Analysis
Type of data	Quantitative + some qualitative	Qualitative	Qualitative	Qualitative	Both
Sample size	Large	Small	Medium	Small	Varies
Depth	Low	High	Medium	High	Medium
Breadth	High	Low	Medium	Low	Varies
Time	Medium	High	High	High	Medium

required					
Cost	Low-Medium	Medium	Medium	Low	Low
Researcher skill	Medium	High	High	Medium	Medium
Flexibility	Low	High	Medium	High	Low
Response rate	Medium	High	High	High	N/A
Analyzing data	Easier	Difficult	Difficult	Difficult	Medium
Best for	Counting, patterns	Depth, meaning	Group views	Behavior	Existing info

9. SUMMARY: COMPARISON OF METHODS

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10. QUICK REFERENCE: WHEN TO USE EACH METHOD

Your Goal	Recommended Method
Find out how many farmers use mobile money	Questionnaire (closed questions)
Understand WHY farmers use mobile money	Interviews (open-ended questions)
Learn what farmers discuss about mobile money among themselves	Focus group discussions
See what actually happens at mobile money agents	Observation
Get official statistics on mobile money in Uganda	Document analysis (UBOS, Bank of Uganda reports)
Compare male and female usage patterns	Questionnaire + interviews
Understand a farmer's complete story	In-depth interview
Get quick feedback from many people	Online questionnaire
Explore a new topic you know little about	Unstructured interviews first, then questionnaire

Study historical trends in mobile money	Document analysis (old reports, newspapers)
Understand community norms about saving	Focus group discussions